# John: A Kingdom Life Study Guide

*All Twenty-One Chapters - Key Notes, Cross-References, and Prophecy Fulfilled (WEB)*

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# Preface

This book walks through all twenty-one chapters of John, one chapter at a time, with the full text of every chapter printed in it. It grew out of study guides written for a group working through the Gospels three chapters at a time, and it is the sixth volume in this series.

John is the Gospel that starts before the beginning. Matthew opens with a family tree, Mark with a man in the desert, Luke with a historian describing his method. John opens with the first words of Genesis and carries them back past the first day: in the beginning was the Word, and the Word was with God, and the Word was God. Then, fourteen verses later, the sentence the whole book rests on: the Word became flesh, and pitched His tent among us.

It is a companion to the Jeremiah, Matthew, Malachi, Mark and Luke volumes in this series, and it is built the same way. If you have used any of those, everything here will be familiar.

The prose is the point. The tables and footnotes are apparatus - useful, and worth using - but they exist to serve a reading of John, not to replace one. If you only ever read the chapter introductions and the scripture text, you will have read this book properly.

## How this book is put together

Every chapter follows the same shape.

- **Key Notes** - the observations worth having in hand before you read: a word that carries more than the translation shows, a custom the first readers took for granted, a connection to something earlier in the book. Each note ends with the verses it comes from.
- **Key Cross-References** - passages that stand behind or alongside the chapter, grouped by theme.
- **Prophecy Fulfilled** - places where the chapter runs back into the Hebrew Scriptures. The heading is shared with the Matthew, Mark and Luke volumes, and there is a note about it below.
- **For Further Study** - three places to go deeper.
- **Introduction** - the chapter read as a whole before you read it in parts.
- **The chapter itself**, printed in full in the World English Bible, with footnote markers on the verses the references belong to.

Every scripture reference in the book is a live link to the World English Bible on BibleGateway. In the app, tapping a footnote marker shows the full text of the passages cited and a line on why they connect, so you can follow a cross-reference without losing your place.

## A note on the second table

The second table in each chapter is headed **Prophecy Fulfilled**, the same as in the other three Gospels, so that anyone reading across them is not relearning the apparatus halfway through.

John uses the fulfillment formula less than Matthew, and saves most of it for the last week - the betrayal, the garments divided, the bones not broken, the side pierced. His more usual way is to show Yahshua standing where something earlier stood: the tabernacle, the manna, the bronze serpent lifted up, the shepherd, the vine, the Passover lamb. That is typology, a pattern answered by a Person, and many of the entries in the table are of that kind. Where an entry is a pattern rather than a prediction, the note at the verse says so.

## A note on the divine names

In the notes and introductions this book uses **Yahweh** for the covenant name of God and **Yahshua** for the Messiah, as the group this material was written for does.

The printed scripture text is never altered. The World English Bible reads Jesus in the Gospels, and it stands exactly as the translators set it. So you will see Yahshua in a paragraph of commentary and Jesus in the verse beneath it. That is deliberate. It keeps our own speech and the translator's work visibly distinct.

## A note on the chapter titles

The chapter titles in this book are not traditional and are not found in any Bible. They were written for this study - they name what struck us in that chapter rather than summarising it.

## A note on the disputed passages

Two passages in John are missing from the earliest manuscripts. This book prints both, as the World English Bible does, and says plainly where the question lies.

**John 5:3-4** - the angel who stirred the water of the pool, and the first one in being healed. Absent from the earliest Greek manuscripts. Whether John wrote it or a copyist explained the scene, the sick man's own words in verse 7 show that this is what the people lying there believed.

**John 7:53-8:11** - the woman taken in adultery. Missing from the earliest Greek manuscripts of John and found in different places in later ones. Most readers believe it is a true account of Yahshua that was preserved separately and later placed here. Its language and setting fit His last week in Jerusalem.

This book prints them because the WEB prints them, notes the evidence at the verse, and leaves the judgment where it belongs.

# Introduction to John

## Who wrote it

The book never names its author. It points to him instead: “the disciple whom Jesus loved,” who leans against Him at the last supper, stands at the cross, outruns Peter to the tomb, and recognises the Lord on the shore. The last chapter says plainly that this is the disciple who wrote these things, and that others know his testimony is true.

The earliest tradition identifies him as John the son of Zebedee, one of the twelve, writing late in life. The Gospel never uses John’s own name for him - the only John in this book is the Baptist - which is hard to explain unless the author was deliberately keeping himself out of it.

What the book does show is a man who knew Jerusalem before it fell: the pool with five porches, the pavement called Gabbatha, the brook Kidron, Solomon’s porch in winter, the hour of the day a thing happened, and how many fish were in a net.

## Why it was written

John tells you, which no other Gospel writer does so directly. “These are written, that you may believe that Jesus is the Christ, the Son of God, and that believing you may have life in his name.”

Every story in the book was chosen for that purpose. He says plainly that Yahshua did many other signs, and that the world could not hold the books if all of them were written. What is here is a selection, made on purpose, aimed at belief.

## The shape of the book

- **The Prologue** (1:1-18) - the Word before the beginning, and the Word made flesh.
- **The Signs** (1:19-12:50) - a public ministry marked by seven signs and by the feasts of Israel, ending with Isaiah’s question: who has believed our report?
- **The Glory** (13:1-20:31) - one night of teaching in private, then the cross, which John calls glory, and the resurrection.
- **The Epilogue** (21:1-25) - breakfast on the beach and Peter restored.

The seven signs usually counted are the water made wine, the official’s son healed, the man at the pool, the five thousand fed, the walk on the water, the man born blind, and Lazarus raised. John numbers only the first two and lets the reader keep count.

## I AM

Seven times Yahshua says I am with a picture attached: the bread of life, the light of the world, the door, the good shepherd, the resurrection and the life, the way and the truth and the life, and the true vine.

Alongside those are the times He says I am with nothing after it at all - to the woman at the well, on the water at night, before Abraham was, and in the garden, when an armed company falls to the ground. In Greek it is ego eimi, the phrase the Greek Scriptures use for Yahweh's own words in Isaiah: that you may know and believe me, and understand that I am he. John wants you to hear it.

## The feasts

No Gospel pays more attention to the appointed times. John marks three Passovers, which is where the familiar reckoning of a ministry of about three years comes from. He sets three whole chapters at Tabernacles, where Yahshua offers living water on the last great day and calls Himself the light of the world beside the lamps of the feast. He records Him in the temple at Dedication. And he dates the cross to the Preparation Day of the Passover, with the Lamb of God dying as the lambs were made ready.

John is also the Gospel that dates the last supper "before the feast of the Passover," and has the leaders the next morning still waiting to eat it. The notes at those chapters follow John's own time markers.

## How John differs from the other three

Readers coming from Matthew, Mark and Luke notice the difference at once. There are no parables in the usual sense, and no casting out of demons. Much of the action is in Judea and Jerusalem rather than Galilee. The teaching comes in long conversations - with Nicodemus, with the woman at the well, with the crowds at the feasts, with the disciples on the last night - rather than in short sayings.

Most of what is in John is in no other Gospel. The early church described it as the spiritual Gospel, written by someone who knew the others and set out to tell what they had not.

## When it was written

Tradition places John last of the four, toward the end of the first century, written from Ephesus. Some scholars argue for an earlier date, pointing out that John describes the pool by the sheep gate as standing - there is a pool - in the present tense. This book does not try to settle it.

## How to use this book

Read John straight through before any of the apparatus. It can be read in an evening, and the pattern of the signs and the feasts only shows if you see the whole.

After that, take a chapter at a time. Read the introduction first, then the chapter itself, and come back to the notes and tables afterward; they will mean more once the text is in you.

If you are reading with others, the introductions are written to be read aloud. That is what they were for originally, and they still work best that way.

# CHAPTER 1 - The Word Made Flesh, a Voice That Claims Nothing, and Come and See

## Key Notes

- “In the beginning” is the first phrase of Genesis, quoted deliberately. John is not starting his book; he is starting the book, and going back further than Genesis does (John 1:1).
- Logos was a live word in two worlds at once. To a Greek it was the ordering principle behind everything; to a Jew it was the davar, the word by which God creates and by which prophets are addressed, and the Aramaic paraphrases used it as a way of speaking about God Himself acting. John picks the one word that lands in both rooms (John 1:1).
- “The Word was God” lacks the article before God in the Greek, which is sometimes offered as a reason to read a god. But Greek regularly drops the article from a predicate noun standing before its verb, and John writes the same construction elsewhere without anyone reading it that way. The grammar is worth knowing rather than shouting about (John 1:1).
- Verse 3 is deliberately airtight: all things were made through him, and without him not one thing was made that has been made. There is no category left over (John 1:3).
- The verb in verse 5 can mean overcome or grasp, and both senses are alive in it - the darkness neither put the light out nor understood it. The WEB prints overcome (John 1:5).
- The witness is introduced before the incarnation is stated. John the Baptist arrives in verse 6, eight verses before the Word becomes flesh, because in this Gospel testimony always comes first (John 1:6-8).
- Verse 11 uses two different forms: he came to his own things - his own place - and his own people did not receive him (John 1:11).
- “He gave the right to become God’s children” is exousia, authority, and the birth is defined by three negations: not of blood, not of the will of the flesh, not of the will of a man (John 1:12-13).
- “Lived among us” is eskenosen - he pitched his tent, he tabernacled. The word is built on the tent in the wilderness, and the next clause, we saw his glory, is what filled it (John 1:14).
- “Grace and truth” is the Hebrew pair chesed and emet - loyal love and faithfulness - which is what Yahweh proclaimed over Moses on the mountain. Three verses later Moses is named by name (John 1:14, 17).
- Verse 17 is not law bad, grace good. The law was given through Moses; grace and truth came into being through Yahshua. One was handed down and the other arrived in person (John 1:17).
- “In the bosom of the Father” is the position of the honoured guest reclining next to the host at a meal. John uses the same phrase later of the disciple leaning on Yahshua (John 1:18, 13:23).
- The delegation asks three questions in descending order of expectation: the Christ, Elijah, the prophet of Deuteronomy 18. John says no to all three (John 1:19-21).

- He denies being Elijah, and Yahshua later says he came in the spirit and power of Elijah. Both are true at different levels - he is not the returned prophet, and he is doing the work Malachi described. This book flags the tension rather than flattening it (John 1:21, Luke 1:17).
- The only identity he claims is a sound. I am a voice. Not a title, not an office - the noise somebody makes ahead of a king (John 1:23).
- Loosening a sandal was slave work, and rabbinic tradition held that a Hebrew slave could not be made to do it. He says he is not fit for the job a slave would be spared (John 1:27).
- "Behold, the Lamb of God, who takes away the sin of the world" appears nowhere else in the Gospels. Which lamb is not specified - the Passover lamb, which was not a sin offering; the silent lamb of Isaiah 53; the daily offering in the temple; the ram caught for Isaac. The ambiguity may well be the point (John 1:29).
- The opening chapter is dated in days - the next day, the next day, again the next day - and chapter 2 opens on the third day after that. Counted through, it makes a week. Many readers see a creation week deliberately laid over the start of the Gospel; the text does not say so outright (John 1:29, 35, 43, 2:1).
- "It was about the tenth hour" is four in the afternoon. Nothing in the story depends on it, which is exactly why it reads like something somebody remembered (John 1:39).
- Andrew first finds his own brother. That is the shape of the whole chapter - found, and then brought. Nobody in it is argued into anything (John 1:41-42).
- John translates Rabbi, Messiah and Cephas for his reader. He is writing for people who do not have the Aramaic (John 1:38, 41, 42).
- Nazareth is never mentioned anywhere in the Hebrew Scriptures, and Nathanael is from Cana, the next village over. His remark is small-town rivalry rather than theology (John 1:46, 21:2).
- "An Israelite in whom is no deceit" is a pointed thing to say, because Israel was the name given to a man whose whole early life was deceit - and the promise three verses later is Jacob's dream (John 1:47, 51).
- Being under a fig tree is sometimes read as rabbinic shorthand for studying Torah. It may be. The text simply says he was there and that he was seen (John 1:48).
- The last verse is Genesis 28 with a Person where the ladder was - heaven opened, and the angels ascending and descending on the Son of Man. And the you is plural: the promise is to all of them (John 1:51).

## Key Cross-References (WEB)

| Topic | References |
|---|---|
| In the Beginning | John 1:1 • Genesis 1:1 • Proverbs 8:22-30 |
| All Things Made Through Him | John 1:3 • Psalm 33:6 • Isaiah 44:24 |
| He Tabernacled Among Us | John 1:14 • Exodus 40:34-35 • Ezekiel 37:27 |

| Topic | References |
|---|---|
| Grace and Truth | John 1:14 • Exodus 34:6 • Psalm 85:10 |
| No One Has Seen God | John 1:18 • Exodus 33:20 • Deuteronomy 4:12 |
| Are You Elijah? | John 1:21 • Malachi 4:5 • Deuteronomy 18:15 |
| The Voice in the Wilderness | John 1:23 • Isaiah 40:3 • Malachi 3:1 |
| An Israelite Without Deceit | John 1:47 • Genesis 27:35 • Psalm 32:2 |

## Prophecy Fulfilled

| Fulfillment | References |
|---|---|
| The Light the Darkness Cannot Put Out | John 1:5 • Isaiah 9:2 • Isaiah 60:1-3 |
| The Glory We Have Seen | John 1:14 • Isaiah 6:1-3 • Exodus 33:18-19 |
| The Lamb of God | John 1:29 • Isaiah 53:7 • Exodus 12:3-6 |
| The Spirit Descending and Remaining | John 1:32-33 • Isaiah 11:2 • Isaiah 42:1 |
| Of Whom Moses and the Prophets Wrote | John 1:45 • Deuteronomy 18:18 • Isaiah 7:14 |
| The Son of God, the King of Israel | John 1:49 • Psalm 2:6-7 • Zephaniah 3:15 |
| The Ladder Between Heaven and Earth | John 1:51 • Genesis 28:12 • Daniel 7:13 |

## For Further Study

Credible external commentary that expounds on this chapter in a way consistent with a Torah-honoring, Messianic reading of the text:

- Enduring Word - John 1 Commentary (David Guzik) - the prologue, the witness of John, and the first disciples
- Life, Hope and Truth - The Gospel of John - John's signs, the I AM sayings, and why this Gospel differs from the other three
- Verse By Verse Ministry International - The Gospel of John, Lesson 1A - exposition of the prologue and the testimony of John the Baptist

## John 1 - Introduction

Every other Gospel begins somewhere a reader can stand. Matthew begins with a family tree, Mark with a man in a desert, Luke with a historian describing his method. John begins before there was anywhere to stand.

In the beginning was the Word is a quotation, and every Jewish reader knew of what. John picks up the first sentence of Genesis and carries it back past the first day. And the term he chooses is live in two worlds at once: to a Greek the Logos is the reason behind the universe, the pattern holding it together; to a Jew the word of Yahweh is how the world was made, and in the Aramaic paraphrases read in

synagogue the Word was a way of speaking about God acting without naming Him directly. It is the one term that lands in both rooms - and then John says the thing neither room was ready for. The Word became flesh.

The verb is not lived but pitched a tent: he tabernacled among us. It is built on the tent in the middle of the wilderness camp, the one with the glory over it that Moses could not walk into - and the very next clause is that we beheld his glory. What filled the tent moved into a body. And the pair that goes with it, grace and truth, is chesed and emet, the two words Yahweh speaks over Himself as He passes in front of Moses on the mountain, which is why Moses is named three verses later. That verse is not law bad and grace good. The law was given - handed down, delivered. Grace and truth came into being, arrived in a person. The same God, and the second time He has a face.

Then a man in the wilderness handles an interrogation by refusing every title offered him. Not the Christ, not Elijah, not the prophet. Asked to supply something his questioners can take back, he claims to be a sound - a voice, the noise somebody makes ahead of a king. And when he finally points, the sentence puts the whole book in one line: behold, the Lamb of God, who takes away the sin of the world. He never says which lamb, and there were several available - Passover, the silent lamb of Isaiah, the offering made every morning and evening, the ram caught in the thicket when Abraham raised the knife. The refusal to narrow it may be the point.

The rest of the chapter is people finding people. Andrew follows, then fetches his brother. Philip fetches Nathanael, and when Nathanael sneers about Nazareth - which is village rivalry rather than theology, since Cana is the next town over - Philip does not argue with him but says come and see, which is what Yahshua had already said to the first two. There is no debate anywhere in this chapter. And the man greeted as an Israelite without deceit is being handed a loaded compliment, because Israel was the name given to a man whose early life was deceit; the promise made to him a few verses later is that man's dream at Bethel, the ladder with traffic moving between heaven and earth. Except that in this version there is no ladder. There is a Person.

## John 1:1-51 (WEB)

**1** In the beginning was the Word, and the Word was with God, and the Word was God.[1]

**2** The same was in the beginning with God.

**3** All things were made through him. Without him was not anything made that has been made.[2]

**4** In him was life, and the life was the light of men.

**5** The light shines in the darkness, and the darkness hasn't overcome it.[3]

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[1] **Cross-Reference:** Genesis 1:1 • Proverbs 8:22-30 - *in the beginning God created, and wisdom present as a craftsman when he marked out the foundations*

[2] **Cross-Reference:** Psalm 33:6 • Isaiah 44:24 - *by Yahweh's word the heavens were made, and the one who stretched out the heavens alone*

[3] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Isaiah 9:2 • Isaiah 60:1-3 - *the people walking in darkness who have seen a great light, and nations coming to the brightness of your rising*

**6** There came a man, sent from God, whose name was John.

**7** The same came as a witness, that he might testify about the light, that all might believe through him.

**8** He was not the light, but was sent that he might testify about the light.

**9** The true light that enlightens everyone was coming into the world.

**10** He was in the world, and the world was made through him, and the world didn't recognize him.

**11** He came to his own, and those who were his own didn't receive him.

**12** But as many as received him, to them he gave the right to become God's children, to those who believe in his name:

**13** who were born not of blood, nor of the will of the flesh, nor of the will of man, but of God.

**14** The Word became flesh, and lived among us. We saw his glory, such glory as of the one and only Son of the Father, full of grace and truth.[4]

**15** John testified about him. He cried out, saying, "This was he of whom I said, 'He who comes after me has surpassed me, for he was before me.'"

**16** From his fullness we all received grace upon grace.

**17** For the law was given through Moses. Grace and truth were realized through Jesus Christ.[5]

**18** No one has seen God at any time. The one and only Son, who is in the bosom of the Father, he has declared him.[6]

**19** This is John's testimony, when the Jews sent priests and Levites from Jerusalem to ask him, "Who are you?"

**20** He declared, and didn't deny, but he declared, "I am not the Christ."

**21** They asked him, "What then? Are you Elijah?" He said, "I am not." "Are you the prophet?" He answered, "No."[7]

**22** They said therefore to him, "Who are you? Give us an answer to take back to those who sent us. What do you say about yourself?"

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[4] **Cross-Reference:** Exodus 40:34-35 • Exodus 34:6 - *the glory filling the tabernacle so that Moses could not enter, and Yahweh proclaiming himself abundant in loving kindness and truth*

[5] **Cross-Reference:** Exodus 24:12 • Psalm 85:10 - *the tablets given to Moses on the mountain, and loving kindness and truth meeting together*

[6] **Cross-Reference:** Exodus 33:20 • Deuteronomy 4:12 - *no man may see me and live, and a voice heard with no form seen*

[7] **Cross-Reference:** Malachi 4:5 • Deuteronomy 18:15 - *Elijah sent before the great and terrible day, and a prophet like Moses whom you shall listen to*

**23** He said, “I am the voice of one crying in the wilderness, ‘Make straight the way of the Lord,’ as Isaiah the prophet said.”[8]

**24** The ones who had been sent were from the Pharisees.

**25** They asked him, “Why then do you baptize, if you are not the Christ, nor Elijah, nor the prophet?”

**26** John answered them, “I baptize in water, but among you stands one whom you don’t know.

**27** He is the one who comes after me, who is preferred before me, whose sandal strap I’m not worthy to loosen.”

**28** These things were done in Bethany beyond the Jordan, where John was baptizing.

**29** The next day, he saw Jesus coming to him, and said, “Behold, the Lamb of God, who takes away the sin of the world![9]

**30** This is he of whom I said, ‘After me comes a man who is preferred before me, for he was before me.’

**31** I didn’t know him, but for this reason I came baptizing in water: that he would be revealed to Israel.”

**32** John testified, saying, “I have seen the Spirit descending like a dove out of heaven, and it remained on him.[10]

**33** I didn’t recognize him, but he who sent me to baptize in water, he said to me, ‘On whomever you will see the Spirit descending, and remaining on him, the same is he who baptizes in the Holy Spirit.’

**34** I have seen, and have testified that this is the Son of God.”

**35** Again, the next day, John was standing with two of his disciples,

**36** and he looked at Jesus as he walked, and said, “Behold, the Lamb of God!”

**37** The two disciples heard him speak, and they followed Jesus.

**38** Jesus turned, and saw them following, and said to them, “What are you looking for?” They said to him, “Rabbi” (which is to say, being interpreted, Teacher), “where are you staying?”

**39** He said to them, “Come, and see.” They came and saw where he was staying, and they stayed with him that day. It was about the tenth hour.

**40** One of the two who heard John, and followed him, was Andrew, Simon Peter’s brother.

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[8] **Cross-Reference:** Isaiah 40:3 • Malachi 3:1 - *a voice crying in the wilderness to prepare the way, and the messenger sent before the face*

[9] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Isaiah 53:7 • Exodus 12:3-6 - *led as a lamb to the slaughter, and a lamb without blemish kept until the fourteenth day*

[10] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Isaiah 11:2 • Isaiah 42:1 - *the Spirit of Yahweh resting on him, and my chosen in whom my soul delights*

**41** He first found his own brother, Simon, and said to him, “We have found the Messiah!” (which is, being interpreted, Christ).

**42** He brought him to Jesus. Jesus looked at him, and said, “You are Simon the son of Jonah. You shall be called Cephas” (which is by interpretation, Peter).

**43** On the next day, he was determined to go out into Galilee, and he found Philip. Jesus said to him, “Follow me.”

**44** Now Philip was from Bethsaida, of the city of Andrew and Peter.

**45** Philip found Nathanael, and said to him, “We have found him, of whom Moses in the law, and the prophets, wrote: Jesus of Nazareth, the son of Joseph.”[11]

**46** Nathanael said to him, “Can any good thing come out of Nazareth?” Philip said to him, “Come and see.”

**47** Jesus saw Nathanael coming to him, and said about him, “Behold, an Israelite indeed, in whom is no deceit!”

**48** Nathanael said to him, “How do you know me?” Jesus answered him, “Before Philip called you, when you were under the fig tree, I saw you.”

**49** Nathanael answered him, “Rabbi, you are the Son of God! You are King of Israel!”[12]

**50** Jesus answered him, “Because I told you, ‘I saw you underneath the fig tree,’ do you believe? You will see greater things than these!”

**51** He said to him, “Most certainly, I tell you all, hereafter you will see heaven opened, and the angels of God ascending and descending on the Son of Man.”[13]

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[11] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Deuteronomy 18:18 • Isaiah 7:14 - *a prophet raised up from among their brothers, and the virgin who conceives and bears a son*

[12] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Psalm 2:6-7 • Zephaniah 3:15 - *my king set on my holy hill, and the King of Israel in the midst of her*

[13] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Genesis 28:12 • Daniel 7:13 - *the ladder with angels ascending and descending, and one like a son of man coming with the clouds*

# CHAPTER 2 - Six Stone Jars, a Whip of Cords, and a Temple Raised in Three Days

## Key Notes

- “The third day” counts on from the days marked through chapter 1. Taken together the opening runs to seven, which many readers take as a creation week laid over the beginning of the Gospel (John 2:1, 1:29).
- Cana appears only in John, and the one man we know from there is Nathanael, who was called two days earlier (John 2:1, 21:2).
- “Woman” sounds cold in English and was not rude in Greek - He uses the same address to her from the cross. But it is not mother either, and the distance in it is real (John 2:4, 19:26).
- “What does that have to do with you and me” is a Hebrew idiom that turns up in Samuel and Kings. It means this is not a matter we share, and it is not affectionate (John 2:4).
- “My hour has not yet come” is the first of a series. The hour finally arrives when He says the hour has come for the Son of Man to be glorified - and He means the cross (John 2:4, 12:23).
- Whatever he says to you, do it, is the last thing His mother says in the whole of Scripture. She is not recorded speaking again (John 2:5).
- The jars are stone rather than clay because stone does not contract ritual impurity - which is why the vessels for purification water were made of it. Two or three metretes apiece puts the total somewhere near a hundred and twenty gallons (John 2:6).
- He takes the water kept for ceremonial washing and makes it the wine of a wedding. Nothing is destroyed and nothing is condemned; the same water is put to a better use (John 2:7-9).
- There were six jars. Seven is the number that would have been complete (John 2:6).
- The master of the feast does not know where it came from; the servants who drew it do. In this Gospel knowledge keeps landing on the people who did what they were told (John 2:9).
- The compliment goes to a bridegroom who did nothing. The next chapter will name who the bridegroom actually is (John 2:10, 3:29).
- John calls it a sign - semeion - not a mighty work, which is the Synoptics’ usual word. A mighty work displays power; a sign points away from itself at something else (John 2:11).
- John puts the clearing of the temple at the start of the ministry and the other three put it at the end. Either there were two, three years apart, or John has placed it here for reasons of theme rather than sequence. Both readings have serious defenders and this book does not settle it (John 2:13-16).
- The whip is only in John, and read closely it is used on the animals. To the men selling doves He speaks instead - and doves were the offering of the poor, so scattering those birds would have cost the poorest people in the court their sacrifice (John 2:15-16).

- “My Father’s house” is the first claim He makes in this Gospel, and it is a claim about sonship as much as about trading. Luke has Him using almost the same words at twelve years old (John 2:16, Luke 2:49).
- The disciples remember Psalm 69, which is quoted more often in the New Testament than almost any other psalm, and always about suffering (John 2:17).
- “Destroy this temple” is an imperative. He is not proposing it; He is telling them what they are going to do (John 2:19).
- Forty-six years puts the conversation around AD 27 or 28, since Herod’s rebuilding began around 20 BC. It is one of the firmest chronological pegs in the Gospels (John 2:20).
- Verse 21 is John’s own note, added long afterwards - he spoke of the temple of his body - and verse 22 admits that nobody understood it at the time (John 2:21-22).
- The last three verses are a warning attached to a success. Many believed when they saw the signs, and He did not entrust Himself to them. It is the same verb both ways: they believed in Him, and He did not believe in them (John 2:23-24).
- “He knew what was in man” closes the chapter - and the next word in the Gospel is Nicodemus, a man arriving with a carefully prepared opening line (John 2:25, 3:1).

## Key Cross-References (WEB)

| Topic | References |
|---|---|
| Whatever He Says to You, Do It | John 2:5 • Genesis 41:55 • Exodus 24:7 |
| Vessels for Purifying | John 2:6 • Numbers 19:17-19 • Leviticus 11:32-33 |
| Wine at the Feast | John 2:10 • Psalm 104:14-15 • Isaiah 25:6 |
| A House of Prayer, Not a Market | John 2:16 • Isaiah 56:7 • Zechariah 14:21 |
| Zeal for Your House | John 2:17 • Psalm 69:9 • Psalm 119:139 |
| By What Sign? | John 2:18 • Deuteronomy 18:21-22 • Isaiah 7:11 |
| Raised on the Third Day | John 2:19 • Hosea 6:2 • Psalm 16:10 |
| He Knew What Was in Man | John 2:25 • 1 Samuel 16:7 • Jeremiah 17:9-10 |

## Prophecy Fulfilled

| Fulfillment | References |
|---|---|
| The Bridegroom at the Feast | John 2:9 • Isaiah 62:5 • Hosea 2:19-20 |
| The Wine of the Age to Come | John 2:10 • Amos 9:13-14 • Joel 3:18 |
| Glory Revealed in a Sign | John 2:11 • Isaiah 35:1-2 • Habakkuk 2:14 |
| The Lord Comes Suddenly to His Temple | John 2:15 • Malachi 3:1-3 • Zechariah 14:21 |
| Zeal Has Consumed Me | John 2:17 • Psalm 69:9 • Psalm 69:20-21 |

| Fulfillment | References |
|---|---|
| A Temple Not Built by Hands | John 2:19 • Ezekiel 37:26-27 • Isaiah 28:16 |
| He Searches the Heart | John 2:24 • Psalm 139:1-4 • 1 Chronicles 28:9 |

## For Further Study

Credible external commentary that expounds on this chapter in a way consistent with a Torah-honoring, Messianic reading of the text:

- Enduring Word - John 2 Commentary (David Guzik) - the wedding at Cana, the first sign, and the cleansing of the temple
- Life, Hope and Truth - The Gospel of John - the seven signs and what John means by belief
- Verse By Verse Ministry International - The Gospel of John, Lesson 2 - exposition of Cana and the first Passover of the ministry

## John 2 - Introduction

A wedding in a village nobody has heard of, and the catering fails. A village wedding was the party of the decade and ran for days; running out of wine was not an inconvenience but a humiliation the town would still be discussing in twenty years. His mother comes to Him and says four words. They have no wine. She does not ask for anything - she simply tells Him.

The reply sounds cold in English. Woman is not rude in Greek, and He uses the same address to her from the cross, but it is not mother either, and the distance in it is real. What does that have to do with you and me is an old Hebrew idiom, found in Samuel and in Kings, meaning this is not a matter we share. And my hour has not yet come starts a clock that runs the length of this Gospel; when the hour finally arrives, it is the cross. Her answer is to turn to the servants and say whatever He tells you, do it - the last words Mary speaks anywhere in Scripture.

Six stone jars, and the detail earns its place twice over. Stone, because stone cannot contract ritual impurity, which is exactly why the water for purification was kept in it. And six rather than seven. Something like a hundred and twenty gallons of washing water, filled to the brim and turned into the wine of a wedding feast. Nothing is smashed and nobody is lectured about ceremony; the same vessels are filled and put to a better use. And no one sees it happen - there is no gesture and no word spoken over the water, only a servant dipping a cup. The master of the feast does not know where it came from, and the servants who drew it do. That will keep happening in this book: the people who did what they were told are the people who know.

The compliment goes to a bridegroom who had nothing to do with it, which is quietly funny and also a set-up, because the next chapter identifies who the bridegroom actually is. And John calls this the beginning of the signs - not a mighty work, which is the word the other Gospels reach for, but a sign, which points away from itself.

Then Jerusalem and the tables. Matthew, Mark and Luke all place this in the final week and John places it at the beginning: either it happened twice, three years apart, or John has set it here for reasons of theme. Serious readers hold both and this book does not pretend to settle it. What He does is worth watching closely. The whip, which only John mentions, is used on the animals; to the men selling doves He speaks instead, and doves were the offering of the poor, so loosing those birds would have cost the poorest people in the court what they came with. Even overturning the place, He is careful about who pays. And what He calls it is the first claim He makes in this Gospel - my Father's house. Destroy this temple is an imperative, not a proposal; He is telling them what they will do. Forty-six years of building sets the conversation around AD 27 or 28, and John adds, long afterwards, that He spoke of the temple of His body, and that nobody understood it until He was raised. The chapter ends on a warning attached to a success: many believed when they saw the signs, and He did not entrust Himself to them. It is the same verb both ways. They believed in Him; He did not believe in them.

## John 2:1-25 (WEB)

**1** The third day, there was a marriage in Cana of Galilee. Jesus' mother was there.

**2** Jesus also was invited, with his disciples, to the marriage.

**3** When the wine ran out, Jesus' mother said to him, "They have no wine."

**4** Jesus said to her, "Woman, what does that have to do with you and me? My hour has not yet come."

**5** His mother said to the servants, "Whatever he says to you, do it."[14]

**6** Now there were six water pots of stone set there after the Jews' way of purifying, containing two or three metretes apiece.[15]

**7** Jesus said to them, "Fill the water pots with water." They filled them up to the brim.

**8** He said to them, "Now draw some out, and take it to the ruler of the feast." So they took it.

**9** When the ruler of the feast tasted the water now become wine, and didn't know where it came from (but the servants who had drawn the water knew), the ruler of the feast called the bridegroom,[16]

**10** and said to him, "Everyone serves the good wine first, and when the guests have drunk freely, then that which is worse. You have kept the good wine until now!"[17]

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[14] **Cross-Reference:** Genesis 41:55 • Exodus 24:7 - *go to Joseph, and whatever he says to you, do it; and all that Yahweh has spoken we will do*

[15] **Cross-Reference:** Numbers 19:17-19 • Leviticus 11:32-33 - *running water for cleansing the unclean, and the earthen vessel that must be broken*

[16] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Isaiah 62:5 • Hosea 2:19-20 - *as a bridegroom rejoices over his bride, and I will betroth you to me forever*

[17] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Amos 9:13-14 • Joel 3:18 - *the mountains dropping sweet wine, and the hills flowing with milk*

**11** This beginning of his signs Jesus did in Cana of Galilee, and revealed his glory; and his disciples believed in him.[18]

**12** After this, he went down to Capernaum, he, and his mother, his brothers, and his disciples; and they stayed there a few days.

**13** The Passover of the Jews was at hand, and Jesus went up to Jerusalem.

**14** He found in the temple those who sold oxen, sheep, and doves, and the changers of money sitting.

**15** He made a whip of cords, and threw all out of the temple, both the sheep and the oxen; and he poured out the changers' money, and overthrew their tables.[19]

**16** To those who sold the doves, he said, "Take these things out of here! Don't make my Father's house a marketplace!"[20]

**17** His disciples remembered that it was written, "Zeal for your house will eat me up."[21]

**18** The Jews therefore answered him, "What sign do you show us, seeing that you do these things?"[22]

**19** Jesus answered them, "Destroy this temple, and in three days I will raise it up."[23]

**20** The Jews therefore said, "It took forty-six years to build this temple! Will you raise it up in three days?"

**21** But he spoke of the temple of his body.

**22** When therefore he was raised from the dead, his disciples remembered that he said this, and they believed the Scripture, and the word which Jesus had said.[24]

**23** Now when he was in Jerusalem at the Passover, during the feast, many believed in his name, observing his signs which he did.

**24** But Jesus didn't entrust himself to them, because he knew everyone,[25]

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[18] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Isaiah 35:1-2 • Habakkuk 2:14 - *they shall see the glory of Yahweh, and the earth filled with the knowledge of his glory*

[19] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Malachi 3:1-3 • Zechariah 14:21 - *the Lord coming suddenly to his temple to purify the sons of Levi, and no trader left in the house*

[20] **Cross-Reference:** Isaiah 56:7 • Psalm 93:5 - *my house shall be called a house of prayer, and holiness befits your house forever*

[21] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Psalm 69:9 • Psalm 69:20-21 - *zeal for your house has eaten me up, and reproach breaking the heart, with vinegar for the thirst*

[22] **Cross-Reference:** Deuteronomy 18:21-22 • Isaiah 7:11 - *how to know a word Yahweh has not spoken, and a sign asked for as deep as Sheol*

[23] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Ezekiel 37:26-27 • Hosea 6:2 - *my sanctuary set among them forever, and on the third day he will raise us up*

[24] **Cross-Reference:** Psalm 16:10 • Isaiah 28:16 - *you will not leave my soul in Sheol, and a tried stone laid as a sure foundation*

[25] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Psalm 139:1-4 • 1 Chronicles 28:9 - *you have searched me and know my thoughts from far off, and Yahweh searches all hearts*

**25** and because he didn’t need for anyone to testify concerning man; for he himself knew what was in man.[26]

[26] **Cross-Reference:** 1 Samuel 16:7 • Jeremiah 17:9-10 - *man looks at the outward appearance but Yahweh at the heart, and I search the heart and test the mind*

# CHAPTER 3 - Born From Above, a Serpent Lifted in the Wilderness, and He Must Increase

## Key Notes

- The chapter break hides a joint. Chapter 2 ends with He knew what was in man, and the next sentence introduces a man with a carefully prepared opening line (John 3:1, 2:25).
- Nicodemus is a Pharisee and a ruler - which means the Sanhedrin - and in verse 10 he is called the teacher of Israel, with the article. He is not a curious layman (John 3:1, 10).
- He comes at night. In a Gospel that runs on light and darkness, the detail is not neutral - and Nicodemus appears twice more, the last time in daylight with seventy-five pounds of spices for a burial (John 3:2, 7:50, 19:39).
- “We know” is plural. He is speaking for other people who have reached the same conclusion and have not said so out loud (John 3:2).
- The word behind born anew is anothen, which means both again and from above. Nicodemus hears the first; Yahshua means the second; and the whole exchange runs on the ambiguity. It works in Greek and not in Aramaic, which raises a fair question about what language this conversation was held in. The text does not answer it (John 3:3-4).
- “Born of water and spirit” has been read as natural birth then spiritual birth, as baptism, and as Ezekiel 36 - I will sprinkle clean water on you, and I will put my Spirit within you. The last of those is a passage the teacher of Israel would be expected to know, which fits the rebuke that follows (John 3:5, 10).
- Wind and spirit are one word in Greek, and one word in Hebrew too. The saying only works because they are the same word (John 3:8).
- “You hear its sound but don’t know where it comes from” - the wind is known by its effects and not by its origin, and so is everyone born of the Spirit (John 3:8).
- “Are you the teacher of Israel and don’t understand these things?” assumes the new birth was already there in the Hebrew Scriptures to be understood. He is not being told he missed a new doctrine; he is being told he missed his own (John 3:10).
- “Who is in heaven” at the end of verse 13 is present in many manuscripts and absent from others. The WEB prints it (John 3:13).
- The bronze serpent is Numbers 21. The people are dying of snakebite, and what God tells Moses to lift up is a snake - an image of the very thing killing them. They are not healed by looking away but by looking at it (John 3:14).
- That serpent later had to be destroyed, because Israel started burning incense to it. The cure became an idol within a few centuries (John 3:14, 2 Kings 18:4).
- “Lifted up” is hypsoo, and in this Gospel it always carries both meanings at once - lifted onto a cross, and lifted into glory. He never separates them (John 3:14, 8:28, 12:32).

- “God so loved the world” is houtos - in this way, in this manner. The verse is about how God loved, not only how much (John 3:16).
- “One and only” is monogenes - unique, one of a kind. It is a statement about there being no second, rather than about origin (John 3:16, 18).
- The judgment in verse 19 is not a sentence handed down but a preference already exercised: the light came, and men loved the darkness. The verdict is what people did with it (John 3:19).
- Where the quotation ends is a real question. The Greek has no quotation marks, and verse 15 and verse 21 are both defensible as the last words spoken to Nicodemus. The WEB closes it at 21 (John 3:15-21).
- “Jesus baptized” in verse 22 is corrected a chapter later, where John notes that in fact His disciples did the baptizing, not He Himself (John 3:22, 4:2).
- Enon near Salim, because there was much water there, is the kind of detail a traveller remembers and a theologian would not invent (John 3:23).
- “For John was not yet thrown into prison” is a quiet correction of the impression the other Gospels leave, where John’s arrest comes before the ministry begins (John 3:24).
- The friend of the bridegroom was a real office - he arranged the marriage, made the negotiations, and stood aside on the day. His whole joy is in hearing the bridegroom’s voice, which means his success is his own redundancy (John 3:29).
- “He must increase, but I must decrease” is the last thing John the Baptist says in this Gospel. He goes out on a sentence about becoming smaller (John 3:30).
- Whether verses 31 to 36 are still John speaking or the writer’s own commentary is disputed, and the text gives no marker either way (John 3:31-36).
- “The wrath of God remains on him” is a present continuous verb. The wrath is not described as arriving later; it is described as already resting, and belief is what lifts it (John 3:36).

## Key Cross-References (WEB)

| Topic | References |
|---|---|
| Born of Water and Spirit | John 3:5 • Ezekiel 36:25-27 • Jeremiah 31:33 |
| The Wind Goes Where It Wants | John 3:8 • Ecclesiastes 11:5 • Ezekiel 37:9 |
| The Teacher of Israel | John 3:10 • Isaiah 29:11-12 • Malachi 2:7 |
| The Serpent on the Pole | John 3:14 • Numbers 21:8-9 • 2 Kings 18:4 |
| Light Come Into the World | John 3:19 • Isaiah 9:2 • Job 24:13-17 |
| Nothing Received Unless Given | John 3:27 • 1 Chronicles 29:14 • Daniel 2:21 |
| The Voice of the Bridegroom | John 3:29 • Jeremiah 33:11 • Isaiah 62:5 |
| The Spirit Without Measure | John 3:34 • Isaiah 11:2 • Isaiah 61:1 |

## Prophecy Fulfilled

| Fulfillment | References |
|---|---|
| A New Heart and a New Spirit | John 3:3 • Ezekiel 11:19-20 • Deuteronomy 30:6 |
| He Who Came Down From Heaven | John 3:13 • Proverbs 30:4 • Daniel 7:13 |
| Lifted Up As the Serpent Was | John 3:14 • Numbers 21:8-9 • Isaiah 52:13 |
| He Gave His Only Son | John 3:16 • Genesis 22:2 • Isaiah 53:6 |
| Sent Not to Judge but to Save | John 3:17 • Ezekiel 33:11 • Isaiah 49:6 |
| The Bridegroom's Voice Restored | John 3:29 • Jeremiah 33:11 • Hosea 2:19-20 |
| All Things Given Into His Hand | John 3:35 • Daniel 7:14 • Psalm 8:6 |

## For Further Study

Credible external commentary that expounds on this chapter in a way consistent with a Torah-honoring, Messianic reading of the text:

- Enduring Word - John 3 Commentary (David Guzik) - Nicodemus, the new birth, and the last testimony of John the Baptist
- Life, Hope and Truth - The Gospel of John - what John means by belief, life, and being born from above
- Verse By Verse Ministry International - The Gospel of John, Lesson 3A - exposition of the night conversation with Nicodemus

## John 3 - Introduction

The chapter break hides a joint. Chapter 2 closes with the note that He knew what was in man, and the next sentence introduces a man arriving with a carefully prepared opening line. Nicodemus is a Pharisee and a ruler - which means the Sanhedrin - and a few verses later he is called the teacher of Israel, with the article. He is not a curious layman. And his we know is plural: he speaks for people who have reached a conclusion privately and are not saying so in daylight, which is why he comes at night, in a book that runs on light and dark from its first page. Though he should not be dismissed too quickly, because he appears twice more, and the last time it is in the open, at a Roman cross, carrying seventy-five pounds of burial spices while the disciples are in hiding.

The compliment is not answered. Unless one is born anothen, he cannot see the Kingdom - and the word means both again and from above. Nicodemus hears the first, which makes his question literal rather than stupid, and the whole conversation runs on the double meaning. Born of water and spirit has been read as natural birth followed by spiritual, and as baptism, but the rebuke that follows points elsewhere: are you the teacher of Israel and do not understand these things? That only makes sense if the answer was already in the book he taught from - and it is. Ezekiel promises clean water sprinkled and a new spirit put within. He is not being told he missed a new doctrine. He is being told he missed his own Scriptures.

The wind saying works only because wind and spirit are one word, in Greek and in Hebrew alike. The wind is known by what it moves rather than by where it started, and so is everyone born of the Spirit.

Then the strangest picture in the chapter. In Numbers the people are dying of snakebite, and what God tells Moses to raise on a pole is a snake - an image of the very thing killing them. They are not healed by looking away but by looking straight at it. There is a footnote to that story worth carrying: centuries later Israel was burning incense to the bronze serpent and Hezekiah had to destroy it, because the cure had become an idol. And lifted up in this Gospel always carries both senses at once - raised on a cross and raised into glory. John never separates them; in this book the cross is the throne.

Then the verse familiarity has sanded smooth. God so loved the world does not mean so much; the Greek means in this way, in this manner, and it points back at the serpent. This is how God loved - He lifted His Son where everyone dying could see Him. And the judgment that follows is not a sentence handed down but a preference already exercised: the light came, and men loved the darkness. The chapter closes with one of the most dignified paragraphs in Scripture. John's disciples come to him hurt, watching their teacher's work drain away, and he answers with the picture of the shoshbin - the friend of the bridegroom, who arranged the marriage, did the negotiating, ran the day, and then stood outside the chamber and was glad to hear the bridegroom's voice. The friend's success is his own redundancy. He must increase, but I must decrease are the last words John the Baptist speaks in this Gospel. He is given no farewell scene. He goes out on a sentence about becoming smaller.

## John 3:1-36 (WEB)

**1** Now there was a man of the Pharisees named Nicodemus, a ruler of the Jews.

**2** The same came to him by night, and said to him, "Rabbi, we know that you are a teacher come from God, for no one can do these signs that you do, unless God is with him."

**3** Jesus answered him, "Most certainly, I tell you, unless one is born anew, he can't see God's Kingdom."[27]

**4** Nicodemus said to him, "How can a man be born when he is old? Can he enter a second time into his mother's womb, and be born?"

**5** Jesus answered, "Most certainly I tell you, unless one is born of water and spirit, he can't enter into God's Kingdom.[28]

**6** That which is born of the flesh is flesh. That which is born of the Spirit is spirit.

**7** Don't marvel that I said to you, 'You must be born anew.'

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[27] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Ezekiel 11:19-20 • Deuteronomy 30:6 - *a new heart and a new spirit put within them, and Yahweh circumcising the heart so that you may live*

[28] **Cross-Reference:** Ezekiel 36:25-27 • Jeremiah 31:33 - *clean water sprinkled and a new spirit put within you, and the law written on the heart*

**8** The wind blows where it wants to, and you hear its sound, but don't know where it comes from and where it is going. So is everyone who is born of the Spirit."[29]

**9** Nicodemus answered him, "How can these things be?"

**10** Jesus answered him, "Are you the teacher of Israel, and don't understand these things?[30]

**11** Most certainly I tell you, we speak that which we know, and testify of that which we have seen, and you don't receive our witness.

**12** If I told you earthly things and you don't believe, how will you believe if I tell you heavenly things?

**13** No one has ascended into heaven, but he who descended out of heaven, the Son of Man, who is in heaven.[31]

**14** As Moses lifted up the serpent in the wilderness, even so must the Son of Man be lifted up,[32]

**15** that whoever believes in him should not perish, but have eternal life.

**16** For God so loved the world, that he gave his one and only Son, that whoever believes in him should not perish, but have eternal life.[33]

**17** For God didn't send his Son into the world to judge the world, but that the world should be saved through him.[34]

**18** He who believes in him is not judged. He who doesn't believe has been judged already, because he has not believed in the name of the one and only Son of God.

**19** This is the judgment, that the light has come into the world, and men loved the darkness rather than the light; for their works were evil.[35]

**20** For everyone who does evil hates the light, and doesn't come to the light, lest his works would be exposed.

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[29] **Cross-Reference:** Ecclesiastes 11:5 • Ezekiel 37:9 - *you don't know the way of the wind, and breath called from the four winds into the slain*

[30] **Cross-Reference:** Isaiah 29:11-12 • Malachi 2:7 - *a sealed book handed to a man who can read, and the priest's lips that should keep knowledge*

[31] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Proverbs 30:4 • Daniel 7:13 - *who has ascended into heaven and descended, and one like a son of man coming with the clouds*

[32] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Numbers 21:8-9 • Isaiah 52:13 - *the bronze serpent set on a pole so that whoever looked would live, and my servant lifted up and highly exalted*

[33] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Genesis 22:2 • Isaiah 53:6 - *take your son, your only son whom you love, and Yahweh laying on him the iniquity of us all*

[34] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Ezekiel 33:11 • Isaiah 49:6 - *I have no pleasure in the death of the wicked, and salvation to the end of the earth*

[35] **Cross-Reference:** Isaiah 9:2 • Job 24:13-17 - *a light shining on those in the shadow of death, and those who rebel against the light*

**21** But he who does the truth comes to the light, that his works may be revealed, that they have been done in God."

**22** After these things, Jesus came with his disciples into the land of Judea. He stayed there with them, and baptized.

**23** John also was baptizing in Enon near Salim, because there was much water there. They came, and were baptized.

**24** For John was not yet thrown into prison.

**25** There arose therefore a questioning on the part of John's disciples with some Jews about purification.

**26** They came to John, and said to him, "Rabbi, he who was with you beyond the Jordan, to whom you have testified, behold, the same baptizes, and everyone is coming to him."

**27** John answered, "A man can receive nothing, unless it has been given him from heaven.[36]

**28** You yourselves testify that I said, 'I am not the Christ,' but, 'I have been sent before him.'

**29** He who has the bride is the bridegroom; but the friend of the bridegroom, who stands and hears him, rejoices greatly because of the bridegroom's voice. This, my joy, therefore is made full.[37]

**30** He must increase, but I must decrease.

**31** He who comes from above is above all. He who is from the earth belongs to the earth, and speaks of the earth. He who comes from heaven is above all.

**32** What he has seen and heard, of that he testifies; and no one receives his witness.

**33** He who has received his witness has set his seal to this, that God is true.

**34** For he whom God has sent speaks the words of God; for God gives the Spirit without measure.[38]

**35** The Father loves the Son, and has given all things into his hand.[39]

**36** One who believes in the Son has eternal life, but one who disobeys the Son won't see life, but the wrath of God remains on him."

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[36] **Cross-Reference:** 1 Chronicles 29:14 • Daniel 2:21 - *all things come from you and of your own we have given you, and God who removes and sets up kings*

[37] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Jeremiah 33:11 • Isaiah 62:5 - *the voice of the bridegroom heard again in the waste places, and your God rejoicing over you*

[38] **Cross-Reference:** Isaiah 11:2 • Isaiah 61:1 - *the Spirit of Yahweh resting on him, and the Spirit of the Lord Yahweh is on me*

[39] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Daniel 7:14 • Psalm 8:6 - *dominion and glory given him that all peoples should serve him, and all things put under his feet*

## Major Themes Across John 1-3

- A Gospel that opens before Genesis rather than at a genealogy
- One word chosen because it lands in the Greek room and the Hebrew room at once
- Light that darkness could neither put out nor understand
- A Word who pitched His tent in the middle of the camp
- Chesed and emet - the words spoken over Moses - walking around in a body
- The law handed down, and grace and truth arriving in person
- A witness who refused three titles and claimed only to be a sound
- A Lamb announced without saying which lamb, because it may be all of them
- Come and see, offered twice, and no argument made anywhere in the chapter
- Found and brought - the only evangelism method in John 1
- A man with no deceit, greeted by the name of a man who had nothing else
- Jacob's ladder with a Person where the ladder used to be
- A mother's last recorded words: whatever He says to you, do it
- Six stone jars, one short of seven, filled to the brim
- Water for washing turned into wine for a wedding, and the jars never broken
- Servants who knew because they had obeyed, and a steward who did not
- A bridegroom congratulated for something he did not do
- Signs rather than mighty works - power that points past itself
- A whip used on the animals, and words used on the sellers of the poor man's dove
- My Father's house, said first and claimed as a son
- Destroy this temple, given as an imperative rather than a proposal
- Belief that He would not entrust Himself to
- A ruler who came at night and buried Him in daylight
- One word meaning both again and from above, and a conversation running on it
- A teacher of Israel told he had missed his own Scriptures
- Wind known by what it moves and not by where it began
- A cure shaped like the thing that was killing them
- Lifted up, meaning a cross and a throne in the same breath
- So loved, meaning in this way, and pointing back at a pole in the wilderness
- A judgment that is a preference rather than a sentence
- A friend of the bridegroom whose success is his own redundancy
- A great man's last recorded sentence, and it is about getting smaller

# CHAPTER 4 - A Tired Man at a Well, Living Water, and a Word That Healed From Twenty Miles

## Key Notes

- Yahshua Himself did not baptize; His disciples did. John stops to correct the rumor in the middle of a sentence (John 4:1-2).
- “He needed to pass through Samaria” uses the same small verb John uses for the Son of Man who must be lifted up and the friend who must decrease. The road through Samaria was the shortest way north, but in this Gospel that word usually means more than geography (John 4:4, 3:14, 3:30).
- Sychar sits near the ground Jacob gave to Joseph, and Joseph’s bones were buried at Shechem in that same field. This conversation happens on family land (John 4:5, Genesis 48:22, Joshua 24:32).
- He was tired. The Word who made all things got worn out walking and sat down on the edge of a well. John does not let the reader forget the flesh (John 4:6).
- “About the sixth hour” counts from sunrise, so about noon - the heat of the day, when water was not usually drawn. Some readers take it as Roman reckoning from midnight, which would make it six in the evening. Either way John wants the hour remembered (John 4:6, 19:14).
- A man and a woman meeting at a well is one of the oldest scenes in Scripture. Abraham’s servant found Rebekah at a well, Jacob met Rachel at one, Moses met Zipporah at one. Every time it leads to a marriage. And John has just finished calling Yahshua the bridegroom (John 4:7, 3:29, Genesis 24:11-14, 29:9-11).
- “Jews have no dealings with Samaritans” may be narrower in the Greek - they do not share vessels. Which is exactly what He has just asked to do. He wants a drink from her jar (John 4:9).
- The Samaritans traced back to the peoples the king of Assyria settled in the land after the northern kingdom fell, who feared Yahweh and served their own gods at the same time. Seven hundred years later the wound was still open (John 4:9, 2 Kings 17:24, 33).
- “Living water” in ordinary speech meant running water, from a spring, as opposed to water standing in a cistern. She hears plumbing. He means what Jeremiah meant when Yahweh called Himself the spring of living waters (John 4:10-11, Jeremiah 2:13).
- “Are you greater than our father Jacob?” is the first of two such questions in John. Four chapters later someone asks if He is greater than Abraham. Both times the honest answer is yes (John 4:12, 8:53).
- “A spring of water welling up” uses a verb for leaping or springing up. The water He gives does not sit still in a person (John 4:14).
- He does not shame her and He does not skip it. Go, call your husband. She answers with a half-truth, and He tells her it is true and fills in the other half. That is the whole conversation about her past (John 4:16-18).

- Some readers see the five husbands as a picture of Samaria's history, since the king of Assyria brought in peoples from five cities. It is a possible echo. The text gives no sign that she is anything but a real woman with a real history (John 4:18, 2 Kings 17:24).
- "This mountain" is Gerizim, where Moses had the blessing proclaimed, and where the Samaritans built their own temple. It had been destroyed by a Jewish king more than a century before this conversation, and they still worshipped on the ruins (John 4:20, Deuteronomy 11:29).
- He takes a side - salvation is from the Jews - and in the same breath says the side is about to stop mattering. The hour is coming when neither mountain will be the place (John 4:21-22).
- "In spirit and truth" is not inward instead of real. It is worship that answers to who God actually is. And the line most people skip: the Father is seeking such people. Worship is something He is looking for (John 4:23-24).
- The Samaritans accepted only the five books of Moses, so the Messiah they waited for was the prophet like Moses promised in Deuteronomy 18. She expects someone who will tell them everything (John 4:25, Deuteronomy 18:18).
- "I am he" is two words in Greek: ego eimi, I am. It is the first time in the Gospel He says it, and He says it to a Samaritan woman at noon (John 4:26).
- She left her water jar. She had come to draw water, and she forgot it, which tells you what kind of conversation it was (John 4:28).
- "Come, see a man who told me everything that I did" is the same invitation Philip gave Nathanael. Come and see. She becomes the first person in John to bring a whole town (John 4:29, 1:46).
- "My food is to do the will of him who sent me." The disciples went to buy lunch. He had already eaten (John 4:32-34).
- Four months from sowing to harvest was a farmer's saying. He tells them to look up, and what they would have seen coming down the road from Sychar was a crowd of Samaritans (John 4:35, 4:30).
- "Savior of the world" is said in the New Testament only here and in John's first letter. The first people in this Gospel to say it are Samaritans (John 4:42, 1 John 4:14).
- A prophet has no honor in his own country. The other Gospels use the saying of Nazareth. John places it here, as He heads back into Galilee (John 4:44).
- The nobleman is a royal official, likely in the service of Herod Antipas. Cana to Capernaum is about twenty miles, uphill all the way from the lake. He walked it to ask (John 4:46-47).
- "Unless you see signs and wonders" is plural - you all. It is spoken to the crowd as much as to the father (John 4:48).
- "The man believed the word that Jesus spoke to him, and he went his way." He believed before anything happened. The servants met him on the road the next day with the news (John 4:50-51).

- The fever left at the seventh hour, the very hour the word was spoken, from twenty miles away. Distance did not slow the word down (John 4:52-53, Psalm 107:20).
- John numbers the first two signs, both at Cana, and then stops counting. From here the reader is trusted to keep track (John 4:54, 2:11).

## Key Cross-References (WEB)

| Topic | References |
|---|---|
| Jacob's Field and Joseph's Bones | John 4:5 • Genesis 48:22 • Joshua 24:32 |
| Meetings at a Well | John 4:7 • Genesis 24:11-14 • Genesis 29:9-11 |
| Where the Samaritans Came From | John 4:9 • 2 Kings 17:24 • 2 Kings 17:33 |
| The Spring of Living Waters | John 4:10 • Jeremiah 2:13 • Jeremiah 17:13 |
| This Mountain | John 4:20 • Deuteronomy 11:29 • Deuteronomy 12:5 |
| Salvation Is From the Jews | John 4:22 • Isaiah 2:3 • Romans 9:4-5 |
| Fields White for Harvest | John 4:35 • Amos 9:13 • Matthew 9:37-38 |
| A Prophet in His Own Country | John 4:44 • Matthew 13:57 • Luke 4:24 |

## Prophecy Fulfilled

| Fulfillment | References |
|---|---|
| Water From the Wells of Salvation | John 4:14 • Isaiah 12:3 • Isaiah 44:3 |
| Worship in Every Place | John 4:23 • Malachi 1:11 • Zephaniah 3:9 |
| The Prophet Like Moses | John 4:25 • Deuteronomy 18:15 • Deuteronomy 18:18 |
| I Am He Who Speaks | John 4:26 • Isaiah 52:6 • Isaiah 43:10 |
| The Savior of the World | John 4:42 • Isaiah 49:6 • Isaiah 45:22 |
| He Sent His Word and Healed | John 4:50 • Psalm 107:20 • Isaiah 55:11 |

## For Further Study

Credible external commentary that expounds on this chapter in a way consistent with a Torah-honoring, Messianic reading of the text:

- Enduring Word - John 4 Commentary (David Guzik) - the woman at the well, worship in spirit and truth, and the nobleman's son
- Life, Hope and Truth - The Gospel of John - John's signs, the I AM sayings, and why this Gospel differs from the other three
- Verse By Verse Ministry International - The Gospel of John, Lesson 4A - exposition of the Samaritan woman and the harvest

## John 4 - Introduction

The chapter opens with the Word made flesh too tired to keep walking. It is about noon, the disciples have gone into Sychar for food, and Yahshua sits down on the edge of Jacob's well, on the land Jacob gave to Joseph. A woman comes out alone to draw water in the heat of the day, when no one draws water - the hour for someone who does not want to be talked about. And He asks her for a drink, which crosses three lines at once: Jew and Samaritan, man and woman, and a rabbi drinking from a Samaritan's jar.

He offers living water, and she hears the ordinary meaning, running spring water rather than the still water of a cistern. Asked whether He is greater than Jacob, He answers by contrasting the two waters: one that leaves a person thirsty again, and one that becomes a spring leaping up inside. She asks for it so that she will never have to come back to this well, still thinking about the walk at noon. Then He tells her to call her husband, and when she says she has none, He agrees with her and supplies what she left out. He neither shames her nor skips it.

She turns the conversation to the question of where worship belongs, Gerizim or Jerusalem, and He answers it honestly. Salvation is from the Jews; and yet the hour is coming, and now is, when the true worshippers will worship the Father in spirit and truth. The line at the center of the chapter is that the Father is seeking such people. When she speaks of the Messiah who will tell them everything, He says ego eimi - I am, the one speaking to you - the first time the phrase is spoken in John, and it is spoken to her.

She leaves her water jar and goes back into the town she had been avoiding, telling everyone to come and see a man who told her everything she ever did. The disciples urge Him to eat; He says His food is to do the will of the one who sent Him, and tells them to lift their eyes, because the fields are already white - and what is coming down the road from Sychar is a crowd of Samaritans, who end by calling Him the Savior of the world. Then in Galilee a royal official walks twenty miles to beg for his dying son and is sent home with a sentence: go, your son lives. He believes the word before he sees anything, and his servants meet him on the road. The fever left at the very hour the word was spoken.

## John 4:1-54 (WEB)

**1** Therefore when the Lord knew that the Pharisees had heard that Jesus was making and baptizing more disciples than John

**2** (although Jesus himself didn't baptize, but his disciples),

**3** he left Judea, and departed into Galilee.

**4** He needed to pass through Samaria.

**5** So he came to a city of Samaria, called Sychar, near the parcel of ground that Jacob gave to his son, Joseph.[40]

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[40] **Cross-Reference:** Genesis 48:22 • Joshua 24:32 - *Jacob giving Joseph one portion above his brothers, and Joseph's bones buried at Shechem in the field Jacob bought*

**6** Jacob's well was there. Jesus therefore, being tired from his journey, sat down by the well. It was about the sixth hour.

**7** A woman of Samaria came to draw water. Jesus said to her, "Give me a drink."[41]

**8** For his disciples had gone away into the city to buy food.

**9** The Samaritan woman therefore said to him, "How is it that you, being a Jew, ask for a drink from me, a Samaritan woman?" (For Jews have no dealings with Samaritans.)[42]

**10** Jesus answered her, "If you knew the gift of God, and who it is who says to you, 'Give me a drink,' you would have asked him, and he would have given you living water."[43]

**11** The woman said to him, "Sir, you have nothing to draw with, and the well is deep. So where do you get that living water?

**12** Are you greater than our father, Jacob, who gave us the well, and drank of it himself, as did his children, and his livestock?"

**13** Jesus answered her, "Everyone who drinks of this water will thirst again,

**14** but whoever drinks of the water that I will give him will never thirst again; but the water that I will give him will become in him a well of water springing up to eternal life."[44]

**15** The woman said to him, "Sir, give me this water, so that I don't get thirsty, neither come all the way here to draw."

**16** Jesus said to her, "Go, call your husband, and come here."

**17** The woman answered, "I have no husband." Jesus said to her, "You said well, 'I have no husband,'

**18** for you have had five husbands; and he whom you now have is not your husband. This you have said truly."

**19** The woman said to him, "Sir, I perceive that you are a prophet.

**20** Our fathers worshiped in this mountain, and you Jews say that in Jerusalem is the place where people ought to worship."[45]

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[41] **Cross-Reference:** Genesis 24:11-14 • Genesis 29:9-11 - *Abraham's servant at the well asking a woman for a drink, and Jacob meeting Rachel at the well and watering her flock*

[42] **Cross-Reference:** 2 Kings 17:24 • 2 Kings 17:33 - *the king of Assyria settling foreign peoples in Samaria, who feared Yahweh and served their own gods*

[43] **Cross-Reference:** Jeremiah 2:13 • Jeremiah 17:13 - *Yahweh the spring of living waters, forsaken for broken cisterns that hold no water*

[44] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Isaiah 12:3 • Isaiah 44:3 - *drawing water with joy from the wells of salvation, and water poured on the thirsty with the Spirit on their descendants*

[45] **Cross-Reference:** Deuteronomy 11:29 • Deuteronomy 12:5 - *the blessing set on Mount Gerizim, and the place Yahweh would choose to put his name*

**21** Jesus said to her, “Woman, believe me, the hour comes, when neither in this mountain, nor in Jerusalem, will you worship the Father.

**22** You worship that which you don’t know. We worship that which we know; for salvation is from the Jews.[46]

**23** But the hour comes, and now is, when the true worshipers will worship the Father in spirit and truth, for the Father seeks such to be his worshipers.[47]

**24** God is spirit, and those who worship him must worship in spirit and truth.”

**25** The woman said to him, “I know that Messiah comes, he who is called Christ. When he has come, he will declare to us all things.”[48]

**26** Jesus said to her, “I am he, the one who speaks to you.”[49]

**27** At this, his disciples came. They marveled that he was speaking with a woman; yet no one said, “What are you looking for?” or, “Why do you speak with her?”

**28** So the woman left her water pot, and went away into the city, and said to the people,

**29** “Come, see a man who told me everything that I did. Can this be the Christ?”

**30** They went out of the city, and were coming to him.

**31** In the meanwhile, the disciples urged him, saying, “Rabbi, eat.”

**32** But he said to them, “I have food to eat that you don’t know about.”

**33** The disciples therefore said to one another, “Has anyone brought him something to eat?”

**34** Jesus said to them, “My food is to do the will of him who sent me, and to accomplish his work.

**35** Don’t you say, ‘There are yet four months until the harvest?’ Behold, I tell you, lift up your eyes, and look at the fields, that they are white for harvest already.[50]

**36** He who reaps receives wages, and gathers fruit to eternal life; that both he who sows and he who reaps may rejoice together.

**37** For in this the saying is true, ‘One sows, and another reaps.’

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[46] **Cross-Reference:** Isaiah 2:3 • Romans 9:4-5 - *instruction going out of Zion and the word of Yahweh from Jerusalem, and the covenants and the Messiah coming through Israel*

[47] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Malachi 1:11 • Zephaniah 3:9 - *a pure offering to his name in every place among the nations, and the peoples calling on Yahweh’s name shoulder to shoulder*

[48] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Deuteronomy 18:15 • Deuteronomy 18:18 - *a prophet like Moses raised up from among their brothers, with Yahweh’s words in his mouth*

[49] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Isaiah 52:6 • Isaiah 43:10 - *my people shall know that I am he who speaks, and before me there was no God formed*

[50] **Cross-Reference:** Amos 9:13 • Matthew 9:37-38 - *the plowman overtaking the reaper, and the harvest plentiful but the laborers few*

**38** I sent you to reap that for which you haven't labored. Others have labored, and you have entered into their labor."

**39** From that city many of the Samaritans believed in him because of the word of the woman, who testified, "He told me everything that I did."

**40** So when the Samaritans came to him, they begged him to stay with them. He stayed there two days.

**41** Many more believed because of his word.

**42** They said to the woman, "Now we believe, not because of your speaking; for we have heard for ourselves, and know that this is indeed the Christ, the Savior of the world."[51]

**43** After the two days he went out from there and went into Galilee.

**44** For Jesus himself testified that a prophet has no honor in his own country.[52]

**45** So when he came into Galilee, the Galileans received him, having seen all the things that he did in Jerusalem at the feast, for they also went to the feast.

**46** Jesus came therefore again to Cana of Galilee, where he made the water into wine. There was a certain nobleman whose son was sick at Capernaum.

**47** When he heard that Jesus had come out of Judea into Galilee, he went to him, and begged him that he would come down and heal his son, for he was at the point of death.

**48** Jesus therefore said to him, "Unless you see signs and wonders, you will in no way believe."

**49** The nobleman said to him, "Sir, come down before my child dies."

**50** Jesus said to him, "Go your way. Your son lives." The man believed the word that Jesus spoke to him, and he went his way.[53]

**51** As he was now going down, his servants met him and reported, saying "Your child lives!"

**52** So he inquired of them the hour when he began to get better. They said therefore to him, "Yesterday at the seventh hour, the fever left him."

**53** So the father knew that it was at that hour in which Jesus said to him, "Your son lives." He believed, as did his whole house.

**54** This is again the second sign that Jesus did, having come out of Judea into Galilee.

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[51] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Isaiah 49:6 • Isaiah 45:22 - *a light to the nations so salvation reaches the end of the earth, and look to me and be saved, all the ends of the earth*

[52] **Cross-Reference:** Matthew 13:57 • Luke 4:24 - *a prophet is not without honor except in his own country*

[53] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Psalm 107:20 • Isaiah 55:11 - *he sends his word and heals them, and the word from his mouth does not return to him empty*

# CHAPTER 5 - Thirty-Eight Years by the Pool, a Mat on the Sabbath, and the Witnesses Called to the Stand

## Key Notes

- The feast is not named. Readers have argued for Passover, Purim, Pentecost and Tabernacles. John names nearly every other feast he mentions, so the silence may simply mean the feast is not the point (John 5:1).
- The sheep gate was the gate the priests rebuilt and sanctified in Nehemiah's day, near the temple, where animals for sacrifice came in (John 5:2, Nehemiah 3:1).
- Five porches around a pool sounded like legend to some readers for centuries. Excavations near the church of St Anne in Jerusalem uncovered a double pool with colonnades on four sides and a fifth across the middle (John 5:2).
- The end of verse 3 and all of verse 4, the angel stirring the water, are missing from the earliest manuscripts and are printed in the WEB. Whether John wrote them or a later copyist explained the scene, verse 7 shows that this is what the sick people believed (John 5:3-4, 5:7).
- Thirty-eight years is precisely the time Israel spent between Kadesh Barnea and the brook Zered, until the whole generation that refused to go in had died. John gives the number without comment (John 5:5, Deuteronomy 2:14).
- "Do you want to be made well?" is a real question, not a cruel one. Some people have built a whole life around what is wrong with them (John 5:6).
- He never says yes. He explains why nobody helps him and someone always beats him to it. The answer to a question about wanting is a story about other people (John 5:7).
- "Arise, take up your mat, and walk" is almost word for word what Yahshua says about the paralyzed man let down through the roof in Mark. The mat was a poor man's bedroll (John 5:8, Mark 2:9).
- There is no faith required of him in the story. He does not know who healed him and cannot point Him out. Grace in this chapter goes first and asks questions later (John 5:13).
- "It was the Sabbath on that day" is withheld until after the healing, which is how John makes the reader feel the turn (John 5:9).
- Jeremiah 17 does forbid carrying a burden out of the house on the Sabbath, and Nehemiah shut the gates against the traders' loads. The man's mat was his own bed, and his accusers never once ask about what had just happened to him. Yahshua does not answer with a ruling on carrying at all. He answers with who His Father is (John 5:10, 5:17, Jeremiah 17:21-22).
- "Sin no more, so that nothing worse happens to you" links this man's past to his condition in a way Yahshua refuses to do for the man born blind four chapters later. Not all suffering comes from sin. Some does (John 5:14, 9:3).
- The healed man goes straight to the authorities with the name. Whether from fear or gratitude, the text does not say, and it is fair to notice that he never thanks anyone (John 5:15).

- “My Father is still working, so I am working too.” God rested from creating on the seventh day, but He never stopped holding the world together, giving life and receiving the dead. Yahshua claims to be doing what His Father does on the Sabbath (John 5:17, Psalm 121:4).
- They understood Him perfectly. Calling God His own Father in that sense was making Himself equal with God. Nobody in the scene thinks He is claiming to be merely a good man (John 5:18, 10:33).
- “The Son can do nothing of himself” is not weakness. It is the reverse - whatever the Father does, the Son does likewise. Total dependence and total equality in the same breath (John 5:19).
- Giving life to the dead and judging the world were the two things the Hebrew Scriptures reserve for God alone. He claims both in four verses (John 5:21-22, Deuteronomy 32:39).
- “Honor the Son, even as they honor the Father.” The same honor, not a lesser one (John 5:23).
- “Has eternal life” and “has passed out of death into life” are present and past. It is not only something waiting at the end (John 5:24).
- “Because he is a son of man” is the only place in the Gospels where the phrase has no article at all - not the Son of Man, but a son of man - which is exactly how Daniel 7 puts it (John 5:27, Daniel 7:13).
- “All who are in the tombs will hear his voice” is the clearest echo in the Gospels of Daniel 12:2 - two resurrections, one to life and one to judgment, and both come out of the grave at His voice (John 5:28-29, Daniel 12:2).
- A witness who speaks only for himself was not enough under the Torah. Every matter is established by two or three witnesses, so He calls four: John, His own works, the Father, and the Scriptures (John 5:31-39, Deuteronomy 19:15).
- John was “the burning and shining lamp” - a lamp, not the light. The same distinction the prologue made (John 5:35, 1:8).
- “You search the Scriptures” can be read as a command or a statement, and either works. The point lands the same: they read the right book and missed who it was about (John 5:39-40).
- “If another comes in his own name, you will receive him.” History is full of men who did, and were (John 5:43).
- The final witness for the prosecution is Moses. The one they claimed as theirs is the one who wrote about Him (John 5:45-47, Deuteronomy 18:15).

## Key Cross-References (WEB)

| Topic | References |
|---|---|
| The Sheep Gate | John 5:2 • Nehemiah 3:1 • Nehemiah 12:39 |
| Thirty-Eight Years | John 5:5 • Deuteronomy 2:14 • Numbers 14:33 |
| Burdens and the Sabbath | John 5:10 • Jeremiah 17:21-22 • Nehemiah 13:19 |
| My Father Is Still Working | John 5:17 • Genesis 2:2-3 • Psalm 121:4 |

| Topic | References |
|---|---|
| Equal With God | John 5:18 • John 10:33 • Philippians 2:6 |
| Two or Three Witnesses | John 5:31 • Deuteronomy 19:15 • Deuteronomy 17:6 |
| You Search the Scriptures | John 5:39 • Luke 24:27 • Acts 17:11 |
| Moses Wrote About Me | John 5:46 • Deuteronomy 18:15 • Genesis 3:15 |

## Prophecy Fulfilled

| Fulfillment | References |
|---|---|
| The Lame Man Will Leap | John 5:8 • Isaiah 35:6 • Exodus 15:26 |
| The One Who Makes Alive | John 5:21 • Deuteronomy 32:39 • 1 Samuel 2:6 |
| All Judgment Given to the Son | John 5:22 • Psalm 2:12 • Isaiah 11:3-4 |
| The Dead Will Hear His Voice | John 5:25 • Ezekiel 37:4-6 • Isaiah 26:19 |
| A Son of Man | John 5:27 • Daniel 7:13-14 • Psalm 8:4-6 |
| Out of the Tombs | John 5:29 • Daniel 12:2 • Hosea 13:14 |
| A Lamp for My Anointed | John 5:35 • Psalm 132:17 • Malachi 4:5 |

## For Further Study

Credible external commentary that expounds on this chapter in a way consistent with a Torah-honoring, Messianic reading of the text:

- Enduring Word - John 5 Commentary (David Guzik) - the pool of Bethesda, the Sabbath controversy, and the witnesses to the Son
- Life, Hope and Truth - The Gospel of John - John's signs, the I AM sayings, and why this Gospel differs from the other three
- Verse By Verse Ministry International - The Gospel of John, Lesson 5A - exposition of the healing at Bethesda and the Son's equality with the Father

## John 5 - Introduction

By the sheep gate in Jerusalem lies a pool with five porches, and every porch is crowded with the sick, all watching the water. The note in verse 4 about an angel stirring it is missing from the earliest manuscripts, but whoever wrote it, verse 7 confirms that this is what the people lying there believed. One man has lain there thirty-eight years - exactly the span Israel spent between Kadesh Barnea and the brook Zered, until the generation that refused to enter the land had died. John supplies the number without comment.

Yahshua picks out one man and asks whether he wants to be made well. The man never says yes. He explains that he has no one to help him and that someone always gets there first. Thirty-eight years will build a life around what is wrong, and the question is less cruel than it sounds. Without waiting for a

better answer, Yahshua tells him to rise, take up his mat and walk, and he does. Only then does John add that it was the Sabbath.

The first words spoken to a man who has not walked in thirty-eight years concern the bed he is carrying. To be fair to the accusers, Jeremiah 17 does forbid carrying a burden out of the house on the Sabbath. But no one asks what has happened to him and no one rejoices; they step past the miracle to reach the mat. And Yahshua does not answer with a ruling on carrying. He says that His Father is working still, and so is He. God rested from creating, but He has never stopped sustaining the world, and the one who keeps Israel neither slumbers nor sleeps. His hearers understood Him exactly, and wanted Him dead for making Himself equal with God.

He does not retreat. The Son gives life to whom He wills; all judgment has been given to Him; all should honor the Son as they honor the Father. Giving life and judging the world are the two works the Hebrew Scriptures reserve for God, and He claims both, along with the hour when all who are in the tombs will hear His voice and come out, as Daniel 12 foresaw. Then, because the Torah requires two or three witnesses, He calls four: John, His works, the Father, and the Scriptures, which they search without coming to the one they testify about. The last witness is Moses, the man they counted as theirs, who wrote about Him.

## John 5:1-47 (WEB)

**1** After these things, there was a feast of the Jews, and Jesus went up to Jerusalem.

**2** Now in Jerusalem by the sheep gate, there is a pool, which is called in Hebrew, “Bethesda”, having five porches.[54]

**3** In these lay a great multitude of those who were sick, blind, lame, or paralyzed, waiting for the moving of the water;

**4** for an angel went down at certain times into the pool, and stirred up the water. Whoever stepped in first after the stirring of the water was healed of whatever disease he had.

**5** A certain man was there, who had been sick for thirty-eight years.[55]

**6** When Jesus saw him lying there, and knew that he had been sick for a long time, he asked him, “Do you want to be made well?”

**7** The sick man answered him, “Sir, I have no one to put me into the pool when the water is stirred up, but while I’m coming, another steps down before me.”

**8** Jesus said to him, “Arise, take up your mat, and walk.”[56]

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[54] **Cross-Reference:** Nehemiah 3:1 - *Eliashib the high priest and the priests building the sheep gate and sanctifying it*

[55] **Cross-Reference:** Deuteronomy 2:14 • Numbers 14:33 - *thirty-eight years from Kadesh Barnea to the brook Zered until a whole generation was gone, and the children wandering forty years*

[56] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Isaiah 35:6 • Exodus 15:26 - *the lame man leaping like a deer, and I am Yahweh who heals you*

**9** Immediately, the man was made well, and took up his mat and walked. Now it was the Sabbath on that day.

**10** So the Jews said to him who was cured, “It is the Sabbath. It is not lawful for you to carry the mat.”[57]

**11** He answered them, “He who made me well, the same said to me, ‘Take up your mat, and walk.’”

**12** Then they asked him, “Who is the man who said to you, ‘Take up your mat, and walk’?”

**13** But he who was healed didn’t know who it was, for Jesus had withdrawn, a crowd being in the place.

**14** Afterward Jesus found him in the temple, and said to him, “Behold, you are made well. Sin no more, so that nothing worse happens to you.”

**15** The man went away, and told the Jews that it was Jesus who had made him well.

**16** For this cause the Jews persecuted Jesus, and sought to kill him, because he did these things on the Sabbath.

**17** But Jesus answered them, “My Father is still working, so I am working, too.”[58]

**18** For this cause therefore the Jews sought all the more to kill him, because he not only broke the Sabbath, but also called God his own Father, making himself equal with God.

**19** Jesus therefore answered them, “Most certainly, I tell you, the Son can do nothing of himself, but what he sees the Father doing. For whatever things he does, these the Son also does likewise.

**20** For the Father has affection for the Son, and shows him all things that he himself does. He will show him greater works than these, that you may marvel.

**21** For as the Father raises the dead and gives them life, even so the Son also gives life to whom he desires.[59]

**22** For the Father judges no one, but he has given all judgment to the Son,[60]

**23** that all may honor the Son, even as they honor the Father. He who doesn’t honor the Son doesn’t honor the Father who sent him.

**24** “Most certainly I tell you, he who hears my word, and believes him who sent me, has eternal life, and doesn’t come into judgment, but has passed out of death into life.

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[57] **Cross-Reference:** Jeremiah 17:21-22 • Nehemiah 13:19 - *bear no burden on the Sabbath and carry none out of your houses, and Nehemiah shutting the gates so no load came in*

[58] **Cross-Reference:** Genesis 2:2-3 • Psalm 121:4 - *God resting on the seventh day and making it holy, and he who keeps Israel neither slumbering nor sleeping*

[59] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Deuteronomy 32:39 • 1 Samuel 2:6 - *I kill and I make alive, and Yahweh who brings down to Sheol and brings up*

[60] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Psalm 2:12 • Isaiah 11:3-4 - *homage given to the Son, and the shoot of Jesse judging the poor with righteousness*

**25** Most certainly, I tell you, the hour comes, and now is, when the dead will hear the Son of God's voice; and those who hear will live.[61]

**26** For as the Father has life in himself, even so he gave to the Son also to have life in himself.

**27** He also gave him authority to execute judgment, because he is a son of man.[62]

**28** Don't marvel at this, for the hour comes, in which all that are in the tombs will hear his voice,

**29** and will come out; those who have done good, to the resurrection of life; and those who have done evil, to the resurrection of judgment.[63]

**30** I can of myself do nothing. As I hear, I judge, and my judgment is righteous; because I don't seek my own will, but the will of my Father who sent me.

**31** "If I testify about myself, my witness is not valid.[64]

**32** It is another who testifies about me. I know that the testimony which he testifies about me is true.

**33** You have sent to John, and he has testified to the truth.

**34** But the testimony which I receive is not from man. However, I say these things that you may be saved.

**35** He was the burning and shining lamp, and you were willing to rejoice for a while in his light.[65]

**36** But the testimony which I have is greater than that of John, for the works which the Father gave me to accomplish, the very works that I do, testify about me, that the Father has sent me.

**37** The Father himself, who sent me, has testified about me. You have neither heard his voice at any time, nor seen his form.

**38** You don't have his word living in you; because you don't believe him whom he sent.

**39** "You search the Scriptures, because you think that in them you have eternal life; and these are they which testify about me.[66]

**40** Yet you will not come to me, that you may have life.

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[61] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Ezekiel 37:4-6 • Isaiah 26:19 - *dry bones told to hear the word of Yahweh and live, and your dead shall live and arise*

[62] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Daniel 7:13-14 • Psalm 8:4-6 - *one like a son of man given dominion and a kingdom, and the son of man crowned with glory and given rule*

[63] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Daniel 12:2 • Hosea 13:14 - *many who sleep in the dust awakening, some to everlasting life and some to shame, and a ransom from the power of Sheol*

[64] **Cross-Reference:** Deuteronomy 19:15 • Deuteronomy 17:6 - *every matter established at the mouth of two or three witnesses*

[65] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Psalm 132:17 • Malachi 4:5 - *a lamp ordained for my anointed, and Elijah sent before the day of Yahweh*

[66] **Cross-Reference:** Luke 24:27 • Acts 17:11 - *beginning from Moses and all the prophets he explained the things concerning himself, and the Bereans examining the Scriptures daily*

**41** I don’t receive glory from men.

**42** But I know you, that you don’t have God’s love in yourselves.

**43** I have come in my Father’s name, and you don’t receive me. If another comes in his own name, you will receive him.

**44** How can you believe, who receive glory from one another, and you don’t seek the glory that comes from the only God?

**45** “Don’t think that I will accuse you to the Father. There is one who accuses you, even Moses, on whom you have set your hope.

**46** For if you believed Moses, you would believe me; for he wrote about me.[67]

**47** But if you don’t believe his writings, how will you believe my words?”

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[67] **Cross-Reference:** Deuteronomy 18:15 • Genesis 3:15 *- a prophet like Moses to whom you shall listen, and the seed of the woman who bruises the serpent’s head*

# CHAPTER 6 - Five Barley Loaves, I AM on the Water, and the Bread That Came Down From Heaven

## Key Notes

- John alone calls the lake the Sea of Tiberias, after the city Herod Antipas built on its shore and named for the emperor. His readers knew it by that name (John 6:1, 21:1).
- “The Passover, the feast of the Jews, was at hand.” This is the second Passover John marks, and everything in the chapter happens in its shadow: bread, a crossing of water, and manna in the wilderness (John 6:4, 2:13, 11:55).
- He asks Philip where to buy bread, and John adds that He already knew what He would do. Philip was from Bethsaida, the nearest town. It was a test, and Philip answers it with arithmetic (John 6:5-7, 1:44).
- Two hundred denarii was about two hundred days’ wages for a laborer, most of a year’s pay, and Philip says it would not be enough for everyone to get a little (John 6:7, Matthew 20:2).
- Moses asked almost the same question in the wilderness. Where could I get meat to give all these people? Would all the fish of the sea be enough? (John 6:5, Numbers 11:13, 11:22).
- Only John says the loaves were barley, the cheap bread of the poor, and only John mentions the boy who had them. Elisha once fed a hundred men with twenty barley loaves and had some left over (John 6:9, 2 Kings 4:42-44).
- “There was much grass in the place” - spring, as Passover would be. Mark says green grass. Small details like this are how eyewitness memory reads (John 6:10, Mark 6:39).
- “Gather up the broken pieces which are left over, that nothing be lost.” The same word, lost, is used about two dozen verses later for the people the Father gives Him: of all He has given Me, I should lose nothing (John 6:12, 6:39).
- Twelve baskets left - one for each of the twelve who had just watched the arithmetic fail (John 6:13).
- “This is truly the prophet who comes into the world” is the prophet like Moses of Deuteronomy 18. They had just watched bread appear in the wilderness, which is exactly what you would expect a new Moses to do (John 6:14, Deuteronomy 18:15).
- They wanted to take Him by force and make Him king. He withdrew to the mountain alone. A crown offered by a full stomach is not the kingdom (John 6:15).
- Twenty-five or thirty stadia is three or four miles - the middle of the lake, at night, rowing into the wind (John 6:19).
- In the Hebrew Scriptures the one who walks on the waves of the sea is God. Job says He alone treads on them. The psalm says His way was through the sea and His footsteps were not seen (John 6:19, Job 9:8, Psalm 77:19).

- “It is I” is ego eimi again, the same two words He spoke to the woman at the well. On the water in the dark they carry their full weight: I AM. Don’t be afraid (John 6:20, 4:26).
- “Immediately the boat was at the land where they were going.” John gives no explanation and does not need one (John 6:21, Psalm 107:30).
- “You seek me, not because you saw signs, but because you ate of the loaves.” They had the bread and missed the sign. The bread was the point to them; it was the pointer to Him (John 6:26).
- “Him the Father, God, has sealed” uses the image of a seal pressed into wax, the mark that proves who owns or sent something (John 6:27).
- What must we do to do the works of God? The answer is one work, singular: believe in the one He sent (John 6:28-29).
- They ask for a sign after watching five thousand eat. Then they quote the manna. Moses gave our fathers bread from heaven. They are asking Him to top it (John 6:30-31, Psalm 78:24).
- He corrects three things in one sentence: it was not Moses, it was My Father; not gave, but gives; and the true bread is not something but someone (John 6:32-33).
- “I am the bread of life” is the first of seven I AM sayings with a picture attached: bread, light, door, good shepherd, resurrection, way, vine (John 6:35, 8:12, 10:9, 10:11, 11:25, 14:6, 15:1).
- “Him who comes to me I will in no way throw out.” The Greek doubles the negative. Never, under any circumstances (John 6:37).
- “I will raise him up at the last day” is said four times in this chapter. Whatever else this bread means, it ends in resurrection (John 6:39, 40, 44, 54).
- The Jews murmured, which is the wilderness word. Israel murmured against Moses over the bread, and Moses told them their murmuring was against Yahweh (John 6:41, Exodus 16:8).
- “They will all be taught by God” is Isaiah 54. The drawing of the Father is not a feeling but a teaching, and those who learn come (John 6:44-45, Isaiah 54:13).
- From verse 54 on, the verb for eat changes to one that means to chew or gnaw. He does not soften the image when they object. He makes it harder (John 6:54-58).
- Drinking blood was forbidden from Noah onward, because the life is in the blood. To a Jewish ear this is the most offensive thing He could say - unless He is saying that His life is the life given for theirs (John 6:53, Leviticus 17:11).
- “The Spirit gives life; the flesh profits nothing. The words that I speak to you are spirit, and are life.” The way into the hard saying is through the words, not around them (John 6:63).
- Many of His disciples turned back and walked with Him no more. They did not stop believing in God. They stopped walking with Him (John 6:66).
- “You have the words of eternal life” is the answer to the words that drove everyone else away. Peter does not say he understands. He says there is nowhere else to go (John 6:68).

- "The Holy One of God" is the title a demon shouted in the synagogue at Capernaum. Here a disciple says it on purpose (John 6:69, Mark 1:24).
- He chose twelve and one of them is a devil. Judas was chosen too, and stayed through all of it (John 6:70-71).

## Key Cross-References (WEB)

| Topic | References |
|---|---|
| Where Shall We Buy Bread? | John 6:5 • Numbers 11:13 • Numbers 11:22 |
| Barley Loaves for a Crowd | John 6:9 • 2 Kings 4:42-44 |
| Satisfied, With Some Left Over | John 6:12 • Ruth 2:14 • Exodus 16:19-20 |
| Bread From Heaven | John 6:31 • Exodus 16:4 • Psalm 78:24-25 |
| Murmuring in the Wilderness | John 6:41 • Exodus 16:8 • Numbers 11:1 |
| All Taught by God | John 6:45 • Isaiah 54:13 • Jeremiah 31:34 |
| The Life Is in the Blood | John 6:53 • Leviticus 17:11 • Genesis 9:4 |
| To Whom Would We Go? | John 6:68 • Psalm 73:25 • Deuteronomy 32:47 |

## Prophecy Fulfilled

| Fulfillment | References |
|---|---|
| The Prophet Who Comes Into the World | John 6:14 • Deuteronomy 18:15 • Deuteronomy 18:18 |
| He Treads on the Waves of the Sea | John 6:19 • Job 9:8 • Psalm 77:19 |
| I Am, Do Not Be Afraid | John 6:20 • Exodus 3:14 • Isaiah 43:2 |
| The Bread of Life | John 6:35 • Isaiah 55:1-2 • Deuteronomy 8:3 |
| Raised Up at the Last Day | John 6:40 • Isaiah 26:19 • Job 19:25-26 |
| Flesh Given for the Life of the World | John 6:51 • Isaiah 53:5 • Isaiah 53:12 |
| The Holy One of God | John 6:69 • Psalm 16:10 • Isaiah 49:7 |

## For Further Study

Credible external commentary that expounds on this chapter in a way consistent with a Torah-honoring, Messianic reading of the text:

- Enduring Word - John 6 Commentary (David Guzik) - the feeding of the five thousand, the walk on the water, and the bread of life discourse
- Life, Hope and Truth - The Gospel of John - John's signs, the I AM sayings, and why this Gospel differs from the other three

- Verse By Verse Ministry International - The Gospel of John, Lesson 6A - exposition of the feeding of the five thousand and the manna background

## John 6 - Introduction

Passover is near, and the chapter moves through the shape of the Exodus: bread in the wilderness, a crossing of water, murmuring, and manna. A great crowd follows Yahshua around the lake, and He asks Philip where they could buy bread for them all, knowing already what He would do. Philip answers the test with arithmetic - two hundred denarii, most of a year's wages, would not give everyone a bite - the same despairing sum Moses did in the wilderness when he asked where he could find meat for all the people. Andrew finds a boy with five barley loaves, the bread of the poor, and two fish, and asks what that could be among so many.

The people sit down on the spring grass, five thousand men, and eat as much as they want. Then comes the command to gather the fragments so that nothing is lost - the same word He will use of the people the Father gives Him, of whom He will lose nothing. The way He treats bread is the way He treats people. Twelve baskets remain. The crowd rightly recognises the prophet like Moses and then tries to seize Him and make Him king, and He withdraws alone to the mountain rather than accept a crown from people whose stomachs are full.

That night the disciples, rowing into a storm in the middle of the lake, see Him walking on the sea, which in the Hebrew Scriptures is what God alone does. He calls out ego eimi - it is I, and for anyone who knows the burning bush, I AM - and the moment they take Him aboard they reach the shore. The next day the crowd finds Him and He tells them plainly that they came for the bread, not the sign. They ask for a sign anyway and invoke the manna, and He answers that it was never Moses who gave bread from heaven, that His Father gives the true bread, and that He is that bread.

They murmur, as their fathers did, and instead of softening the saying He sharpens it: unless they eat His flesh and drink His blood they have no life in them. Blood was forbidden from Noah onward because the life is in the blood, and that is exactly the point - He is offering His life for theirs. When they object He changes the verb to one that means to chew. Many disciples turn back, and He asks the twelve whether they will go too. Peter does not claim to understand. He says there is nowhere else to go, because Yahshua has the words of eternal life.

## John 6:1-71 (WEB)

**1** After these things, Jesus went away to the other side of the sea of Galilee, which is also called the Sea of Tiberias.

**2** A great multitude followed him, because they saw his signs which he did on those who were sick.

**3** Jesus went up into the mountain, and he sat there with his disciples.

**4** Now the Passover, the feast of the Jews, was at hand.

**5** Jesus therefore lifting up his eyes, and seeing that a great multitude was coming to him, said to Philip, “Where are we to buy bread, that these may eat?”[68]

**6** This he said to test him, for he himself knew what he would do.

**7** Philip answered him, “Two hundred denarii worth of bread is not sufficient for them, that everyone of them may receive a little.”

**8** One of his disciples, Andrew, Simon Peter’s brother, said to him,

**9** “There is a boy here who has five barley loaves and two fish, but what are these among so many?”[69]

**10** Jesus said, “Have the people sit down.” Now there was much grass in that place. So the men sat down, in number about five thousand.

**11** Jesus took the loaves; and having given thanks, he distributed to the disciples, and the disciples to those who were sitting down; likewise also of the fish as much as they desired.

**12** When they were filled, he said to his disciples, “Gather up the broken pieces which are left over, that nothing be lost.”[70]

**13** So they gathered them up, and filled twelve baskets with broken pieces from the five barley loaves, which were left over by those who had eaten.

**14** When therefore the people saw the sign which Jesus did, they said, “This is truly the prophet who comes into the world.”[71]

**15** Jesus therefore, perceiving that they were about to come and take him by force, to make him king, withdrew again to the mountain by himself.

**16** When evening came, his disciples went down to the sea,

**17** and they entered into the boat, and were going over the sea to Capernaum. It was now dark, and Jesus had not come to them.

**18** The sea was tossed by a great wind blowing.

**19** When therefore they had rowed about twenty-five or thirty stadia, they saw Jesus walking on the sea, and drawing near to the boat; and they were afraid.[72]

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[68] **Cross-Reference:** Numbers 11:13 • Numbers 11:22 - *Moses asking where he could get meat for all the people, and whether all the fish of the sea would be enough*

[69] **Cross-Reference:** 2 Kings 4:42-44 - *twenty barley loaves set before a hundred men, and they ate and left some over, according to Yahweh’s word*

[70] **Cross-Reference:** Ruth 2:14 • Exodus 16:19-20 - *Ruth eating until she was satisfied and having some left, and the manna kept overnight that bred worms*

[71] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Deuteronomy 18:15 • Deuteronomy 18:18 - *a prophet like Moses raised up from among their brothers, with Yahweh’s words in his mouth*

[72] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Job 9:8 • Psalm 77:19 - *he alone treads on the waves of the sea, and your way was through the sea with footsteps not known*

**20** But he said to them, “It is I. Don’t be afraid.”[73]

**21** They were willing therefore to receive him into the boat. Immediately the boat was at the land where they were going.

**22** On the next day, the multitude that stood on the other side of the sea saw that there was no other boat there, except the one in which his disciples had embarked, and that Jesus hadn’t entered with his disciples into the boat, but his disciples had gone away alone.

**23** However boats from Tiberias came near to the place where they ate the bread after the Lord had given thanks.

**24** When the multitude therefore saw that Jesus wasn’t there, nor his disciples, they themselves got into the boats, and came to Capernaum, seeking Jesus.

**25** When they found him on the other side of the sea, they asked him, “Rabbi, when did you come here?”

**26** Jesus answered them, “Most certainly I tell you, you seek me, not because you saw signs, but because you ate of the loaves, and were filled.

**27** Don’t work for the food which perishes, but for the food which remains to eternal life, which the Son of Man will give to you. For God the Father has sealed him.”

**28** They said therefore to him, “What must we do, that we may work the works of God?”

**29** Jesus answered them, “This is the work of God, that you believe in him whom he has sent.”

**30** They said therefore to him, “What then do you do for a sign, that we may see, and believe you? What work do you do?

**31** Our fathers ate the manna in the wilderness. As it is written, ‘He gave them bread out of heaven to eat.’”[74]

**32** Jesus therefore said to them, “Most certainly, I tell you, it wasn’t Moses who gave you the bread out of heaven, but my Father gives you the true bread out of heaven.

**33** For the bread of God is that which comes down out of heaven, and gives life to the world.”

**34** They said therefore to him, “Lord, always give us this bread.”

**35** Jesus said to them, “I am the bread of life. He who comes to me will not be hungry, and he who believes in me will never be thirsty.[75]

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[73] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Exodus 3:14 • Isaiah 43:2 - *I AM WHO I AM, and when you pass through the waters I will be with you*

[74] **Cross-Reference:** Exodus 16:4 • Psalm 78:24-25 - *bread rained from heaven for the people, and the grain of heaven, the bread of angels*

[75] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Isaiah 55:1-2 • Deuteronomy 8:3 - *come, buy and eat without money, and man does not live by bread only but by every word from Yahweh’s mouth*

**36** But I told you that you have seen me, and yet you don't believe.

**37** All those whom the Father gives me will come to me. He who comes to me I will in no way throw out.

**38** For I have come down from heaven, not to do my own will, but the will of him who sent me.

**39** This is the will of my Father who sent me, that of all he has given to me I should lose nothing, but should raise him up at the last day.

**40** This is the will of the one who sent me, that everyone who sees the Son, and believes in him, should have eternal life; and I will raise him up at the last day."[76]

**41** The Jews therefore murmured concerning him, because he said, "I am the bread which came down out of heaven."[77]

**42** They said, "Isn't this Jesus, the son of Joseph, whose father and mother we know? How then does he say, 'I have come down out of heaven?'"

**43** Therefore Jesus answered them, "Don't murmur among yourselves.

**44** No one can come to me unless the Father who sent me draws him, and I will raise him up in the last day.

**45** It is written in the prophets, 'They will all be taught by God.' Therefore everyone who hears from the Father, and has learned, comes to me.[78]

**46** Not that anyone has seen the Father, except he who is from God. He has seen the Father.

**47** Most certainly, I tell you, he who believes in me has eternal life.

**48** I am the bread of life.

**49** Your fathers ate the manna in the wilderness, and they died.

**50** This is the bread which comes down out of heaven, that anyone may eat of it and not die.

**51** I am the living bread which came down out of heaven. If anyone eats of this bread, he will live forever. Yes, the bread which I will give for the life of the world is my flesh."[79]

**52** The Jews therefore contended with one another, saying, "How can this man give us his flesh to eat?"

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[76] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Isaiah 26:19 • Job 19:25-26 - *your dead shall live and arise, and my Redeemer standing on the earth at the last, seen in my flesh*

[77] **Cross-Reference:** Exodus 16:8 • Numbers 11:1 - *your murmurings are not against us but against Yahweh, and the people complaining in the ears of Yahweh*

[78] **Cross-Reference:** Isaiah 54:13 • Jeremiah 31:34 - *all your children taught by Yahweh, and they shall all know me, from the least to the greatest*

[79] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Isaiah 53:5 • Isaiah 53:12 - *pierced for our transgressions and healed by his wounds, and pouring out his soul to death to bear the sin of many*

**53** Jesus therefore said to them, “Most certainly I tell you, unless you eat the flesh of the Son of Man and drink his blood, you don’t have life in yourselves.[80]

**54** He who eats my flesh and drinks my blood has eternal life, and I will raise him up at the last day.

**55** For my flesh is food indeed, and my blood is drink indeed.

**56** He who eats my flesh and drinks my blood lives in me, and I in him.

**57** As the living Father sent me, and I live because of the Father; so he who feeds on me, he will also live because of me.

**58** This is the bread which came down out of heaven—not as our fathers ate the manna, and died. He who eats this bread will live forever.”

**59** He said these things in the synagogue, as he taught in Capernaum.

**60** Therefore many of his disciples, when they heard this, said, “This is a hard saying! Who can listen to it?”

**61** But Jesus knowing in himself that his disciples murmured at this, said to them, “Does this cause you to stumble?

**62** Then what if you would see the Son of Man ascending to where he was before?

**63** It is the spirit who gives life. The flesh profits nothing. The words that I speak to you are spirit, and are life.

**64** But there are some of you who don’t believe.” For Jesus knew from the beginning who they were who didn’t believe, and who it was who would betray him.

**65** He said, “For this cause I have said to you that no one can come to me, unless it is given to him by my Father.”

**66** At this, many of his disciples went back, and walked no more with him.

**67** Jesus said therefore to the twelve, “You don’t also want to go away, do you?”

**68** Simon Peter answered him, “Lord, to whom would we go? You have the words of eternal life.[81]

**69** We have come to believe and know that you are the Christ, the Son of the living God.”[82]

**70** Jesus answered them, “Didn’t I choose you, the twelve, and one of you is a devil?”

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[80] **Cross-Reference:** Leviticus 17:11 • Genesis 9:4 - *the life of the flesh is in the blood, given on the altar to make atonement, and flesh with its blood you shall not eat*

[81] **Cross-Reference:** Psalm 73:25 • Deuteronomy 32:47 - *whom do I have in heaven but you, and the word that is no vain thing because it is your life*

[82] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Psalm 16:10 • Isaiah 49:7 - *you will not let your holy one see corruption, and the Holy One of Israel who has chosen you*

**71** Now he spoke of Judas, the son of Simon Iscariot, for it was he who would betray him, being one of the twelve.

## Major Themes Across John 4-6

- The Word made flesh, tired enough to sit down on the edge of a well
- A road through Samaria that He needed to take, and a woman He went to find
- Three walls crossed with one request for a drink
- Living water mistaken for plumbing, and offered anyway
- A past named without shame and without being skipped
- Worship that is no longer a question of which mountain
- A Father who goes looking for worshippers
- I am He, said first to a Samaritan woman at noon
- A water jar left behind by someone who found a well
- A whole town brought by the person who had been avoiding it
- Food the disciples did not know about: doing the will of the one who sent Him
- Fields already white, and Samaritans coming down the road
- The Savior of the world, named first by outsiders
- A father who believed a sentence before he saw anything
- A word that healed from twenty miles away at the very hour it was spoken
- Thirty-eight years by a pool, the length of a wilderness generation
- Do you want to be made well, answered with a reason instead of a yes
- Grace that went first and asked questions later
- Accusers who walked past a miracle to get to a mat
- A Father who never stops working, and a Son who does what He does
- Equality with God, understood perfectly by those who rejected it
- Life and judgment, the two works only God does, claimed by the Son
- All who are in the tombs hearing His voice
- Four witnesses called, because the Torah requires more than one
- Searching the Scriptures and missing the Person they are about
- Moses, called as the final witness against those who claimed him
- A boy’s barley lunch in the hands of the one who made the grain
- Fragments gathered so that nothing is lost, as He loses none of His
- A crown refused because it was offered by full stomachs
- The one who treads on the waves of the sea, saying I AM in the dark
- Bread wanted, sign missed, and the Giver overlooked
- Not Moses but My Father, not gave but gives, not something but someone

- A hard saying made harder rather than softer
- The life in the blood, offered for the life of the world
- Will you also go away, and nowhere else to go

# CHAPTER 7 - Brothers Who Did Not Believe, a Shout on the Last Day, and Rivers of Living Water

## Key Notes

- He stayed in Galilee because the Judeans were looking to kill Him. Chapter 5 ended with a death plot, and it is still in the air (John 7:1, 5:18).
- Tabernacles was the feast of tents, seven days of rejoicing after the harvest was in, with the whole household - servants, foreigners, widows and orphans included - living in booths. It was the most crowded week of the year in Jerusalem (John 7:2, Leviticus 23:34, Deuteronomy 16:13-14).
- “Even his brothers didn’t believe in him.” These are the brothers who grew up in the same house. One of them, James, later led the assembly in Jerusalem and wrote a letter in the New Testament. Unbelief at the dinner table is not the end of the story (John 7:5, 1 Corinthians 15:7).
- Their advice is pure public relations: nobody does things in secret if he wants to be known, so show yourself to the world. It is the same logic as the wilderness temptation - prove it in public (John 7:3-4).
- “My time has not yet come” is a different word from “my hour.” It means the right moment, the opportune season. Theirs, He says, is always ready, because nothing they do costs them anything (John 7:6).
- “I am not yet going up to this feast” - and then He goes. Some manuscripts read “not yet,” others simply “not.” Either way He refuses to go on their terms, as a public show, and goes later on His own (John 7:8-10).
- The crowd murmurs, which is the wilderness word again, and is split between “he is a good man” and “he leads the multitude astray.” Nobody says it out loud, for fear (John 7:12-13).
- “How does this man know letters, having never been educated?” He had not studied under a recognised rabbi. They meant: where did He get His authority? He answers: from the one who sent Me (John 7:15-16).
- “If anyone desires to do his will, he will know about the teaching.” Obedience comes before understanding here, not after it. You find out whether it is true by being willing to do it (John 7:17).
- “Didn’t Moses give you the law, and yet none of you keeps the law?” He is not attacking the Torah. He is accusing them of breaking it, by plotting murder while defending the Sabbath (John 7:19).
- Circumcision on the eighth day went ahead even when the eighth day fell on a Sabbath, because the instruction about the eighth day came first. His argument: if you can perform a covenant act on one part of a man on the Sabbath, why be angry that I made the whole man well? (John 7:22-23, Leviticus 12:3).

- “Don’t judge according to appearance, but judge righteous judgment” is almost a quotation of Deuteronomy 16, the charge given to every judge in Israel (John 7:24, Deuteronomy 16:18).
- “When the Christ comes, no one will know where he comes from” reflects an expectation that the Messiah would appear suddenly and unknown. They think they know where He is from. They are only half right (John 7:27-28).
- “Where I am, you can’t come” is said to His enemies here, and later to His friends at the last supper - with a promise added for the friends that is not given to the enemies (John 7:34, 13:33, 14:3).
- “The dispersion among the Greeks” means the Jews living scattered across the Greek-speaking world. They mean it as a sneer. John’s readers knew the message did exactly that (John 7:35).
- The last and greatest day of the feast is either the seventh day, when the water ceremony reached its height, or the eighth day, the solemn assembly Moses added to the end. Readers have argued both for a long time. The Torah gives the eighth day its own holy convocation (John 7:37, Leviticus 23:36).
- Each morning of Tabernacles, a priest carried water from the pool of Siloam up to the temple and poured it out at the altar while the people sang. That ceremony is described in later Jewish writings rather than in the Torah, but it is the background that makes the shout land: on that day, at that feast, He offers water (John 7:37, Isaiah 12:3).
- “He stood and cried out” - teachers normally sat. This was a man standing up in the temple court and shouting (John 7:37).
- “As the Scripture has said” points to no single verse. The nearest are Zechariah 14, living waters going out from Jerusalem, and Ezekiel 47, water flowing from under the threshold of the temple - both prophecies associated with this very feast (John 7:38, Zechariah 14:8, Ezekiel 47:1).
- “From within him” can be read two ways: out of the believer, or out of the Messiah Himself. John’s next sentence, about the Spirit, suggests the source is Him and the channel is us (John 7:38-39).
- “The Holy Spirit was not yet given, because Jesus wasn’t yet glorified.” John is writing from the far side of the cross, and he tells you so (John 7:39).
- Some in the crowd object that the Christ comes from Bethlehem, of the seed of David. John reports it without comment - because every one of his readers knew where He was born (John 7:42, Micah 5:2).
- “No man ever spoke like this man!” The officers were sent to arrest Him and came back arrested by what they heard (John 7:46).
- “This multitude that doesn’t know the law is cursed.” The leaders’ contempt for ordinary people is said out loud (John 7:49).
- Nicodemus, who came by night in chapter 3, now speaks up in daylight, on a point of Torah: do we judge a man before hearing him? It is a small step, and it costs him (John 7:50-51, Deuteronomy 1:16-17).

- “No prophet has arisen out of Galilee” is simply not true. Jonah was from Gath Hepher, a town in Galilee in the territory of Zebulun. In their anger the experts forgot their own Scriptures (John 7:52, 2 Kings 14:25).
- The story of the woman taken in adultery, which follows, is missing from the earliest Greek manuscripts of John and turns up in different places in later ones. Most readers believe it is a true story about Yahshua, preserved separately; the WEB prints it here (John 7:53).

## Key Cross-References (WEB)

| Topic | References |
|---|---|
| The Feast of Tents | John 7:2 • Leviticus 23:34 • Deuteronomy 16:13-14 |
| Willing to Do His Will | John 7:17 • Psalm 25:14 • Deuteronomy 29:29 |
| Circumcision on the Eighth Day | John 7:22 • Genesis 17:12 • Leviticus 12:3 |
| Judge With Righteous Judgment | John 7:24 • Deuteronomy 16:18-19 • Leviticus 19:15 |
| The Last Day of the Feast | John 7:37 • Leviticus 23:36 • Numbers 29:35 |
| Come to the Waters | John 7:37 • Isaiah 55:1 • Isaiah 12:3 |
| A Hearing Before Judgment | John 7:51 • Deuteronomy 1:16-17 • Deuteronomy 17:4 |
| A Prophet From Galilee | John 7:52 • 2 Kings 14:25 • Joshua 19:13 |

## Prophecy Fulfilled

| Fulfillment | References |
|---|---|
| A Stranger to His Brothers | John 7:5 • Psalm 69:8 • Genesis 37:4 |
| The Teaching of the One Who Sent Him | John 7:16 • Deuteronomy 18:18 • Isaiah 11:2 |
| Rivers of Living Water | John 7:38 • Zechariah 14:8 • Ezekiel 47:1 |
| The Spirit Poured Out | John 7:39 • Joel 2:28 • Isaiah 44:3 |
| The Prophet | John 7:40 • Deuteronomy 18:15 |
| From Bethlehem, of the Seed of David | John 7:42 • Micah 5:2 • 2 Samuel 7:12 |
| Grace Poured on His Lips | John 7:46 • Psalm 45:2 • Isaiah 50:4 |

## For Further Study

Credible external commentary that expounds on this chapter in a way consistent with a Torah-honoring, Messianic reading of the text:

- Enduring Word - John 7 Commentary (David Guzik) - the Feast of Tabernacles, the division over Yahshua, and rivers of living water
- Life, Hope and Truth - The Gospel of John - John’s signs, the I AM sayings, and why this Gospel differs from the other three

- Verse By Verse Ministry International - The Gospel of John, Lesson 7A - exposition of Yahshua at the Feast of Tabernacles

## John 7 - Introduction

The chapter is set at Tabernacles, the most joyful week in the calendar: the harvest gathered, whole households living in booths, the branches waved, and Israel rejoicing before Yahweh in memory of the wilderness. It opens with His brothers mocking Him, urging Him to go and perform in public, because no one who wants to be known works in secret. John says plainly that even His brothers did not believe in Him - the boys raised in the same house - though one of them, James, would later lead the assembly in Jerusalem.

He tells them His time has not yet come, and that theirs is always ready, because nothing they do costs them anything. Then He goes up quietly and on His own terms. Jerusalem is murmuring about Him, divided between a good man and a deceiver, and no one speaks openly for fear. Halfway through the feast He begins teaching in the temple, and the experts ask how a man who never studied under a rabbi knows so much. His teaching, He says, belongs to the one who sent Him, and anyone willing to do God's will will know whether it is true - understanding following obedience rather than preceding it.

Then He turns the accusation around. Moses gave them the Torah and none of them keeps it, since they are plotting a murder while defending the Sabbath. They circumcise on the Sabbath because the eighth day takes precedence; why be angry that He made a whole man well? Judge not by appearance but with righteous judgment, He says, quoting the charge Deuteronomy gives every judge in Israel.

On the last and greatest day of the feast - in a week when, by later Jewish accounts, water was carried each morning from Siloam and poured out at the altar - He stands and cries out that anyone who thirsts should come to Him and drink, and that rivers of living water will flow from within. Zechariah's living waters from Jerusalem and Ezekiel's river from beneath the temple are both prophecies tied to this feast, and He claims them. John explains that He meant the Spirit, not yet given. The crowd divides over whether the Christ can come from Galilee, unaware of Bethlehem. The officers sent to arrest Him return saying no one ever spoke like this man. Nicodemus, who came by night, asks in daylight for a fair hearing, and is told that no prophet comes from Galilee - which forgets that Jonah came from Gath Hepher.

## John 7:1-53 (WEB)

**1** After these things, Jesus was walking in Galilee, for he wouldn't walk in Judea, because the Jews sought to kill him.

**2** Now the feast of the Jews, the Feast of Booths, was at hand.[83]

**3** His brothers therefore said to him, "Depart from here, and go into Judea, that your disciples also may see your works which you do.

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[83] **Cross-Reference:** Leviticus 23:34 • Deuteronomy 16:13-14 - *the feast of tents for seven days in the seventh month, kept with rejoicing by the whole household and the stranger*

**4** For no one does anything in secret, and himself seeks to be known openly. If you do these things, reveal yourself to the world."

**5** For even his brothers didn't believe in him.[84]

**6** Jesus therefore said to them, "My time has not yet come, but your time is always ready.

**7** The world can't hate you, but it hates me, because I testify about it, that its works are evil.

**8** You go up to the feast. I am not yet going up to this feast, because my time is not yet fulfilled."

**9** Having said these things to them, he stayed in Galilee.

**10** But when his brothers had gone up to the feast, then he also went up, not publicly, but as it were in secret.

**11** The Jews therefore sought him at the feast, and said, "Where is he?"

**12** There was much murmuring among the multitudes concerning him. Some said, "He is a good man." Others said, "Not so, but he leads the multitude astray."

**13** Yet no one spoke openly of him for fear of the Jews.

**14** But when it was now the middle of the feast, Jesus went up into the temple and taught.

**15** The Jews therefore marveled, saying, "How does this man know letters, having never been educated?"

**16** Jesus therefore answered them, "My teaching is not mine, but his who sent me.[85]

**17** If anyone desires to do his will, he will know about the teaching, whether it is from God, or if I am speaking from myself.[86]

**18** He who speaks from himself seeks his own glory, but he who seeks the glory of him who sent him is true, and no unrighteousness is in him.

**19** Didn't Moses give you the law, and yet none of you keeps the law? Why do you seek to kill me?"

**20** The multitude answered, "You have a demon! Who seeks to kill you?"

**21** Jesus answered them, "I did one work, and you all marvel because of it.

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[84] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Psalm 69:8 • Genesis 37:4 - *a stranger to my brothers and an alien to my mother's children, and Joseph's brothers who could not speak peaceably to him*

[85] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Deuteronomy 18:18 • Isaiah 11:2 - *my words in his mouth, and he shall speak all that I command him, and the Spirit of wisdom and understanding resting on him*

[86] **Cross-Reference:** Psalm 25:14 • Deuteronomy 29:29 - *the friendship of Yahweh is with those who fear him, and the things revealed belong to us, that we may do all the words*

**22** Moses has given you circumcision (not that it is of Moses, but of the fathers), and on the Sabbath you circumcise a boy.[87]

**23** If a boy receives circumcision on the Sabbath, that the law of Moses may not be broken, are you angry with me, because I made a man completely healthy on the Sabbath?

**24** Don't judge according to appearance, but judge righteous judgment."[88]

**25** Therefore some of them of Jerusalem said, "Isn't this he whom they seek to kill?

**26** Behold, he speaks openly, and they say nothing to him. Can it be that the rulers indeed know that this is truly the Christ?

**27** However we know where this man comes from, but when the Christ comes, no one will know where he comes from."

**28** Jesus therefore cried out in the temple, teaching and saying, "You both know me, and know where I am from. I have not come of myself, but he who sent me is true, whom you don't know.

**29** I know him, because I am from him, and he sent me."

**30** They sought therefore to take him; but no one laid a hand on him, because his hour had not yet come.

**31** But of the multitude, many believed in him. They said, "When the Christ comes, he won't do more signs than those which this man has done, will he?"

**32** The Pharisees heard the multitude murmuring these things concerning him, and the chief priests and the Pharisees sent officers to arrest him.

**33** Then Jesus said, "I will be with you a little while longer, then I go to him who sent me.

**34** You will seek me, and won't find me; and where I am, you can't come."

**35** The Jews therefore said among themselves, "Where will this man go that we won't find him? Will he go to the Dispersion among the Greeks, and teach the Greeks?

**36** What is this word that he said, 'You will seek me, and won't find me; and where I am, you can't come'?"

**37** Now on the last and greatest day of the feast, Jesus stood and cried out, "If anyone is thirsty, let him come to me and drink![89]

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[87] **Cross-Reference:** Genesis 17:12 • Leviticus 12:3 - *every male circumcised at eight days old, on the eighth day*

[88] **Cross-Reference:** Deuteronomy 16:18-19 • Leviticus 19:15 - *judges who judge the people with righteous judgment and show no partiality, judging your neighbor in righteousness*

[89] **Cross-Reference:** Leviticus 23:36 • Isaiah 55:1 - *the eighth day a holy convocation and solemn assembly, and come, everyone who thirsts, to the waters*

**38** He who believes in me, as the Scripture has said, from within him will flow rivers of living water."[90]

**39** But he said this about the Spirit, which those believing in him were to receive. For the Holy Spirit was not yet given, because Jesus wasn't yet glorified.[91]

**40** Many of the multitude therefore, when they heard these words, said, "This is truly the prophet."[92]

**41** Others said, "This is the Christ." But some said, "What, does the Christ come out of Galilee?

**42** Hasn't the Scripture said that the Christ comes of the offspring of David, and from Bethlehem, the village where David was?"[93]

**43** So there arose a division in the multitude because of him.

**44** Some of them would have arrested him, but no one laid hands on him.

**45** The officers therefore came to the chief priests and Pharisees, and they said to them, "Why didn't you bring him?"

**46** The officers answered, "No man ever spoke like this man!"[94]

**47** The Pharisees therefore answered them, "You aren't also led astray, are you?

**48** Have any of the rulers believed in him, or of the Pharisees?

**49** But this multitude that doesn't know the law is accursed."

**50** Nicodemus (he who came to him by night, being one of them) said to them,

**51** "Does our law judge a man, unless it first hears from him personally and knows what he does?"[95]

**52** They answered him, "Are you also from Galilee? Search, and see that no prophet has arisen out of Galilee."[96]

**53** Everyone went to his own house,

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[90] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Zechariah 14:8 • Ezekiel 47:1 - *living waters going out from Jerusalem in summer and winter, and waters flowing from under the threshold of the house*

[91] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Joel 2:28 • Isaiah 44:3 - *I will pour out my Spirit on all flesh, and water on the thirsty and my Spirit on your descendants*

[92] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Deuteronomy 18:15 - *a prophet like Moses raised up from among you, to whom you shall listen*

[93] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Micah 5:2 • 2 Samuel 7:12 - *the ruler of Israel coming out of Bethlehem Ephrathah, and David's offspring whose kingdom Yahweh establishes*

[94] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Psalm 45:2 • Isaiah 50:4 - *grace has anointed your lips, and the tongue of those who are taught, to sustain the weary with words*

[95] **Cross-Reference:** Deuteronomy 1:16-17 • Deuteronomy 17:4 - *hear cases between your brothers and judge righteously, and inquire diligently before anything is judged*

[96] **Cross-Reference:** 2 Kings 14:25 • Joshua 19:13 - *Jonah the son of Amittai, the prophet from Gath Hepher, a town in the territory of Zebulun*

# CHAPTER 8 - Stones Dropped in the Temple Court, the Light of the World, and Before Abraham, I AM

## Key Notes

- He went to the Mount of Olives and came back to the temple at dawn. That is the pattern the other Gospels give for His final week, which is one reason many think this story belongs to that week (John 8:1-2, Luke 21:37-38).
- The scribes and Pharisees bring a woman caught in the act. If she was caught in the act, the man was caught too. The Torah required both to die. They brought only one (John 8:3-4, Leviticus 20:10, Deuteronomy 22:22).
- The trap was precise. Say no, and He contradicts Moses. Say yes, and He defies Rome, which reserved the death penalty for itself (John 8:5-6, 18:31).
- He stooped and wrote on the ground with His finger. The tablets of the covenant were written with the finger of God. And Jeremiah says those who turn from Yahweh will be written in the earth (John 8:6, Exodus 31:18, Jeremiah 17:13).
- What He wrote is never told. Every guess, including the popular one that He wrote their sins, is a guess (John 8:6, 8:8).
- “He who is without sin among you, let him throw the first stone at her.” Under the Torah the witnesses threw first. He did not abolish the penalty. He asked who was qualified to begin it (John 8:7, Deuteronomy 17:7).
- They left one by one, beginning from the oldest. The older you are, the longer the list (John 8:9).
- “Neither do I condemn you. Go your way. From now on, sin no more.” Both halves matter, and in that order. He does not condemn her, and He does not call it nothing (John 8:11).
- “I am the light of the world.” At Tabernacles, according to later Jewish accounts, huge lamps were lit in the Court of the Women, bright enough to light the whole city. Verse 20 places Him in the treasury, which was in that same court (John 8:12, 8:20).
- “Will not walk in the darkness, but will have the light of life” recalls the pillar of fire in the wilderness - the light Israel followed, which the feast of booths remembers (John 8:12, Exodus 13:21).
- Their objection is a legal one: you testify about yourself, so your testimony is not valid. He answers with the Torah’s own rule of two witnesses - Himself and the Father (John 8:13, 8:17-18, Deuteronomy 19:15).
- “Unless you believe that I am he, you will die in your sins.” The word he is not in the Greek. It reads: unless you believe that I am. Isaiah uses the same words for Yahweh: that you may know and believe me, and understand that I am he (John 8:24, Isaiah 43:10).
- “When you have lifted up the Son of Man, then you will know that I am he.” The cross will be the place where who He is becomes plain - lifted up, like the serpent on the pole (John 8:28, 3:14).

- “You will know the truth, and the truth will make you free” is said to people who had just believed - and within twenty verses they are calling Him demon-possessed. Belief that will not stay is the subject of this whole exchange (John 8:31-32, 8:48).
- “We have never been in bondage to anyone.” Egypt, Assyria, Babylon, Persia, Greece, and the Roman soldiers standing outside the temple at that moment would beg to differ (John 8:33, Deuteronomy 6:21).
- “Everyone who commits sin is the bondservant of sin.” The slavery He means is not political (John 8:34).
- “A bondservant doesn’t live in the house forever. A son remains forever.” Ishmael and Isaac. Sarah’s words - cast out the servant and her son - stand behind the saying (John 8:35, Genesis 21:10).
- “If you were Abraham’s children, you would do the works of Abraham.” Descent is not the same as likeness. Abraham welcomed messengers from God; they want to kill one (John 8:39-40).
- “We were not born of sexual immorality” may be a jab. The rumors about His own birth were already going around (John 8:41).
- “He was a murderer from the beginning” goes back to the garden and the lie that brought death, and to Cain, the first murderer, who John later says was of the evil one (John 8:44, Genesis 3:4, 1 John 3:12).
- “Which of you convicts me of sin?” No one answers. In a crowd that wanted Him dead, no one could name a single thing (John 8:46).
- “You are a Samaritan, and have a demon” - the two worst things they could think to call Him, in one breath (John 8:48).
- “If a person keeps my word, he will never see death.” They hear it as madness, because Abraham died and the prophets died (John 8:51-53).
- “Your father Abraham rejoiced to see my day.” On the mountain, when Abraham said God will provide the lamb, and named the place Yahweh Will Provide, he was looking further than he knew (John 8:56, Genesis 22:8, 22:14).
- “You are not yet fifty years old” is not a guess at His age. It is the age at which a Levite retired from service - a round number for a man not yet old (John 8:57, Numbers 4:3).
- “Before Abraham came into existence, I AM.” Not I was, which would claim age. I am, which claims something else. Abraham came to be; He simply is (John 8:58, Exodus 3:14).
- They picked up stones. The Torah’s penalty for blasphemy was stoning. They understood exactly what He had claimed (John 8:59, Leviticus 24:16).
- “Jesus was hidden, and went out of the temple.” In Ezekiel, the glory of Yahweh left the temple and went to the mountain on the east. John lets the picture stand without comment (John 8:59, Ezekiel 10:18, 11:23).

## Key Cross-References (WEB)

| Topic | References |
|---|---|
| Both Shall Die | John 8:5 • Leviticus 20:10 • Deuteronomy 22:22 |
| Written With His Finger | John 8:6 • Exodus 31:18 • Jeremiah 17:13 |
| The Witnesses Throw First | John 8:7 • Deuteronomy 17:7 |
| The Pillar of Fire | John 8:12 • Exodus 13:21 • Psalm 27:1 |
| The Testimony of Two | John 8:17 • Deuteronomy 19:15 |
| Never in Bondage? | John 8:33 • Deuteronomy 6:21 • Nehemiah 9:36 |
| The Son Remains in the House | John 8:35 • Genesis 21:10 • Galatians 4:30 |
| Stoning for Blasphemy | John 8:59 • Leviticus 24:16 |

## Prophecy Fulfilled

| Fulfillment | References |
|---|---|
| The Light of the World | John 8:12 • Isaiah 9:2 • Isaiah 42:6 |
| That I Am He | John 8:24 • Isaiah 43:10 • Deuteronomy 32:39 |
| Lifted Up | John 8:28 • Isaiah 52:13 • Numbers 21:9 |
| Liberty for the Captives | John 8:32 • Isaiah 61:1 • Psalm 119:45 |
| No Deceit in His Mouth | John 8:46 • Isaiah 53:9 • Psalm 45:7 |
| The Day Abraham Saw | John 8:56 • Genesis 22:8 • Genesis 22:14 |
| Before Abraham, I AM | John 8:58 • Exodus 3:14 • Isaiah 41:4 |
| The Glory Leaves the Temple | John 8:59 • Ezekiel 10:18 • Ezekiel 11:23 |

## For Further Study

Credible external commentary that expounds on this chapter in a way consistent with a Torah-honoring, Messianic reading of the text:

- Enduring Word - John 8 Commentary (David Guzik) - the woman taken in adultery, the light of the world, and before Abraham was, I AM
- Life, Hope and Truth - The Gospel of John - John's signs, the I AM sayings, and why this Gospel differs from the other three
- Verse By Verse Ministry International - The Gospel of John, Lesson 8A - exposition of the light of the world and the children of Abraham

## John 8 - Introduction

At dawn in the temple court the scribes and Pharisees bring a woman caught in the act of adultery and stand her before the crowd. If she was caught in the act, the man was too, and the Torah condemned

both; they brought only one, which shows this was never about the Torah. The trap was precise: refusing would set Him against Moses, and assenting would defy Rome, which kept the power of execution for itself. He stoops and writes on the ground with His finger - the finger that wrote the tablets at Sinai - in the dust where, Jeremiah said, those who turn from Yahweh are written. What He wrote is never told.

Pressed, He says that the one without sin should throw the first stone. In the Torah the witnesses threw first, so He has not abolished the penalty; He has asked who is qualified to begin it. They leave one by one, beginning with the oldest. Alone with her, He tells her that He does not condemn her, and that from now on she is to sin no more. Both halves stand, in that order.

Then, standing by the treasury in the Court of the Women, where by later Jewish accounts the great lamps of Tabernacles lit the whole city, He says that He is the light of the world. The exchange that follows hardens steadily. Unless they believe that I am, He says, using Isaiah's words for Yahweh, they will die in their sins. To those who had believed He promises that the truth will make them free, and they protest that Abraham's children have never been slaves to anyone - an astonishing claim from a people who had known Egypt and Babylon and stood at that moment under Rome. The slavery He means is to sin, and only the Son, who remains in the house, can set them free.

Descent from Abraham, He says, is not the same as likeness to him; their desire to kill Him shows a different father. He asks which of them can convict Him of sin, and no one answers. When He promises that whoever keeps His word will never see death, they invoke Abraham's death, and He replies that Abraham rejoiced to see His day. Then the sentence: before Abraham came into existence, I AM. Abraham had a beginning; He simply is. They pick up stones, the Torah's penalty for blasphemy, understanding Him perfectly, and He passes out of the temple, as the glory once left it in Ezekiel's vision.

## John 8:1-59 (WEB)

**1** but Jesus went to the Mount of Olives.

**2** Now very early in the morning, he came again into the temple, and all the people came to him. He sat down, and taught them.

**3** The scribes and the Pharisees brought a woman taken in adultery. Having set her in the middle,

**4** they told him, "Teacher, we found this woman in adultery, in the very act.

**5** Now in our law, Moses commanded us to stone such women. What then do you say about her?"[97]

**6** They said this testing him, that they might have something to accuse him of. But Jesus stooped down, and wrote on the ground with his finger.[98]

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[97] **Cross-Reference:** Leviticus 20:10 • Deuteronomy 22:22 - *the adulterer and the adulteress both put to death, the man who lay with the woman and the woman*

[98] **Cross-Reference:** Exodus 31:18 • Jeremiah 17:13 - *the tablets written with God's finger, and those who depart from Yahweh written in the earth*

**7** But when they continued asking him, he looked up and said to them, “He who is without sin among you, let him throw the first stone at her.”[99]

**8** Again he stooped down, and with his finger wrote on the ground.

**9** They, when they heard it, being convicted by their conscience, went out one by one, beginning from the oldest, even to the last. Jesus was left alone with the woman where she was, in the middle.

**10** Jesus, standing up, saw her and said, “Woman, where are your accusers? Did no one condemn you?”

**11** She said, “No one, Lord.” Jesus said, “Neither do I condemn you. Go your way. From now on, sin no more.”

**12** Again, therefore, Jesus spoke to them, saying, “I am the light of the world. He who follows me will not walk in the darkness, but will have the light of life.”[100]

**13** The Pharisees therefore said to him, “You testify about yourself. Your testimony is not valid.”

**14** Jesus answered them, “Even if I testify about myself, my testimony is true, for I know where I came from, and where I am going; but you don’t know where I came from, or where I am going.

**15** You judge according to the flesh. I judge no one.

**16** Even if I do judge, my judgment is true, for I am not alone, but I am with the Father who sent me.

**17** It’s also written in your law that the testimony of two people is valid.[101]

**18** I am one who testifies about myself, and the Father who sent me testifies about me.”

**19** They said therefore to him, “Where is your Father?” Jesus answered, “You know neither me, nor my Father. If you knew me, you would know my Father also.”

**20** Jesus spoke these words in the treasury, as he taught in the temple. Yet no one arrested him, because his hour had not yet come.

**21** Jesus said therefore again to them, “I am going away, and you will seek me, and you will die in your sins. Where I go, you can’t come.”

**22** The Jews therefore said, “Will he kill himself, because he says, ‘Where I am going, you can’t come’?”

**23** He said to them, “You are from beneath. I am from above. You are of this world. I am not of this world.

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[99] **Cross-Reference:** Deuteronomy 17:7 - *the hand of the witnesses first on him to put him to death, and afterward the hand of all the people*

[100] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Isaiah 9:2 • Isaiah 42:6 - *the people in darkness seeing a great light, and the servant given as a light for the nations*

[101] **Cross-Reference:** Deuteronomy 19:15 - *every matter established at the mouth of two or three witnesses*

**24** I said therefore to you that you will die in your sins; for unless you believe that I am he, you will die in your sins."[102]

**25** They said therefore to him, "Who are you?" Jesus said to them, "Just what I have been saying to you from the beginning.

**26** I have many things to speak and to judge concerning you. However he who sent me is true; and the things which I heard from him, these I say to the world."

**27** They didn't understand that he spoke to them about the Father.

**28** Jesus therefore said to them, "When you have lifted up the Son of Man, then you will know that I am he, and I do nothing of myself, but as my Father taught me, I say these things.[103]

**29** He who sent me is with me. The Father hasn't left me alone, for I always do the things that are pleasing to him."

**30** As he spoke these things, many believed in him.

**31** Jesus therefore said to those Jews who had believed him, "If you remain in my word, then you are truly my disciples.

**32** You will know the truth, and the truth will make you free."[104]

**33** They answered him, "We are Abraham's offspring, and have never been in bondage to anyone. How do you say, 'You will be made free'?"[105]

**34** Jesus answered them, "Most certainly I tell you, everyone who commits sin is the bondservant of sin.

**35** A bondservant doesn't live in the house forever. A son remains forever.[106]

**36** If therefore the Son makes you free, you will be free indeed.

**37** I know that you are Abraham's offspring, yet you seek to kill me, because my word finds no place in you.

**38** I say the things which I have seen with my Father; and you also do the things which you have seen with your father."

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[102] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Isaiah 43:10 • Deuteronomy 32:39 - *that you may know and believe me and understand that I am he, and see now that I myself am he*

[103] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Isaiah 52:13 • Numbers 21:9 - *my servant exalted and lifted up, and the bronze serpent on the pole that whoever looked at lived*

[104] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Isaiah 61:1 • Psalm 119:45 - *liberty proclaimed to the captives, and I will walk in liberty, for I have sought your precepts*

[105] **Cross-Reference:** Deuteronomy 6:21 • Nehemiah 9:36 - *we were Pharaoh's slaves in Egypt, and we are servants today in the land you gave our fathers*

[106] **Cross-Reference:** Genesis 21:10 • Galatians 4:30 - *cast out the servant and her son, for the son of the servant will not be heir with Isaac*

**39** They answered him, “Our father is Abraham.” Jesus said to them, “If you were Abraham’s children,
you would do the works of Abraham.

**40** But now you seek to kill me, a man who has told you the truth, which I heard from God. Abraham
didn’t do this.

**41** You do the works of your father.” They said to him, “We were not born of sexual immorality. We
have one Father, God.”

**42** Therefore Jesus said to them, “If God were your father, you would love me, for I came out and have
come from God. For I haven’t come of myself, but he sent me.

**43** Why don’t you understand my speech? Because you can’t hear my word.

**44** You are of your father, the devil, and you want to do the desires of your father. He was a murderer
from the beginning, and doesn’t stand in the truth, because there is no truth in him. When he speaks a
lie, he speaks on his own; for he is a liar, and the father of lies.

**45** But because I tell the truth, you don’t believe me.

**46** Which of you convicts me of sin? If I tell the truth, why do you not believe me?[107]

**47** He who is of God hears the words of God. For this cause you don’t hear, because you are not of God.”

**48** Then the Jews answered him, “Don’t we say well that you are a Samaritan, and have a demon?”

**49** Jesus answered, “I don’t have a demon, but I honor my Father, and you dishonor me.

**50** But I don’t seek my own glory. There is one who seeks and judges.

**51** Most certainly, I tell you, if a person keeps my word, he will never see death.”

**52** Then the Jews said to him, “Now we know that you have a demon. Abraham died, and the prophets;
and you say, ‘If a man keeps my word, he will never taste of death.’

**53** Are you greater than our father, Abraham, who died? The prophets died. Who do you make yourself
out to be?”

**54** Jesus answered, “If I glorify myself, my glory is nothing. It is my Father who glorifies me, of whom you
say that he is our God.

**55** You have not known him, but I know him. If I said, ‘I don’t know him,’ I would be like you, a liar. But I
know him, and keep his word.

**56** Your father Abraham rejoiced to see my day. He saw it, and was glad.”[108]

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[107] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Isaiah 53:9 • Psalm 45:7 - *he had done no violence and there was no deceit in his mouth, and you have loved righteousness and hated wickedness*

[108] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Genesis 22:8 • Genesis 22:14 - *God will provide himself the lamb, and the place named Yahweh Will Provide*

**57** The Jews therefore said to him, “You are not yet fifty years old, and have you seen Abraham?”

**58** Jesus said to them, “Most certainly, I tell you, before Abraham came into existence, I AM.”[109]

**59** Therefore they took up stones to throw at him, but Jesus was hidden, and went out of the temple, having gone through the middle of them, and so passed by.[110]

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[109] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Exodus 3:14 • Isaiah 41:4 - *I AM WHO I AM, and I, Yahweh, the first, and with the last, I am he*

[110] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Ezekiel 10:18 • Ezekiel 11:23 - *Yahweh’s glory going out from the threshold of the house and standing on the mountain east of the city*

# CHAPTER 9 - A Man Born Blind, Mud and a Pool Called Sent, and the Ones Who Could Not See

## Key Notes

- He saw a man blind from birth. In this Gospel He keeps noticing people first. The man never asked for anything (John 9:1).
- “Who sinned, this man or his parents?” Both options had defenders. The commandment speaks of iniquity visited on the children of those who hate Him; Ezekiel says the son will not bear the father’s iniquity (John 9:2, Exodus 20:5, Ezekiel 18:20).
- “Neither did this man sin, nor his parents.” He rejects the whole question. Not every suffering is a sentence (John 9:3, 5:14).
- “That the works of God might be revealed in him” can be punctuated differently, since the Greek had no punctuation: neither he nor his parents sinned. But so that the works of God may be revealed, we must work. Either way, the blindness is not a punishment (John 9:3-4).
- “I must work the works of him who sent me while it is day.” The WEB reads I; many of the oldest manuscripts read we must work, which takes the disciples into the work with Him (John 9:4).
- He spat on the ground and made mud. God formed man from the dust of the ground. The one who made eyes the first time uses the same material the second time (John 9:6, Genesis 2:7).
- Siloam means Sent. It was the pool at the bottom of the city, fed by the waters of Shiloah that Isaiah says the people refused - the same pool the water came from at the feast two chapters earlier (John 9:7, Isaiah 8:6).
- He went, washed, and came back seeing. He had to walk to the pool blind, with mud on his face, on nothing but a word (John 9:7).
- The neighbors cannot agree whether it is even the same man. Some say yes, some say it looks like him. A changed life is often harder for people to accept than a miracle (John 9:8-9).
- “It was a Sabbath” - again held back until after the healing, as in chapter 5. Kneading clay was one of the forms of work later listed as forbidden on the Sabbath. The Torah’s own command is to do no regular work and to keep the day holy (John 9:14, 5:9).
- The Pharisees split: he is not from God because he does not keep the Sabbath; how can a sinner do such signs? The miracle forced a choice they did not want to make (John 9:16).
- “He is a prophet” is the man’s first answer. Watch him move: a man called Jesus, then a prophet, then from God, then Lord, then worship (John 9:11, 9:17, 9:33, 9:38).
- His parents confirm the facts and refuse anything else: he is of age, ask him. They feared being put out of the synagogue, a word found only in John (John 9:20-22, 12:42, 16:2).
- “Give glory to God” was a solemn charge to tell the truth and confess. Joshua said it to Achan before Achan admitted his sin (John 9:24, Joshua 7:19).

- “One thing I do know: that though I was blind, now I see.” He cannot answer their theology. He can answer from experience, and they have no reply to that (John 9:25).
- “You don’t also want to become his disciples, do you?” The word also means the blind beggar already counts himself one (John 9:27).
- “We are disciples of Moses. We know that God has spoken to Moses.” Moses saw God face to face, and Moses wrote about the one standing in front of them (John 9:28-29, Deuteronomy 34:10, 5:46).
- “We know that God doesn’t listen to sinners” is the man quoting their own theology back at them, and he is right. Yahweh is far from the wicked but hears the prayer of the righteous (John 9:31, Proverbs 15:29).
- “Since the world began it has never been heard of that anyone opened the eyes of someone born blind.” The Hebrew Scriptures record no such miracle. Psalm 146 says it is something Yahweh does (John 9:32, Psalm 146:8).
- “You were altogether born in sins, and do you teach us?” They answer the logic with an insult and throw him out (John 9:34).
- “Jesus heard that they had thrown him out, and finding him…” Thrown out by men, found by Him. He went looking (John 9:35).
- “Who is he, Lord, that I may believe in him?” The man has never seen Yahshua. He went to the pool blind and came back to find Him gone (John 9:36).
- “You have both seen him, and it is he who speaks with you.” The first face the man ever looked at with understanding was His (John 9:37).
- “He worshiped him.” The same word used for worship given to God. Yahshua does not stop him (John 9:38).
- “I came into this world for judgment, that those who don’t see may see, and that those who see may become blind” is Isaiah’s commission running in both directions at once (John 9:39, Isaiah 6:9-10, 29:18).
- “If you were blind, you would have no sin; but now you say, ‘We see.’ Therefore your sin remains.” The blindness that cannot be healed is the kind that insists it can see (John 9:41).

## Key Cross-References (WEB)

| Topic | References |
|---|---|
| Who Sinned? | John 9:2 • Exodus 20:5 • Ezekiel 18:20 |
| Formed From the Dust | John 9:6 • Genesis 2:7 • Isaiah 64:8 |
| The Waters of Shiloah | John 9:7 • Isaiah 8:6 • Nehemiah 3:15 |
| Give Glory to God | John 9:24 • Joshua 7:19 |
| Disciples of Moses | John 9:28 • Deuteronomy 34:10 • Numbers 12:7-8 |
| God Hears the Righteous | John 9:31 • Psalm 66:18 • Proverbs 15:29 |

| Topic | References |
|---|---|
| Cast Out for His Name | John 9:34 • Isaiah 66:5 |
| Eyes That Do Not See | John 9:39 • Isaiah 6:9-10 • Jeremiah 5:21 |

## Prophecy Fulfilled

| Fulfillment | References |
|---|---|
| A Light for the Nations | John 9:5 • Isaiah 49:6 • Isaiah 60:1 |
| The Eyes of the Blind Opened | John 9:7 • Isaiah 35:5 • Isaiah 42:7 |
| The One Who Was Sent | John 9:7 • Isaiah 61:1 • Isaiah 48:16 |
| Never Heard Since the World Began | John 9:32 • Psalm 146:8 • Isaiah 64:4 |
| Honor Him, for He Is Your Lord | John 9:38 • Psalm 45:11 • Psalm 2:12 |
| The Blind Will See Out of Darkness | John 9:39 • Isaiah 29:18 • Isaiah 42:16 |

## For Further Study

Credible external commentary that expounds on this chapter in a way consistent with a Torah-honoring, Messianic reading of the text:

- Enduring Word - John 9 Commentary (David Guzik) - the healing of the man born blind and the blindness of the Pharisees
- Life, Hope and Truth - The Gospel of John - John's signs, the I AM sayings, and why this Gospel differs from the other three
- Verse By Verse Ministry International - The Gospel of John, Lesson 9A - exposition of the man born blind and the questions that followed

## John 9 - Introduction

Yahshua sees a man blind from birth who asks for nothing, and the disciples see a theological question: who sinned, this man or his parents? Both answers had Scripture behind them, the commandment's iniquity of the fathers on one side and Ezekiel's refusal to make the son bear the father's guilt on the other. He rejects the question entirely. Neither sinned; not every suffering is a sentence. Then He spits on the ground, makes mud, and anoints the man's eyes - the same material from which man was formed in Genesis - and sends him to wash in the pool of Siloam, a name John translates as Sent. The man walks there blind with mud on his face, on nothing but a word, and comes back seeing.

What follows is close to comedy. The neighbors cannot agree that it is the same man. The Pharisees, told that the healing happened on a Sabbath, split between those who say a Sabbath-breaker cannot be from God and those who ask how a sinner could do such signs. The man's parents confirm that he is their son and was born blind, and refuse to say anything more, afraid of being put out of the synagogue.

Recalled and charged to give glory to God, the formula Joshua used to bring Achan to confession, the man answers with the one thing no argument can touch: he was blind and now he sees.

When they demand the story again he asks whether they want to become His disciples too, counting himself one already. They retreat to Moses, to whom God spoke, and the beggar takes up their own theology and turns it on them: God does not hear sinners, no one since the world began has opened the eyes of a man born blind, and if this man were not from God He could do nothing. They answer with an insult and throw him out.

Then Yahshua, hearing it, goes and finds him. The man has never seen Him; he left for the pool blind and returned to find Him gone. Asked whether he believes in the Son of Man, he asks who He is, and is told he has seen Him and is speaking with Him now. He says, Lord, I believe, and worships Him. Across the chapter he has moved from a man called Jesus to a prophet, to one from God, to Lord, to worship. The chapter closes on the reversal: the blind made to see, and those who insist they see left in their sin.

## John 9:1-41 (WEB)

**1** As he passed by, he saw a man blind from birth.

**2** His disciples asked him, “Rabbi, who sinned, this man or his parents, that he was born blind?”[111]

**3** Jesus answered, “Neither did this man sin, nor his parents; but, that the works of God might be revealed in him.

**4** I must work the works of him who sent me, while it is day. The night is coming, when no one can work.

**5** While I am in the world, I am the light of the world.”[112]

**6** When he had said this, he spat on the ground, made mud with the saliva, anointed the blind man’s eyes with the mud,[113]

**7** and said to him, “Go, wash in the pool of Siloam” (which means “Sent”). So he went away, washed, and came back seeing.[114,115]

**8** The neighbors therefore, and those who saw that he was blind before, said, “Isn’t this he who sat and begged?”

**9** Others were saying, “It is he.” Still others were saying, “He looks like him.” He said, “I am he.”

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[111] **Cross-Reference:** Exodus 20:5 • Ezekiel 18:20 - *iniquity visited on the children of those who hate him, and the son shall not bear the iniquity of the father*

[112] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Isaiah 49:6 • Isaiah 60:1 - *a light to the nations so salvation reaches the end of the earth, and arise, shine, for your light has come*

[113] **Cross-Reference:** Genesis 2:7 • Isaiah 64:8 - *Yahweh God forming man from the dust of the ground, and we are the clay and you our potter*

[114] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Isaiah 35:5 • Isaiah 61:1 - *the eyes of the blind opened, and the Lord Yahweh’s anointed one sent to the brokenhearted and the captives*

[115] **Cross-Reference:** Isaiah 8:6 - *the waters of Shiloah that go softly, refused by the people*

**10** They therefore were asking him, “How were your eyes opened?”

**11** He answered, “A man called Jesus made mud, anointed my eyes, and said to me, ‘Go to the pool of Siloam, and wash.’ So I went away and washed, and I received sight.”

**12** Then they asked him, “Where is he?” He said, “I don’t know.”

**13** They brought him who had been blind to the Pharisees.

**14** It was a Sabbath when Jesus made the mud and opened his eyes.

**15** Again therefore the Pharisees also asked him how he received his sight. He said to them, “He put mud on my eyes, I washed, and I see.”

**16** Some therefore of the Pharisees said, “This man is not from God, because he doesn’t keep the Sabbath.” Others said, “How can a man who is a sinner do such signs?” There was division among them.

**17** Therefore they asked the blind man again, “What do you say about him, because he opened your eyes?” He said, “He is a prophet.”

**18** The Jews therefore did not believe concerning him, that he had been blind, and had received his sight, until they called the parents of him who had received his sight,

**19** and asked them, “Is this your son, whom you say was born blind? How then does he now see?”

**20** His parents answered them, “We know that this is our son, and that he was born blind;

**21** but how he now sees, we don’t know; or who opened his eyes, we don’t know. He is of age. Ask him. He will speak for himself.”

**22** His parents said these things because they feared the Jews; for the Jews had already agreed that if any man would confess him as Christ, he would be put out of the synagogue.

**23** Therefore his parents said, “He is of age. Ask him.”

**24** So they called the man who was blind a second time, and said to him, “Give glory to God. We know that this man is a sinner.”[116]

**25** He therefore answered, “I don’t know if he is a sinner. One thing I do know: that though I was blind, now I see.”

**26** They said to him again, “What did he do to you? How did he open your eyes?”

**27** He answered them, “I told you already, and you didn’t listen. Why do you want to hear it again? You don’t also want to become his disciples, do you?”

**28** They insulted him and said, “You are his disciple, but we are disciples of Moses.[117]

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[116] **Cross-Reference:** Joshua 7:19 - *Joshua telling Achan to give glory to Yahweh and confess what he had done*

[117] **Cross-Reference:** Deuteronomy 34:10 • Numbers 12:7-8 - *no prophet like Moses whom Yahweh knew face to face, spoken to mouth to mouth and not in riddles*

**29** We know that God has spoken to Moses. But as for this man, we don't know where he comes from."

**30** The man answered them, "How amazing! You don't know where he comes from, yet he opened my eyes.

**31** We know that God doesn't listen to sinners, but if anyone is a worshiper of God, and does his will, he listens to him.[118]

**32** Since the world began it has never been heard of that anyone opened the eyes of someone born blind.[119]

**33** If this man were not from God, he could do nothing."

**34** They answered him, "You were altogether born in sins, and do you teach us?" They threw him out.[120]

**35** Jesus heard that they had thrown him out, and finding him, he said, "Do you believe in the Son of God?"

**36** He answered, "Who is he, Lord, that I may believe in him?"

**37** Jesus said to him, "You have both seen him, and it is he who speaks with you."

**38** He said, "Lord, I believe!" and he worshiped him.[121]

**39** Jesus said, "I came into this world for judgment, that those who don't see may see; and that those who see may become blind."[122,123]

**40** Those of the Pharisees who were with him heard these things, and said to him, "Are we also blind?"

**41** Jesus said to them, "If you were blind, you would have no sin; but now you say, 'We see.' Therefore your sin remains.

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[118] **Cross-Reference:** Psalm 66:18 • Proverbs 15:29 - *if I cherished sin in my heart the Lord would not have listened, and he hears the prayer of the righteous*

[119] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Psalm 146:8 • Isaiah 64:4 - *Yahweh opens the eyes of the blind, and from of old no eye has seen a God besides you*

[120] **Cross-Reference:** Isaiah 66:5 - *your brothers who hate you and cast you out for my name's sake will be disappointed*

[121] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Psalm 45:11 • Psalm 2:12 - *honor him, for he is your lord, and homage given to the Son*

[122] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Isaiah 29:18 • Isaiah 42:16 - *the eyes of the blind seeing out of obscurity and darkness, and the blind led by a way they do not know*

[123] **Cross-Reference:** Isaiah 6:9-10 - *seeing indeed but not perceiving, eyes shut lest they see and turn and be healed*

## Major Themes Across John 7-9

- Brothers at the same table who did not believe, and one of them who later did
- A time that is never ready for Him and always ready for those it costs nothing
- Whispers in the city and no one willing to speak openly
- Understanding that follows obedience rather than preceding it
- Accused of breaking the Sabbath by men plotting murder
- Circumcision on the eighth day, and a whole man made well
- Judging by appearance instead of with righteous judgment
- A shout on the last day of the water feast
- Rivers of living water flowing from the one standing in the temple
- Officers sent to arrest Him who were arrested by what they heard
- Nicodemus speaking up in daylight, and paying for it
- Experts so angry they forgot Jonah came from Galilee
- A woman used as bait, and a man who was never brought
- The finger that wrote the tablets, writing in the dust
- Stones dropped one by one, beginning with the oldest
- Neither do I condemn you, and go and sin no more, kept together
- The light of the world, spoken beside the great lamps of the feast
- I am, in Isaiah's words, and dying in sin for refusing it
- Truth that makes free, offered to people who insisted they were never slaves
- A son who stays in the house, and a slave who does not
- Descent from Abraham without likeness to him
- No one in a hostile crowd able to name a single sin
- Abraham rejoicing to see a day he could only see from far off
- Before Abraham came to be, I AM
- Stones lifted by men who understood the claim perfectly
- A man noticed before he asked for anything
- Suffering that is not a sentence
- Eyes made from dust a second time by the hands that made them the first
- A walk to a pool called Sent, blind, on nothing but a word
- Neighbors who could not accept a changed life
- One thing I know: I was blind and now I see
- A beggar who already counted himself a disciple

- Thrown out by men and found by Him
- From a man called Jesus to Lord, I believe, and worship
- The only blindness that cannot be healed is the kind that says it sees

# CHAPTER 10 - The Door, the Good Shepherd, and I and the Father Are One

## Key Notes

- There is no break between chapters 9 and 10. The shepherds He is describing are the same men who just threw a healed sheep out of the fold (John 10:1, 9:34).
- A sheepfold was a walled enclosure, often shared by several flocks overnight. A thief does not use the door because the doorkeeper knows who belongs and who does not (John 10:1-3).
- “He calls his own sheep by name.” Shepherds in the region still do this, and the sheep come. Yahweh told Moses I know you by name, and told Jacob I have called you by your name, you are mine (John 10:3, Exodus 33:17, Isaiah 43:1).
- “He goes before them.” An eastern shepherd leads from the front. The sheep follow a voice, not a stick (John 10:4).
- John calls it a paroimia, a figure of speech, and says they did not understand it. So He tells it again from another angle (John 10:6).
- “I am the door” is the third of the seven I AM sayings with a picture. A shepherd would sometimes sleep across the gap in the wall. He was literally the door (John 10:7, 10:9).
- “Will go in and go out, and will find pasture” is covenant language for a life safely led. Moses asked for a man who would go out and come in before the people, so they would not be like sheep without a shepherd (John 10:9, Numbers 27:17).
- “The thief only comes to steal, kill, and destroy. I came that they may have life, and may have it abundantly.” Abundantly means beyond what is needed, overflowing. He did not come to keep people barely alive (John 10:10, Psalm 36:8).
- “Good shepherd” uses kalos, which means good in the sense of noble, beautiful, the real thing - as opposed to the worthless shepherds condemned by the prophets (John 10:11, Zechariah 11:17).
- Ezekiel 34 is the background of the whole chapter. Yahweh condemns the shepherds of Israel who feed themselves, and then says: I myself will search for my sheep, I myself will be the shepherd of my sheep. And then: I will set up one shepherd over them, my servant David. Both are true of Yahshua at once (John 10:11, Ezekiel 34:2, 34:15, 34:23).
- “Lays down his life for the sheep.” A shepherd might risk his life for the flock. This one plans to give it, and says so five times in the chapter (John 10:11, 15, 17, 18).
- The hired hand flees when the wolf comes because the sheep are not his. You find out who owns the flock when it costs something (John 10:12-13).
- “I know my own, and I’m known by my own; even as the Father knows me, and I know the Father.” The way He knows His sheep is compared to the way He and the Father know each other (John 10:14-15).

- “Other sheep, which are not of this fold” is usually read of the nations coming in. Ezekiel 37 speaks of the two houses, Judah and Joseph, gathered back as one nation with one shepherd over them. Either way the destination is the same: one flock, one shepherd (John 10:16, Ezekiel 37:22-24).
- “I lay down my life, that I may take it again. No one takes it away from me.” The cross was not something that happened to Him. He had authority to lay it down and authority to take it up (John 10:17-18).
- The Feast of Dedication remembers the cleansing and rededication of the temple after Antiochus Epiphanes defiled it, nearly two hundred years earlier. It is not one of the appointed times in Leviticus 23. John simply records that Yahshua was in the temple at that time, in winter (John 10:22-23).
- Solomon’s porch was a covered colonnade along the east side of the temple court, a place out of the winter weather. The early believers later met there (John 10:23, Acts 5:12).
- “How long will you hold us in suspense?” is literally how long will you take away our life, or lift up our soul. They want a straight answer they can use (John 10:24).
- “No one will snatch them out of my hand… no one is able to snatch them out of my Father’s hand.” The same hand, said two ways. Yahweh says in Isaiah: there is no one who can deliver out of my hand (John 10:28-29, Isaiah 43:13).
- “I and the Father are one” uses one in the neuter, hen - one thing, not one person. It is the unity of the Shema, Yahweh is one, spoken from inside it (John 10:30, Deuteronomy 6:4).
- They pick up stones because, as they say, you, being a man, make yourself God. Once again His enemies understood Him more clearly than many readers since (John 10:31-33).
- “I said, you are gods” is Psalm 82, which Yahshua calls your law - the word could cover the whole of Scripture. In the psalm God stands among those He calls gods and sons of the Most High and says they will die like men. Readers divide over whether they are Israel’s judges or the heavenly council; the argument works either way (John 10:34, Psalm 82:6-7).
- The argument runs from lesser to greater. If Scripture can call them gods, how can you call it blasphemy when the one the Father set apart and sent says I am the Son of God? (John 10:35-36).
- “The Scripture can’t be broken” is said in passing, as something everyone in the conversation already agreed on (John 10:35).
- “Sanctified and sent” - set apart and sent - is said at the feast of setting apart. Dedication remembered an altar consecrated again; He claims to be the one the Father consecrated (John 10:36).
- He goes back across the Jordan to where John first baptized. The ministry ends near where it began (John 10:40, 1:28).
- “John did no sign, but everything John said about this man is true.” The best thing ever said about a preacher (John 10:41).

## Key Cross-References (WEB)

| Topic | References |
|---|---|
| Shepherds Who Feed Themselves | John 10:1 • Ezekiel 34:2-3 • Jeremiah 23:1-2 |
| He Calls His Own by Name | John 10:3 • Isaiah 43:1 • Exodus 33:17 |
| The Gate of Yahweh | John 10:9 • Psalm 118:20 • Genesis 28:17 |
| Life More Abundantly | John 10:10 • Psalm 36:8-9 • Deuteronomy 30:19-20 |
| The Worthless Shepherd | John 10:12 • Zechariah 11:17 • Ezekiel 34:5-6 |
| The Dedication of the Altar | John 10:22 • 2 Chronicles 7:9 • Numbers 7:84 |
| You Are Gods | John 10:34 • Psalm 82:6 • Exodus 22:28 |
| Scripture Cannot Be Broken | John 10:35 • Psalm 119:89 • Isaiah 40:8 |

## Prophecy Fulfilled

| Fulfillment | References |
|---|---|
| Yahweh Is My Shepherd | John 10:11 • Psalm 23:1 • Isaiah 40:11 |
| I Myself Will Shepherd My Sheep | John 10:11 • Ezekiel 34:11-12 • Ezekiel 34:15 |
| Strike the Shepherd | John 10:15 • Zechariah 13:7 • Isaiah 53:6-7 |
| One Flock, One Shepherd | John 10:16 • Ezekiel 37:22-24 • Ezekiel 34:23 |
| No One Can Deliver Out of My Hand | John 10:28 • Isaiah 43:13 • Deuteronomy 32:39 |
| I and the Father Are One | John 10:30 • Deuteronomy 6:4 • Zechariah 14:9 |
| Set Apart and Sent | John 10:36 • Jeremiah 1:5 • Isaiah 61:1 |

## For Further Study

Credible external commentary that expounds on this chapter in a way consistent with a Torah-honoring, Messianic reading of the text:

- Enduring Word - John 10 Commentary (David Guzik) - the door of the sheep, the good shepherd, and the Feast of Dedication
- Life, Hope and Truth - The Gospel of John - John's signs, the I AM sayings, and why this Gospel differs from the other three
- Verse By Verse Ministry International - The Gospel of John, Lesson 10A - exposition of the good shepherd and his sheep

## John 10 - Introduction

Chapter 10 follows directly from the man thrown out of the synagogue, and Yahshua turns to the men who threw him out and speaks of shepherds. Every hearer knew the prophets' indictment: Ezekiel's shepherds who feed themselves instead of the flock, Jeremiah's who scatter the sheep of Yahweh's

pasture. The thief climbs over the wall rather than using the door; the true shepherd calls his own sheep by name, as Yahweh knew Moses by name and called Jacob by his, goes before them, and is followed because they know his voice.

Then come two of the I AM sayings in succession. I am the door - the shepherd who lay across the opening of the stone fold at night, so that nothing passed except over him. The thief comes to steal and kill and destroy; He came that they might have life overflowing. And I am the good shepherd, who lays down his life for the sheep. Ezekiel 34 holds the key: Yahweh condemns the false shepherds and says that He Himself will seek and shepherd His sheep, and then that He will set over them one shepherd, His servant David. Yahshua is both. The hired hand flees from the wolf because the sheep are not his, and there are other sheep, not of this fold, who will hear His voice until there is one flock and one shepherd - whether read of the nations, or of Ezekiel's two houses made one nation under one shepherd. No one takes His life from Him. He lays it down and takes it up again on His own authority.

At the Feast of Dedication, in winter, in Solomon's porch, He is surrounded and asked to say plainly whether He is the Christ. His sheep hear His voice, He says, and no one will snatch them from His hand or from His Father's hand - the same hand, spoken of twice - and then: I and the Father are one, the unity of the Shema spoken from within. They take up stones, saying that He, a man, makes Himself God. He answers from Psalm 82, where Scripture, which cannot be broken, calls others gods: how then is it blasphemy for the one the Father set apart and sent to say He is the Son of God? It is a striking word at the feast of setting apart. He withdraws beyond the Jordan, where John had baptized, and the people there remember that John did no sign, but everything he said about this man was true.

## John 10:1-42 (WEB)

**1** "Most certainly, I tell you, one who doesn't enter by the door into the sheep fold, but climbs up some other way, the same is a thief and a robber.[124]

**2** But one who enters in by the door is the shepherd of the sheep.

**3** The gatekeeper opens the gate for him, and the sheep listen to his voice. He calls his own sheep by name, and leads them out.[125]

**4** Whenever he brings out his own sheep, he goes before them, and the sheep follow him, for they know his voice.

**5** They will by no means follow a stranger, but will flee from him; for they don't know the voice of strangers."

**6** Jesus spoke this parable to them, but they didn't understand what he was telling them.

**7** Jesus therefore said to them again, "Most certainly, I tell you, I am the sheep's door.

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[124] **Cross-Reference:** Ezekiel 34:2-3 • Jeremiah 23:1-2 - *woe to the shepherds of Israel who feed themselves and not the sheep, and who scatter the flock of my pasture*

[125] **Cross-Reference:** Isaiah 43:1 • Exodus 33:17 - *I have called you by your name, you are mine, and I know you by name*

**8** All who came before me are thieves and robbers, but the sheep didn't listen to them.

**9** I am the door. If anyone enters in by me, he will be saved, and will go in and go out, and will find pasture.[126]

**10** The thief only comes to steal, kill, and destroy. I came that they may have life, and may have it abundantly.[127]

**11** I am the good shepherd. The good shepherd lays down his life for the sheep.[128]

**12** He who is a hired hand, and not a shepherd, who doesn't own the sheep, sees the wolf coming, leaves the sheep, and flees. The wolf snatches the sheep, and scatters them.[129]

**13** The hired hand flees because he is a hired hand, and doesn't care for the sheep.

**14** I am the good shepherd. I know my own, and I'm known by my own;

**15** even as the Father knows me, and I know the Father. I lay down my life for the sheep.[130]

**16** I have other sheep, which are not of this fold. I must bring them also, and they will hear my voice. They will become one flock with one shepherd.[131]

**17** Therefore the Father loves me, because I lay down my life, that I may take it again.

**18** No one takes it away from me, but I lay it down by myself. I have power to lay it down, and I have power to take it again. I received this commandment from my Father."

**19** Therefore a division arose again among the Jews because of these words.

**20** Many of them said, "He has a demon, and is insane! Why do you listen to him?"

**21** Others said, "These are not the sayings of one possessed by a demon. It isn't possible for a demon to open the eyes of the blind, is it?"

**22** It was the Feast of the Dedication at Jerusalem.[132]

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[126] **Cross-Reference:** Psalm 118:20 • Genesis 28:17 - *this is the gate of Yahweh, the righteous will enter it, and Jacob's house of God and gate of heaven*

[127] **Cross-Reference:** Psalm 36:8-9 • Deuteronomy 30:19-20 - *abundantly satisfied with the abundance of your house, with you the spring of life, and choose life, for he is your life*

[128] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Psalm 23:1 • Ezekiel 34:15 - *Yahweh is my shepherd, I shall lack nothing, and I myself will be the shepherd of my sheep*

[129] **Cross-Reference:** Zechariah 11:17 • Ezekiel 34:5-6 - *woe to the worthless shepherd who leaves the flock, and sheep scattered with no one to search or seek*

[130] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Zechariah 13:7 • Isaiah 53:6-7 - *strike the shepherd and the sheep will be scattered, and the iniquity of us all laid on him who was led as a lamb*

[131] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Ezekiel 37:22-24 • Ezekiel 34:23 - *the two kingdoms made one nation with one king and one shepherd, and one shepherd set over them, my servant David*

[132] **Cross-Reference:** 2 Chronicles 7:9 • Numbers 7:84 - *the dedication of the altar kept seven days in Solomon's temple, and the altar's dedication in the wilderness*

**23** It was winter, and Jesus was walking in the temple, in Solomon's porch.

**24** The Jews therefore came around him and said to him, "How long will you hold us in suspense? If you are the Christ, tell us plainly."

**25** Jesus answered them, "I told you, and you don't believe. The works that I do in my Father's name, these testify about me.

**26** But you don't believe, because you are not of my sheep, as I told you.

**27** My sheep hear my voice, and I know them, and they follow me.

**28** I give eternal life to them. They will never perish, and no one will snatch them out of my hand.[133]

**29** My Father, who has given them to me, is greater than all. No one is able to snatch them out of my Father's hand.

**30** I and the Father are one."[134]

**31** Therefore Jews took up stones again to stone him.

**32** Jesus answered them, "I have shown you many good works from my Father. For which of those works do you stone me?"

**33** The Jews answered him, "We don't stone you for a good work, but for blasphemy: because you, being a man, make yourself God."

**34** Jesus answered them, "Isn't it written in your law, 'I said, you are gods?'[135]

**35** If he called them gods, to whom the word of God came (and the Scripture can't be broken),[136]

**36** do you say of him whom the Father sanctified and sent into the world, 'You blaspheme,' because I said, 'I am the Son of God?'[137]

**37** If I don't do the works of my Father, don't believe me.

**38** But if I do them, though you don't believe me, believe the works; that you may know and believe that the Father is in me, and I in the Father."

**39** They sought again to seize him, and he went out of their hand.

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[133] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Isaiah 43:13 • Deuteronomy 32:39 - *no one can deliver out of my hand, I am he*

[134] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Deuteronomy 6:4 • Zechariah 14:9 - *hear, Israel, Yahweh is one, and in that day Yahweh will be one and his name one*

[135] **Cross-Reference:** Psalm 82:6 • Exodus 22:28 - *I said, you are gods, all of you sons of the Most High, and you shall not blaspheme God nor curse a ruler*

[136] **Cross-Reference:** Psalm 119:89 • Isaiah 40:8 - *your word is settled in heaven forever, and the word of our God stands forever*

[137] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Jeremiah 1:5 • Isaiah 61:1 - *before you were born I sanctified you, and the Spirit of the Lord Yahweh on the one he anointed and sent*

**40** He went away again beyond the Jordan into the place where John was baptizing at first, and there he stayed.

**41** Many came to him. They said, “John indeed did no sign, but everything that John said about this man is true.”

**42** Many believed in him there.

# CHAPTER 11 - Two Days' Delay, I Am the Resurrection, and Lazarus, Come Out

## Key Notes

- Bethany was a village on the far side of the Mount of Olives, fifteen stadia - under two miles - from Jerusalem. Close enough to be dangerous (John 11:1, 11:18).
- John identifies Mary as the one who anointed the Lord, though he does not tell that story until the next chapter. He assumes his readers already know it (John 11:2, 12:3).
- "Lord, behold, he for whom you have great affection is sick." The sisters send no request. They send a description of the need and trust the love (John 11:3).
- "This sickness is not to death" - and Lazarus dies. He means death will not be the end of it (John 11:4).
- "Now Jesus loved Martha, and her sister, and Lazarus. When therefore he heard that he was sick, he stayed two days." John puts the love and the delay side by side with the word therefore between them. The delay was not the opposite of the love (John 11:5-6).
- The disciples remind Him that the Judeans just tried to stone Him. Going to Bethany means going back into range (John 11:8, 10:31).
- "Aren't there twelve hours of daylight?" A man walking in the day does not stumble. His day had a set length, and nothing could cut it short (John 11:9-10).
- "Our friend Lazarus has fallen asleep." Scripture often calls death sleep, as Daniel speaks of those who sleep in the dust of the earth awakening. The disciples take Him literally, and He has to say it plainly: Lazarus is dead (John 11:11-14, Daniel 12:2).
- "Let's go also, that we may die with him." Thomas, remembered for doubting, is the one who says this. Courage and doubt can live in the same man (John 11:16).
- Lazarus had been in the tomb four days. There was a popular belief that the soul lingered near the body for three days. On the fourth day nobody could pretend he was not really dead (John 11:17, 11:39).
- Many had come from Jerusalem to console the sisters. Mourning was public and lasted days, which means the miracle that follows will have a large audience (John 11:19, 11:45).
- Martha goes out to meet Him; Mary sits in the house. The same two women as in Luke, behaving exactly as they did there (John 11:20, Luke 10:39-40).
- "I know that he will rise again in the resurrection at the last day." Martha's theology is correct, and it is the theology of Daniel 12. She believed in a resurrection someday. He is about to show her that someday is standing in front of her (John 11:24).
- "I am the resurrection and the life" is the fifth of the seven I AM sayings with a picture. He does not say I will bring the resurrection. He says I am it (John 11:25).

- “Do you believe this?” Martha’s answer - You are the Christ, the Son of God, he who comes into the world - is almost word for word the purpose statement of the whole Gospel (John 11:27, 20:31).
- Mary says exactly what Martha said: Lord, if you would have been here, my brother wouldn’t have died. To Martha He gave theology. To Mary He gives tears. Same sentence, different need (John 11:21, 11:32).
- “He groaned in the spirit, and was troubled.” The word for groaned can describe a horse snorting, and in Greek it carries anger. He was not only sad. He was angry at death itself (John 11:33, 11:38).
- “Jesus wept” is the shortest verse in the English Bible. The word is different from the loud wailing of the mourners around Him. These were quiet tears, from a man who knew He was about to fix it (John 11:35).
- “Lord, by this time there is a stench, for he has been dead four days.” Martha, who said she believed, still tries to stop Him at the stone. Believing in theory and believing at the tomb are different things (John 11:39).
- He prays out loud, and says why: for the sake of the crowd, that they may believe the Father sent Him. He thanks the Father before anything has happened (John 11:41-42).
- “Lazarus, come out!” He calls him by name. Some have said that if He had not named him, every grave in the place would have emptied. It is a preview of the hour when all who are in the tombs will hear His voice (John 11:43, 5:28).
- Lazarus comes out still bound, hands and feet, his face wrapped. Yahshua gives life; the people standing there are told to unwrap him. Loose him, and let him go (John 11:44).
- Lazarus would die again. This is a raising, not yet the resurrection. The grave clothes stay behind in the tomb only when Yahshua Himself rises (John 11:44, 20:6-7).
- The council meets because the miracle is too big to ignore. Their fear is that the Romans will take away both our place and our nation. The place means the temple. Forty years later the Romans did exactly that (John 11:47-48, Jeremiah 7:14).
- Caiaphas was high priest that year, and says one man should die for the people rather than the whole nation perish. He meant it as cold politics. John says he was prophesying, because of his office, and did not know it (John 11:49-51).
- “Not for the nation only, but that he might also gather together into one the children of God who are scattered abroad.” The language of gathering the scattered is the prophets’ language for the regathering of Israel, and of the nations with them (John 11:52, Ezekiel 37:21, Isaiah 11:12).
- From that day they plotted to kill Him. Raising a dead man is what finally got Him killed (John 11:53).
- He withdrew to a town called Ephraim, near the wilderness. It is the only time John mentions it (John 11:54).

- Many went up to Jerusalem before the Passover to purify themselves, since anyone unclean could not eat it. The Torah made provision for those who could not keep it at the first time (John 11:55, Numbers 9:10).

## Key Cross-References (WEB)

| Topic | References |
|---|---|
| Twelve Hours in the Day | John 11:9 • Psalm 121:6 • Proverbs 4:18 |
| Fallen Asleep | John 11:11 • Daniel 12:2 • Psalm 13:3 |
| The Resurrection at the Last Day | John 11:24 • Job 19:25-26 • Isaiah 26:19 |
| Tears in His Bottle | John 11:35 • Psalm 56:8 • Isaiah 53:3 |
| Loose Him | John 11:44 • Psalm 116:16 • Isaiah 61:1 |
| Our Place and Our Nation | John 11:48 • Jeremiah 7:4 • Jeremiah 7:14 |
| Purified Before the Passover | John 11:55 • Numbers 9:10 • 2 Chronicles 30:17-18 |

## Prophecy Fulfilled

| Fulfillment | References |
|---|---|
| I Am the Resurrection | John 11:25 • Hosea 13:14 • Isaiah 25:8 |
| The Son Who Comes Into the World | John 11:27 • Psalm 2:7 • Psalm 118:26 |
| I Will Open Your Graves | John 11:43 • Ezekiel 37:12-13 • 1 Samuel 2:6 |
| One Man for the People | John 11:50 • Isaiah 53:8 • Daniel 9:26 |
| A High Priest Who Spoke for God | John 11:51 • Numbers 27:21 • Exodus 28:30 |
| Gathering the Scattered Into One | John 11:52 • Ezekiel 37:21-22 • Isaiah 11:12 |

## For Further Study

Credible external commentary that expounds on this chapter in a way consistent with a Torah-honoring, Messianic reading of the text:

- Enduring Word - John 11 Commentary (David Guzik) - the death and raising of Lazarus and the council's plot
- Life, Hope and Truth - The Gospel of John - John's signs, the I AM sayings, and why this Gospel differs from the other three
- Verse By Verse Ministry International - The Gospel of John, Lesson 11A - exposition of the raising of Lazarus

## John 11 - Introduction

Two sisters in Bethany send Yahshua a message that asks for nothing and simply names the need: the one you love is sick. Then John sets two sentences side by side: Yahshua loved Martha, Mary and

Lazarus, and therefore, hearing of the sickness, He stayed where He was two more days. The delay is joined to the love by a therefore, not opposed to it. When He resolves to return to Judea, where He was nearly stoned, it is Thomas - remembered for doubting - who says let us go and die with Him. He speaks of Lazarus as asleep, in Scripture's familiar idiom for death, and then plainly: Lazarus is dead.

Lazarus has been four days in the tomb when they arrive, past any pretence that he was not truly dead. Martha meets Him on the road with a reproach - if you had been here - and a faith that God will give Him whatever He asks. Told her brother will rise, she answers with the correct theology of Daniel 12, the resurrection at the last day. He answers that He is the resurrection and the life, and her confession - the Christ, the Son of God, who comes into the world - nearly repeats the purpose of the whole Gospel. Mary comes and says exactly what her sister said, and receives no theology at all. He is deeply moved, with a word that carries anger at death itself, and He weeps, quietly, though He knows what He is about to do.

At the tomb Martha, who had confessed her faith on the road, tries to stop Him at the stone: four days, and the stench. The stone is moved; He thanks the Father aloud before anything happens, for the sake of the crowd, and calls Lazarus out by name with a loud voice - a preview of the hour when all in the tombs will hear Him. Lazarus comes out still bound, and the bystanders are told to loose him and let him go. He gives the life; others remove the grave clothes.

The miracle that should have ended the argument is the one that sets His death in motion. The council fears the Romans will take away their place, the temple, and their nation, and Caiaphas, high priest that year, counsels that one man should die for the people. He means it as cold policy; John says he was prophesying by virtue of his office, and that the death would gather into one the scattered children of God - the prophets' own language for regathering. From that day they plot to kill Him. He gave Lazarus his life, and it cost Him His.

## John 11:1-57 (WEB)

**1** Now a certain man was sick, Lazarus from Bethany, of the village of Mary and her sister, Martha.

**2** It was that Mary who had anointed the Lord with ointment, and wiped his feet with her hair, whose brother, Lazarus, was sick.

**3** The sisters therefore sent to him, saying, "Lord, behold, he for whom you have great affection is sick."

**4** But when Jesus heard it, he said, "This sickness is not to death, but for the glory of God, that God's Son may be glorified by it."

**5** Now Jesus loved Martha, and her sister, and Lazarus.

**6** When therefore he heard that he was sick, he stayed two days in the place where he was.

**7** Then after this he said to the disciples, "Let's go into Judea again."

**8** The disciples told him, "Rabbi, the Jews were just trying to stone you, and are you going there again?"

**9** Jesus answered, “Aren’t there twelve hours of daylight? If a man walks in the day, he doesn’t stumble, because he sees the light of this world.[138]

**10** But if a man walks in the night, he stumbles, because the light isn’t in him.”

**11** He said these things, and after that, he said to them, “Our friend, Lazarus, has fallen asleep, but I am going so that I may awake him out of sleep.”[139]

**12** The disciples therefore said, “Lord, if he has fallen asleep, he will recover.”

**13** Now Jesus had spoken of his death, but they thought that he spoke of taking rest in sleep.

**14** So Jesus said to them plainly then, “Lazarus is dead.

**15** I am glad for your sakes that I was not there, so that you may believe. Nevertheless, let’s go to him.”

**16** Thomas therefore, who is called Didymus, said to his fellow disciples, “Let’s go also, that we may die with him.”

**17** So when Jesus came, he found that he had been in the tomb four days already.

**18** Now Bethany was near Jerusalem, about fifteen stadia away.

**19** Many of the Jews had joined the women around Martha and Mary, to console them concerning their brother.

**20** Then when Martha heard that Jesus was coming, she went and met him, but Mary stayed in the house.

**21** Therefore Martha said to Jesus, “Lord, if you would have been here, my brother wouldn’t have died.

**22** Even now I know that, whatever you ask of God, God will give you.”

**23** Jesus said to her, “Your brother will rise again.”

**24** Martha said to him, “I know that he will rise again in the resurrection at the last day.”[140]

**25** Jesus said to her, “I am the resurrection and the life. He who believes in me will still live, even if he dies.[141]

**26** Whoever lives and believes in me will never die. Do you believe this?”

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[138] **Cross-Reference:** Psalm 121:6 • Proverbs 4:18 - *the sun will not harm you by day, and the path of the righteous shining more and more until the perfect day*

[139] **Cross-Reference:** Daniel 12:2 • Psalm 13:3 - *many who sleep in the dust of the earth shall awake, and give light to my eyes lest I sleep in death*

[140] **Cross-Reference:** Job 19:25-26 • Isaiah 26:19 - *my Redeemer standing on the earth at the last and seen in my flesh, and your dead shall live and arise*

[141] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Hosea 13:14 • Isaiah 25:8 - *I will ransom them from the power of Sheol and redeem them from death, and he has swallowed up death forever*

**27** She said to him, “Yes, Lord. I have come to believe that you are the Christ, God’s Son, he who comes into the world.”[142]

**28** When she had said this, she went away, and called Mary, her sister, secretly, saying, “The Teacher is here, and is calling you.”

**29** When she heard this, she arose quickly, and went to him.

**30** Now Jesus had not yet come into the village, but was in the place where Martha met him.

**31** Then the Jews who were with her in the house, and were consoling her, when they saw Mary, that she rose up quickly and went out, followed her, saying, “She is going to the tomb to weep there.”

**32** Therefore when Mary came to where Jesus was, and saw him, she fell down at his feet, saying to him, “Lord, if you would have been here, my brother wouldn’t have died.”

**33** When Jesus therefore saw her weeping, and the Jews weeping who came with her, he groaned in the spirit, and was troubled,

**34** and said, “Where have you laid him?” They told him, “Lord, come and see.”

**35** Jesus wept.[143]

**36** The Jews therefore said, “See how much affection he had for him!”

**37** Some of them said, “Couldn’t this man, who opened the eyes of him who was blind, have also kept this man from dying?”

**38** Jesus therefore, again groaning in himself, came to the tomb. Now it was a cave, and a stone lay against it.

**39** Jesus said, “Take away the stone.” Martha, the sister of him who was dead, said to him, “Lord, by this time there is a stench, for he has been dead four days.”

**40** Jesus said to her, “Didn’t I tell you that if you believed, you would see God’s glory?”

**41** So they took away the stone from the place where the dead man was lying. Jesus lifted up his eyes, and said, “Father, I thank you that you listened to me.

**42** I know that you always listen to me, but because of the multitude standing around I said this, that they may believe that you sent me.”

**43** When he had said this, he cried with a loud voice, “Lazarus, come out!”[144]

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[142] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Psalm 2:7 • Psalm 118:26 - *you are my son, today I have become your father, and blessed is he who comes in Yahweh’s name*

[143] **Cross-Reference:** Psalm 56:8 • Isaiah 53:3 - *you put my tears into your bottle, and a man of suffering, acquainted with grief*

[144] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Ezekiel 37:12-13 • 1 Samuel 2:6 - *I will open your graves and cause you to come up out of them, and Yahweh kills and makes alive*

**44** He who was dead came out, bound hand and foot with wrappings, and his face was wrapped around with a cloth. Jesus said to them, “Free him, and let him go.”[145]

**45** Therefore many of the Jews, who came to Mary and saw what Jesus did, believed in him.

**46** But some of them went away to the Pharisees, and told them the things which Jesus had done.

**47** The chief priests therefore and the Pharisees gathered a council, and said, “What are we doing? For this man does many signs.

**48** If we leave him alone like this, everyone will believe in him, and the Romans will come and take away both our place and our nation.”[146]

**49** But a certain one of them, Caiaphas, being high priest that year, said to them, “You know nothing at all,

**50** nor do you consider that it is advantageous for us that one man should die for the people, and that the whole nation not perish.”[147]

**51** Now he didn’t say this of himself, but being high priest that year, he prophesied that Jesus would die for the nation,[148]

**52** and not for the nation only, but that he might also gather together into one the children of God who are scattered abroad.[149]

**53** So from that day forward they took counsel that they might put him to death.

**54** Jesus therefore walked no more openly among the Jews, but departed from there into the country near the wilderness, to a city called Ephraim. He stayed there with his disciples.

**55** Now the Passover of the Jews was at hand. Many went up from the country to Jerusalem before the Passover, to purify themselves.[150]

**56** Then they sought for Jesus and spoke one with another, as they stood in the temple, “What do you think—that he isn’t coming to the feast at all?”

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[145] **Cross-Reference:** Psalm 116:16 • Isaiah 61:1 - *you have freed me from my chains, and the opening of the prison to those who are bound*

[146] **Cross-Reference:** Jeremiah 7:4 • Jeremiah 7:14 - *do not trust in lying words, the temple of Yahweh, and I will do to this house as I did to Shiloh*

[147] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Isaiah 53:8 • Daniel 9:26 - *cut off out of the land of the living for the disobedience of my people, and the Anointed One cut off*

[148] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Numbers 27:21 • Exodus 28:30 - *the priest inquiring by the judgment of the Urim before Yahweh, and the high priest bearing the judgment of Israel on his heart*

[149] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Ezekiel 37:21-22 • Isaiah 11:12 - *the children of Israel gathered from among the nations and made one nation, and the outcasts of Israel and the dispersed of Judah assembled*

[150] **Cross-Reference:** Numbers 9:10 • 2 Chronicles 30:17-18 - *the Passover still kept by one unclean or far away, and Hezekiah praying for those who ate it uncleansed*

**57** Now the chief priests and the Pharisees had commanded that if anyone knew where he was, he should report it, that they might seize him.

# CHAPTER 12 - A Pound of Nard, a King on a Donkey's Colt, and Isaiah Saw His Glory

## Key Notes

- "Six days before the Passover" begins the final week. From here, John slows down; the last third of his Gospel covers only a few days (John 12:1).
- Martha served, Lazarus reclined at the table, and Mary poured. Three people, three ways of loving Him, none of them wrong (John 12:2-3).
- A pound, litra, was about eleven ounces of pure nard - a perfume made from a plant that grew in the Himalayas. Judas priced it at three hundred denarii, about a year's wages for a laborer (John 12:3, 12:5).
- Mark and Matthew say she poured it on His head. John says His feet. A pound of perfume is enough for both. Kings were anointed on the head; feet were the place a servant knelt (John 12:3, Mark 14:3).
- She wiped His feet with her hair. A respectable woman did not let her hair down in front of men. She did not care what it cost her (John 12:3).
- "The house was filled with the fragrance." The Song of Songs: while the king sat at his table, my perfume spread its fragrance. Everyone who left that house smelled of it (John 12:3, Song of Solomon 1:12).
- Judas objects on behalf of the poor. John tells us he did not care about the poor; he kept the money box and stole from it. The loudest objection to extravagant worship came from the thief (John 12:4-6).
- "She has kept this for the day of my burial." She may have understood what the twelve kept refusing to hear (John 12:7).
- "You always have the poor with you" is Deuteronomy 15, which goes on: therefore open your hand wide to the poor. It is not permission to ignore them. It is a reminder that the chance to anoint Him was almost over (John 12:8, Deuteronomy 15:11).
- The chief priests plot to kill Lazarus too, because he is evidence. A living man who had been dead four days was very bad for their case (John 12:10-11).
- Palm branches are the branches of Tabernacles, commanded in Leviticus 23 for rejoicing before Yahweh, and they had become a symbol of national victory. The crowd is waving a feast and a liberation at the same time (John 12:13, Leviticus 23:40).
- "Hosanna" is Hebrew for save now, from Psalm 118, one of the psalms sung at the feasts. Blessed is he who comes in the name of Yahweh is the next verse (John 12:13, Psalm 118:25-26).
- "The King of Israel" is what Nathanael called Him in chapter 1. Now a whole city says it - and in a few days a sign over His head will say it in three languages (John 12:13, 1:49, 19:19).

- He rides a young donkey, as Zechariah said - lowly, not on a warhorse. John opens the quotation with don't be afraid, daughter of Zion, words that echo Zephaniah (John 12:14-15, Zechariah 9:9, Zephaniah 3:16).
- "His disciples didn't understand these things at first." John admits they missed it, and only connected the Scripture to the event after He was glorified (John 12:16).
- "Look, the world has gone after him." They meant everyone. Two verses later the world arrives, in the form of Greeks (John 12:19-20).
- The Greeks come to Philip, who has a Greek name and was from Bethsaida in Galilee. Philip goes to Andrew, and the two of them go to Yahshua. The same two men who brought people to Him in chapter 1 (John 12:21-22, 1:43-45).
- "The time has come for the Son of Man to be glorified." The hour that was not yet at Cana has arrived. And glorified, in this Gospel, means the cross (John 12:23, 2:4).
- A grain of wheat that falls into the ground and dies bears much fruit. The day after the Sabbath during Unleavened Bread, the first sheaf of the harvest was waved before Yahweh - the firstfruits of what had been buried and come up (John 12:24, Leviticus 23:10-11).
- "He who loves his life will lose it. He who hates his life in this world will keep it." Hate is the Hebrew way of saying love less by comparison. It is about which life you are holding onto (John 12:25).
- "Now my soul is troubled." This is John's Gethsemane. He asks out loud whether to pray to be saved from this hour, and answers Himself: no, for this cause I came to this hour (John 12:27).
- A voice from heaven answers. Some heard thunder. Some said an angel spoke. The same sound, heard three ways, depending on the hearer (John 12:28-29).
- "Now the prince of this world will be cast out." The cross looked like the defeat of Yahshua. It was the defeat of the one who held the world (John 12:31, Luke 10:18).
- "If I am lifted up from the earth, will draw all people to myself." Lifted up is the word from chapter 3 and chapter 8, and John explains it means the kind of death He would die (John 12:32-33, 3:14, 8:28).
- "We have heard out of the law that the Christ remains forever." They are right - the throne of David's son is forever. What they cannot fit is a Christ who dies first (John 12:34, Psalm 89:36).
- Isaiah 53:1 - who has believed our report - opens the suffering servant passage, and John quotes it over the end of the public ministry. The signs were done, and they still did not believe (John 12:37-38, Isaiah 53:1).
- "Isaiah said these things when he saw his glory, and spoke of him." The glory Isaiah saw was the Lord on the throne, high and lifted up, with the seraphim crying holy, holy, holy, Yahweh of Armies. John says that was Yahshua (John 12:41, Isaiah 6:1-3).
- "High and lifted up" in Isaiah 6 is the same pair of words Isaiah uses for the suffering servant in chapter 52: exalted and lifted up, and very high. The throne and the cross are described in the same language (John 12:41, Isaiah 6:1, 52:13).

- Many of the rulers believed in Him but would not confess it, for fear of being put out of the synagogue. They loved the praise of men more than the praise of God. Belief that will not be seen is a kind of fear (John 12:42-43).
- “He who believes in me, believes not in me, but in him who sent me.” To see Him is to see the Father (John 12:44-45, 14:9).
- “The word that I spoke, the same will judge him in the last day.” The promise of Deuteronomy 18: whoever will not listen to my words, which the prophet speaks in my name, I will require it of him (John 12:48, Deuteronomy 18:19).
- “I know that his commandment is eternal life.” The public ministry ends on the Father’s commandment, and calls it life (John 12:50).

## Key Cross-References (WEB)

| Topic | References |
|---|---|
| My Perfume Spread Its Fragrance | John 12:3 • Song of Solomon 1:12 • Song of Solomon 4:14 |
| Spices for a Burial | John 12:7 • 2 Chronicles 16:14 |
| The Poor Will Never Cease | John 12:8 • Deuteronomy 15:11 |
| Branches of Palm Trees | John 12:13 • Leviticus 23:40 • Nehemiah 8:15 |
| Firstfruits of the Harvest | John 12:24 • Leviticus 23:10-11 • 1 Corinthians 15:36-37 |
| The Prince of This World Cast Out | John 12:31 • Luke 10:18 |
| The Throne That Remains Forever | John 12:34 • Psalm 89:36-37 • Isaiah 9:7 |
| The Fear of Man | John 12:43 • Proverbs 29:25 • 1 Samuel 15:24 |

## Prophecy Fulfilled

| Fulfillment | References |
|---|---|
| Hosanna, Blessed Is He Who Comes | John 12:13 • Psalm 118:25-26 |
| Your King Comes on a Donkey’s Colt | John 12:15 • Zechariah 9:9 • Zephaniah 3:16 |
| Lifted Up to Draw All People | John 12:32 • Isaiah 52:13 • Isaiah 11:10 |
| Who Has Believed Our Report? | John 12:38 • Isaiah 53:1 |
| Eyes Shut, Hearts Made Fat | John 12:40 • Isaiah 6:10 |
| Isaiah Saw His Glory | John 12:41 • Isaiah 6:1-3 • Isaiah 52:13 |
| The Words the Father Commanded | John 12:49 • Deuteronomy 18:18-19 |

## For Further Study

Credible external commentary that expounds on this chapter in a way consistent with a Torah-honoring, Messianic reading of the text:

- Enduring Word - John 12 Commentary (David Guzik) - the anointing at Bethany, the triumphal entry, and the grain of wheat
- Life, Hope and Truth - The Gospel of John - John's signs, the I AM sayings, and why this Gospel differs from the other three
- Verse By Verse Ministry International - The Gospel of John, Lesson 12A - exposition of the anointing and the entry into Jerusalem

## John 12 - Introduction

Six days before Passover the final week begins at a dinner in Bethany. Martha serves, Lazarus - who had been dead - reclines at the table, and Mary pours a pound of pure nard, worth about a year's wages, over Yahshua's feet and wipes them with her hair, which a respectable woman did not let down in front of men. She counts neither the money nor her reputation, and the house is filled with the fragrance. Judas objects in the name of the poor, and John records that he was a thief who stole from the common purse. The loudest objection to extravagant worship comes from him. Yahshua defends her: she has kept it for His burial. She may have been the only one listening when He spoke of His death.

The next day a crowd goes out with palm branches - the branches of Tabernacles, taken in Leviticus to rejoice before Yahweh - crying Hosanna, save now, and blessed is he who comes in the name of Yahweh, from Psalm 118. He enters on a young donkey, lowly, as Zechariah foretold, and John admits that the disciples understood none of it until after He was glorified. Then Greeks come asking to see Jesus, and He answers that the hour has come - the hour that had not yet come at Cana - and speaks of a grain of wheat that must fall into the ground and die to bear fruit, the shape of the firstfruits sheaf waved before Yahweh during Unleavened Bread.

Here John shows his Gethsemane. His soul is troubled; shall He pray to be saved from this hour? No, for this He came. A voice answers from heaven, heard by some as thunder and by others as an angel. Now the prince of this world is cast out, and He, lifted up from the earth, will draw all people to Himself - lifted up, John explains, describing the death He would die.

John closes the public ministry with Isaiah: who has believed our report, and the eyes that were blinded. Then he adds that Isaiah said these things because he saw His glory. The glory Isaiah saw was the Lord enthroned, high and lifted up, with the seraphim crying holy to Yahweh of Armies - and John identifies Him as Yahshua. Isaiah uses the same words, high and lifted up, for the suffering servant whose face would be marred beyond any man's. The throne and the cross are spoken of in the same language. The chapter ends with rulers who believed but would not confess it, loving the praise of men more than the praise of God.

## John 12:1-50 (WEB)

**1** Then six days before the Passover, Jesus came to Bethany, where Lazarus was, who had been dead, whom he raised from the dead.

**2** So they made him a supper there. Martha served, but Lazarus was one of those who sat at the table with him.

**3** Mary, therefore, took a pound of ointment of pure nard, very precious, and anointed the feet of Jesus, and wiped his feet with her hair. The house was filled with the fragrance of the ointment.[151]

**4** Then Judas Iscariot, Simon's son, one of his disciples, who would betray him, said,

**5** "Why wasn't this ointment sold for three hundred denarii, and given to the poor?"

**6** Now he said this, not because he cared for the poor, but because he was a thief, and having the money box, used to steal what was put into it.

**7** But Jesus said, "Leave her alone. She has kept this for the day of my burial.[152]

**8** For you always have the poor with you, but you don't always have me."[153]

**9** A large crowd therefore of the Jews learned that he was there, and they came, not for Jesus' sake only, but that they might see Lazarus also, whom he had raised from the dead.

**10** But the chief priests conspired to put Lazarus to death also,

**11** because on account of him many of the Jews went away and believed in Jesus.

**12** On the next day a great multitude had come to the feast. When they heard that Jesus was coming to Jerusalem,

**13** they took the branches of the palm trees, and went out to meet him, and cried out, "Hosanna! Blessed is he who comes in the name of the Lord, the King of Israel!"[154,155]

**14** Jesus, having found a young donkey, sat on it. As it is written,

**15** "Don't be afraid, daughter of Zion. Behold, your King comes, sitting on a donkey's colt."[156]

**16** His disciples didn't understand these things at first, but when Jesus was glorified, then they remembered that these things were written about him, and that they had done these things to him.

**17** The multitude therefore that was with him when he called Lazarus out of the tomb, and raised him from the dead, was testifying about it.

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[151] **Cross-Reference:** Song of Solomon 1:12 • Song of Solomon 4:14 - *while the king sat at his table my perfume spread its fragrance, and spikenard among all the best spices*

[152] **Cross-Reference:** 2 Chronicles 16:14 - *a king laid in a bed filled with sweet odors and spices prepared by the perfumers' art*

[153] **Cross-Reference:** Deuteronomy 15:11 - *the poor will never cease out of the land, therefore open your hand to your needy and your poor*

[154] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Psalm 118:25-26 - *save us now, Yahweh, and blessed is he who comes in Yahweh's name*

[155] **Cross-Reference:** Leviticus 23:40 • Nehemiah 8:15 - *branches of palm trees taken to rejoice before Yahweh seven days, and palm branches gathered to make shelters*

[156] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Zechariah 9:9 • Zephaniah 3:16 - *your King comes to you, lowly and riding on a colt, the foal of a donkey, and do not be afraid, Zion*

**18** For this cause also the multitude went and met him, because they heard that he had done this sign.

**19** The Pharisees therefore said among themselves, “See how you accomplish nothing. Behold, the world has gone after him.”

**20** Now there were certain Greeks among those that went up to worship at the feast.

**21** These, therefore, came to Philip, who was from Bethsaida of Galilee, and asked him, saying, “Sir, we want to see Jesus.”

**22** Philip came and told Andrew, and in turn, Andrew came with Philip, and they told Jesus.

**23** Jesus answered them, “The time has come for the Son of Man to be glorified.

**24** Most certainly I tell you, unless a grain of wheat falls into the earth and dies, it remains by itself alone. But if it dies, it bears much fruit.[157]

**25** He who loves his life will lose it. He who hates his life in this world will keep it to eternal life.

**26** If anyone serves me, let him follow me. Where I am, there will my servant also be. If anyone serves me, the Father will honor him.

**27** “Now my soul is troubled. What shall I say? ‘Father, save me from this time?’ But for this cause I came to this time.

**28** Father, glorify your name!” Then there came a voice out of the sky, saying, “I have both glorified it, and will glorify it again.”

**29** The multitude therefore, who stood by and heard it, said that it had thundered. Others said, “An angel has spoken to him.”

**30** Jesus answered, “This voice hasn’t come for my sake, but for your sakes.

**31** Now is the judgment of this world. Now the prince of this world will be cast out.[158]

**32** And I, if I am lifted up from the earth, will draw all people to myself.”[159]

**33** But he said this, signifying by what kind of death he should die.

**34** The multitude answered him, “We have heard out of the law that the Christ remains forever. How do you say, ‘The Son of Man must be lifted up?’ Who is this Son of Man?”[160]

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[157] **Cross-Reference:** Leviticus 23:10-11 • 1 Corinthians 15:36-37 - *the sheaf of the firstfruits waved before Yahweh, and what you sow is not made alive unless it dies*

[158] **Cross-Reference:** Luke 10:18 - *I saw Satan having fallen like lightning from heaven*

[159] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Isaiah 52:13 • Isaiah 11:10 - *my servant exalted and lifted up and very high, and the nations seeking the root of Jesse, a banner of the peoples*

[160] **Cross-Reference:** Psalm 89:36-37 • Isaiah 9:7 - *his offspring enduring forever and his throne like the sun, and no end to his government on David’s throne*

**35** Jesus therefore said to them, “Yet a little while the light is with you. Walk while you have the light, that darkness doesn’t overtake you. He who walks in the darkness doesn’t know where he is going.

**36** While you have the light, believe in the light, that you may become children of light.” Jesus said these things, and he departed and hid himself from them.

**37** But though he had done so many signs before them, yet they didn’t believe in him,

**38** that the word of Isaiah the prophet might be fulfilled, which he spoke, “Lord, who has believed our report? To whom has the arm of the Lord been revealed?”[161]

**39** For this cause they couldn’t believe, for Isaiah said again,

**40** “He has blinded their eyes and he hardened their heart, lest they should see with their eyes, and perceive with their heart, and would turn, and I would heal them.”[162]

**41** Isaiah said these things when he saw his glory, and spoke of him.[163]

**42** Nevertheless even of the rulers many believed in him, but because of the Pharisees they didn’t confess it, so that they wouldn’t be put out of the synagogue,

**43** for they loved men’s praise more than God’s praise.[164]

**44** Jesus cried out and said, “Whoever believes in me, believes not in me, but in him who sent me.

**45** He who sees me sees him who sent me.

**46** I have come as a light into the world, that whoever believes in me may not remain in the darkness.

**47** If anyone listens to my sayings, and doesn’t believe, I don’t judge him. For I came not to judge the world, but to save the world.

**48** He who rejects me, and doesn’t receive my sayings, has one who judges him. The word that I spoke, the same will judge him in the last day.

**49** For I spoke not from myself, but the Father who sent me, he gave me a commandment, what I should say, and what I should speak.[165]

**50** I know that his commandment is eternal life. The things therefore which I speak, even as the Father has said to me, so I speak.”

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[161] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Isaiah 53:1 - *who has believed our message, and to whom has the arm of Yahweh been revealed*

[162] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Isaiah 6:10 - *make the heart of this people fat and shut their eyes, lest they see and turn again and be healed*

[163] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Isaiah 6:1-3 • Isaiah 52:13 - *the Lord on a throne high and lifted up with the seraphim crying holy, holy, holy, and the servant exalted and lifted up*

[164] **Cross-Reference:** Proverbs 29:25 • 1 Samuel 15:24 - *the fear of man is a snare, and Saul sinning because he feared the people and obeyed their voice*

[165] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Deuteronomy 18:18-19 - *my words in his mouth, and whoever will not listen to the words he speaks in my name, I will require it of him*

## Major Themes Across John 10-12

- False shepherds who threw a healed sheep over the wall
- A shepherd who calls his own by name and goes before them
- The door, lying across the gap so nothing passes but over Him
- Life overflowing, not life barely kept
- Yahweh Himself the shepherd, and David's son set over the flock, both at once
- A hired hand who runs, and an owner who lays down his life
- Other sheep, one flock, one shepherd
- A life no one took, laid down and taken up on His own authority
- One hand holding the sheep, called His and the Father's
- I and the Father are one, the Shema spoken from within
- The one set apart and sent, at the feast of setting apart
- Everything John said about Him proved true
- A message that named the need and trusted the love
- Love and delay joined by the word therefore
- Thomas the doubter as the man who said let us die with Him
- Martha's correct theology meeting the resurrection in person
- Truth for Martha and tears for Mary, after the same sentence
- Anger at death and tears at a tomb He was about to empty
- Faith on the road faltering at the stone
- A dead man called by name, and grave clothes loosed by others
- The miracle that sealed His death
- A prophecy spoken unknowingly by the high priest who wanted Him dead
- Scattered children gathered into one
- A pound of nard and a house filled with its fragrance
- The loudest objection to worship coming from the thief
- Palm branches of the feast and Hosanna on the road
- A King lowly enough to ride a donkey's colt
- Greeks asking to see Him, and the hour arriving
- A grain of wheat buried to become a harvest
- John's Gethsemane: for this hour I came
- One voice from heaven heard as thunder, an angel, or the Father
- Lifted up, meaning the death He would die and the people He would draw

- Isaiah’s throne vision, and John saying the one on it was Yahshua
- High and lifted up: the throne and the cross in the same words
- Belief that stayed hidden for love of the praise of men

# CHAPTER 13 - A Towel and a Basin, a Morsel Handed to a Traitor, and a New Commandment

## Key Notes

- “Before the feast of the Passover” is John’s own time stamp on this meal. The next morning the leaders will not enter the governor’s house so that they can still eat the Passover, and the day of the crucifixion is called the preparation of the Passover. In John, this supper comes before the Passover meal (John 13:1, 18:28, 19:14).
- “He loved them to the end” can also mean to the uttermost, completely. The word is from the same root as His last word on the cross: it is finished (John 13:1, 19:30).
- Judas had already been given the thought by the devil before the washing began. Yahshua washed his feet knowing it (John 13:2, 13:11).
- “Knowing that the Father had given all things into his hands” - and what He did with all things in His hands was pick up a towel. Power, in this Gospel, kneels (John 13:3-4).
- “Laid aside his outer garments” uses the same verb He used for laying down His life in chapter 10, and “put his outer garment back on” uses the same verb as taking it up again. The foot washing is the cross acted out in a room (John 13:4, 13:12, 10:17-18).
- Washing feet was so low a task that it was given to the lowest servant in a house. Abigail offered to wash the feet of David’s servants as the humblest thing she could say (John 13:5, 1 Samuel 25:41).
- “You will never wash my feet!” Peter’s refusal sounds humble and is actually pride. He wants to be the one who serves, not the one who needs it (John 13:8).
- “If I don’t wash you, you have no part with me.” Being served by Him is not optional. Everyone who belongs to Him has to let Him kneel (John 13:8).
- “Someone who has bathed only needs to have his feet washed.” A guest bathed at home and only his feet got dirty on the road. Cleansing once, and then daily washing of what the walk picks up (John 13:10, Exodus 30:19-21).
- “You ought also to wash one another’s feet.” Some assemblies practice it literally; all are commanded the thing it means (John 13:14-15).
- “A servant is not greater than his lord.” Said here about serving, and repeated two chapters later about suffering (John 13:16, 15:20).
- “He who eats bread with me has lifted up his heel against me” is Psalm 41, David on a trusted friend who turned. To lift the heel is to kick, or to show contempt (John 13:18, Psalm 41:9).
- “That you may believe that I am he” is ego eimi again, and again in the words of Isaiah: I declare the end from the beginning. He tells them beforehand so that the betrayal will confirm Him rather than shake them (John 13:19, Isaiah 46:10).

- “He was troubled in spirit” - the same word used at Lazarus’s tomb and in 12:27. Betrayal by a friend hurt Him (John 13:21, 11:33, 12:27).
- They reclined at table, on their left sides, heads toward the table. The disciple whom Jesus loved was next to Him, at His breast - the same word used of the Son in the bosom of the Father (John 13:23, 1:18).
- “The disciple whom Jesus loved” first appears here and is never named. The traditional answer is John the son of Zebedee, the author. He calls himself by the one thing he was sure of (John 13:23, 21:20-24).
- To dip a piece of bread and hand it to someone was a mark of honor from the host. Boaz did it for Ruth. The last thing Yahshua offered Judas was friendship (John 13:26, Ruth 2:14).
- “After the piece of bread, then Satan entered into him.” He took the honor and left with the enemy (John 13:27).
- “What you do, do quickly.” No one at the table understood it. Some thought He was sending Judas to give something to the poor (John 13:27-29).
- “He went out immediately. It was night.” Four words in Greek. He walked away from the light of the world into the dark (John 13:30, 8:12).
- “Now the Son of Man has been glorified.” The moment the betrayer leaves, Yahshua calls it glory. The cross has begun (John 13:31).
- “Little children” is the only time He calls them that in the Gospels. John picked it up and used it all through his letters (John 13:33, 1 John 2:1).
- Love your neighbor as yourself was not new. It is in Leviticus 19. What is new is the measure: just as I have loved you. The standard moved from self to Him (John 13:34, Leviticus 19:18).
- “By this everyone will know that you are my disciples.” Not by doctrine, not by dress, not by argument - though all have their place. By love for one another (John 13:35).
- “I will lay down my life for you.” Peter means it, and he will draw a sword in the garden to prove it. Pride goes before a fall, and the fall is a few hours away (John 13:37, 18:10, Proverbs 16:18).
- “The rooster won’t crow until you have denied me three times.” He predicts the failure, and in chapter 21 He will restore it three times over (John 13:38, 21:15-17).

## Key Cross-References (WEB)

| Topic | References |
|---|---|
| The Fourteenth Day at Evening | John 13:1 • Exodus 12:6 • Leviticus 23:5 |
| A Servant to Wash Feet | John 13:5 • 1 Samuel 25:41 • Genesis 18:4 |
| Washed and Clean | John 13:10 • Exodus 30:19-21 • Ezekiel 36:25 |
| Not Above His Lord | John 13:16 • Matthew 10:24 |
| Bread Dipped and Given | John 13:26 • Ruth 2:14 |

| Topic | References |
|---|---|
| Love Your Neighbor as Yourself | John 13:34 • Leviticus 19:18 • Leviticus 19:34 |
| Pride Before a Fall | John 13:37 • Proverbs 16:18 • Psalm 30:6-7 |

## Prophecy Fulfilled

| Fulfillment | References |
|---|---|
| Loved With an Everlasting Love | John 13:1 • Jeremiah 31:3 • Hosea 11:4 |
| My Servant | John 13:4 • Isaiah 42:1 • Isaiah 49:3 |
| He Lifted Up His Heel | John 13:18 • Psalm 41:9 • Psalm 55:12-14 |
| Declaring the End From the Beginning | John 13:19 • Isaiah 46:9-10 • Isaiah 43:10 |
| The Son of Man Glorified | John 13:31 • Daniel 7:14 • Isaiah 49:3 |
| The Law Written on the Heart | John 13:34 • Jeremiah 31:33 • Ezekiel 36:26-27 |

## For Further Study

Credible external commentary that expounds on this chapter in a way consistent with a Torah-honoring, Messianic reading of the text:

- Enduring Word - John 13 Commentary (David Guzik) - the foot washing, the betrayer revealed, and the new commandment
- Life, Hope and Truth - The Gospel of John - John's signs, the I AM sayings, and why this Gospel differs from the other three
- Verse By Verse Ministry International - The Gospel of John, Lesson 13A - exposition of the upper room and the washing of the disciples' feet

## John 13 - Introduction

John dates the meal precisely: before the feast of the Passover. And he opens it with a sentence that governs the rest of the book - having loved His own who were in the world, He loved them to the end, to the uttermost, with a word from the same root as the cry it is finished. Knowing that the Father had given all things into His hands, Yahshua rises from supper, lays aside His outer garments, wraps a towel around His waist and washes the disciples' feet, the work of the lowest servant in a house. The verbs are the ones He used for laying down His life and taking it up again. The washing is the cross acted out in a room.

Peter refuses, which sounds like humility and is pride: he would rather serve than be served. Told that unless he is washed he has no part with Him, he asks for his head and hands as well, and is told that one who has bathed needs only his feet washed - a cleansing once, and then the daily washing of what the road picks up. Yahshua adds that not all of them are clean, because He knows who will betray Him, and

He has washed that man's feet too. Then He tells them to do for one another what He has done for them.

Troubled in spirit, He announces that one of them will betray Him. Prompted by Peter, the disciple whom Jesus loved, reclining against His breast, asks who it is, and Yahshua answers by dipping a piece of bread and giving it to Judas - a host's gesture of honor. The last thing He offered Judas was friendship. After the bread Satan enters him, and he goes out. It was night. He walks away from the light of the world into the dark, and the moment he is gone Yahshua says that the Son of Man is glorified.

To the eleven, whom He calls little children for the only time, He gives a new commandment: love one another as I have loved you. Love of neighbor was as old as Leviticus 19; what is new is the measure, moved from self to Him, and He has just shown them what it looks like. Peter vows to lay down his life, and is told that before the rooster crows he will deny Him three times. At that table sat a betrayer and a man who would fail by morning, and He loved them to the end.

## John 13:1-38 (WEB)

**1** Now before the feast of the Passover, Jesus, knowing that his time had come that he would depart from this world to the Father, having loved his own who were in the world, he loved them to the end.[166]

**2** During supper, the devil having already put into the heart of Judas Iscariot, Simon's son, to betray him,

**3** Jesus, knowing that the Father had given all things into his hands, and that he came from God, and was going to God,

**4** arose from supper, and laid aside his outer garments. He took a towel, and wrapped a towel around his waist.[167]

**5** Then he poured water into the basin, and began to wash the disciples' feet, and to wipe them with the towel that was wrapped around him.[168]

**6** Then he came to Simon Peter. He said to him, "Lord, do you wash my feet?"

**7** Jesus answered him, "You don't know what I am doing now, but you will understand later."

**8** Peter said to him, "You will never wash my feet!" Jesus answered him, "If I don't wash you, you have no part with me."

**9** Simon Peter said to him, "Lord, not my feet only, but also my hands and my head!"

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[166] **Cross-Reference:** Exodus 12:6 • Leviticus 23:5 - *the lamb kept until the fourteenth day and killed at evening, Yahweh's Passover*

[167] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Isaiah 42:1 • Isaiah 49:3 - *behold my servant whom I uphold, my chosen, and you are my servant, in whom I will be glorified*

[168] **Cross-Reference:** 1 Samuel 25:41 • Genesis 18:4 - *Abigail's servant to wash the feet of the servants, and Abraham fetching water for his guests' feet*

**10** Jesus said to him, “Someone who has bathed only needs to have his feet washed, but is completely clean. You are clean, but not all of you.”[169]

**11** For he knew him who would betray him, therefore he said, “You are not all clean.”

**12** So when he had washed their feet, put his outer garment back on, and sat down again, he said to them, “Do you know what I have done to you?

**13** You call me, ‘Teacher’ and ‘Lord.’ You say so correctly, for so I am.

**14** If I then, the Lord and the Teacher, have washed your feet, you also ought to wash one another’s feet.

**15** For I have given you an example, that you also should do as I have done to you.

**16** Most certainly I tell you, a servant is not greater than his lord, neither one who is sent greater than he who sent him.[170]

**17** If you know these things, blessed are you if you do them.

**18** I don’t speak concerning all of you. I know whom I have chosen. But that the Scripture may be fulfilled, ‘He who eats bread with me has lifted up his heel against me.’[171]

**19** From now on, I tell you before it happens, that when it happens, you may believe that I am he.[172]

**20** Most certainly I tell you, he who receives whomever I send, receives me; and he who receives me, receives him who sent me.”

**21** When Jesus had said this, he was troubled in spirit, and testified, “Most certainly I tell you that one of you will betray me.”

**22** The disciples looked at one another, perplexed about whom he spoke.

**23** One of his disciples, whom Jesus loved, was at the table, leaning against Jesus’ breast.

**24** Simon Peter therefore beckoned to him, and said to him, “Tell us who it is of whom he speaks.”

**25** He, leaning back, as he was, on Jesus’ breast, asked him, “Lord, who is it?”

**26** Jesus therefore answered, “It is he to whom I will give this piece of bread when I have dipped it.” So when he had dipped the piece of bread, he gave it to Judas, the son of Simon Iscariot.[173]

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[169] **Cross-Reference:** Exodus 30:19-21 • Ezekiel 36:25 - *the priests washing hands and feet before they came near, and clean water sprinkled so you will be clean*

[170] **Cross-Reference:** Matthew 10:24 - *a disciple is not above his teacher, nor a servant above his lord*

[171] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Psalm 41:9 • Psalm 55:12-14 - *my familiar friend who ate bread with me has lifted up his heel against me, my companion with whom I took sweet fellowship*

[172] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Isaiah 46:9-10 • Isaiah 43:10 - *I declare the end from the beginning, and that you may know and believe me and understand that I am he*

[173] **Cross-Reference:** Ruth 2:14 - *Boaz inviting Ruth to dip her morsel and passing her grain at the meal*

**27** After the piece of bread, then Satan entered into him. Then Jesus said to him, “What you do, do quickly.”

**28** Now no man at the table knew why he said this to him.

**29** For some thought, because Judas had the money box, that Jesus said to him, “Buy what things we need for the feast,” or that he should give something to the poor.

**30** Therefore having received that morsel, he went out immediately. It was night.

**31** When he had gone out, Jesus said, “Now the Son of Man has been glorified, and God has been glorified in him.[174]

**32** If God has been glorified in him, God will also glorify him in himself, and he will glorify him immediately.

**33** Little children, I will be with you a little while longer. You will seek me, and as I said to the Jews, ‘Where I am going, you can’t come,’ so now I tell you.

**34** A new commandment I give to you, that you love one another. Just as I have loved you, you also love one another.[175,176]

**35** By this everyone will know that you are my disciples, if you have love for one another.”

**36** Simon Peter said to him, “Lord, where are you going?” Jesus answered, “Where I am going, you can’t follow now, but you will follow afterwards.”

**37** Peter said to him, “Lord, why can’t I follow you now? I will lay down my life for you.”[177]

**38** Jesus answered him, “Will you lay down your life for me? Most certainly I tell you, the rooster won’t crow until you have denied me three times.

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[174] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Daniel 7:14 • Isaiah 49:3 - *glory and a kingdom given to the son of man, and my servant in whom I will be glorified*

[175] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Jeremiah 31:33 • Ezekiel 36:26-27 - *my law written in their heart, and a new heart and my Spirit within you to walk in my statutes*

[176] **Cross-Reference:** Leviticus 19:18 - *love your neighbor as yourself, I am Yahweh*

[177] **Cross-Reference:** Proverbs 16:18 • Psalm 30:6-7 - *pride goes before destruction, and I said in my prosperity, I shall never be moved*

# CHAPTER 14 - Let Not Your Heart Be Troubled, the Way to the Father, and Another Counselor

## Key Notes

- There is no chapter break in the conversation. Peter has just been told he will deny Him, and the next words are let not your heart be troubled. The comfort is spoken to a man about to fail (John 14:1, 13:38).
- “You believe in God. Believe also in me.” The Greek can be read as statements or commands. Either way He puts faith in Himself on the same level as faith in God (John 14:1).
- “In my Father’s house are many homes.” The word for homes is related to the verb remain, which runs through these chapters. Dwelling places, places to stay. It reappears in verse 23 for the home the Father and Son make with the believer (John 14:2, 14:23).
- “My Father’s house” was the temple in chapter 2. Here it is bigger than any building. And Revelation ends with God’s dwelling coming down to be with people, the holy city prepared like a bride (John 14:2, 2:16, Revelation 21:2-3).
- Many readers hear a wedding in these verses: a bridegroom going ahead to prepare a place and coming back for his bride. The details often attached to it come from later sources, but the picture fits a Gospel that has already called Him the bridegroom (John 14:2-3, 3:29).
- “I will come again, and will receive you to myself; that where I am, you may be there also.” The promise is not first a place. It is a Person. Where I am (John 14:3).
- “How can we know the way?” Thomas asks the honest question everyone else was too embarrassed to ask, and gets the answer the whole world quotes (John 14:5).
- “I am the way, the truth, and the life” is the sixth of the seven I AM sayings with a picture. The earliest believers were called simply the Way (John 14:6, Acts 9:2).
- “No one comes to the Father, except through me” is not a door slammed. It is a door opened, in the only place a door could be (John 14:6, 10:9).
- “Lord, show us the Father, and that will be enough for us.” Moses asked: show me your glory, and was told no man may see my face and live (John 14:8, Exodus 33:18-20).
- “He who has seen me has seen the Father.” Philip had been looking at the answer to Moses’s prayer for three years (John 14:9).
- “I am in the Father, and the Father in me.” Not two who agree. One who dwells in the other (John 14:10-11, 10:38).
- “Greater works than these he will do” - greater in reach, not in kind. A few thousand heard Him in Galilee; the Way went to the ends of the earth (John 14:12).
- “If you will ask anything in my name, I will do it.” In His name means as His representative, on His business, the way an agent signs for the one who sent him (John 14:13-14).

- “If you love me, keep my commandments” is the language of the ten commandments themselves: loving kindness to thousands of those who love me and keep my commandments. Love and obedience were never opposites (John 14:15, Exodus 20:6, Deuteronomy 7:9).
- “Another Counselor” - parakletos, one called alongside, an advocate, a helper. And another means another of the same kind. The Spirit will be to them what He has been (John 14:16).
- “He lives with you, and will be in you.” Ezekiel promised it: I will put my Spirit within you, and cause you to walk in my statutes (John 14:17, Ezekiel 36:27).
- “I will not leave you orphans.” A teacher’s disciples were sometimes called his children, and a rabbi’s death left them orphaned. He promises they will not be (John 14:18).
- “Because I live, you will live also.” His resurrection is the guarantee of theirs (John 14:19).
- “He who has my commandments, and keeps them, that person is one who loves me.” Said twice in seven verses, in case they missed it (John 14:15, 14:21).
- Judas - not Iscariot - asks the only question this disciple asks in the Gospels: why show yourself to us and not to the world? (John 14:22).
- “We will come to him, and make our home with him.” I will set my tent among you, and walk among you, Yahweh said in Leviticus. The Father and the Son move in (John 14:23, Leviticus 26:11-12).
- “He will teach you all things, and will remind you of all that I said to you.” This is how the Gospel John is writing came to be remembered (John 14:26).
- “Peace I leave with you. My peace I give to you.” Shalom was the ordinary goodbye. He gives it as an inheritance. Not as the world gives - the world gives peace by taking away the trouble; He gives it in the middle of it (John 14:27).
- “The Father is greater than I” is said by the Son who has taken the form of a servant, going to the cross. It is the same Son who said I and the Father are one (John 14:28, 10:30).
- “The prince of the world comes, and he has nothing in me.” No foothold, no claim, nothing to hold onto (John 14:30).
- “Arise, let us go from here.” And then three more chapters of teaching. Many think they left the room here and the rest was spoken on the way to the garden (John 14:31, 18:1).

## Key Cross-References (WEB)

| Topic | References |
|---|---|
| Why Are You in Despair? | John 14:1 • Psalm 42:11 • Isaiah 26:3 |
| The House of Yahweh Forever | John 14:2 • Psalm 23:6 • Revelation 21:2-3 |
| The Holy Way | John 14:6 • Isaiah 35:8 • Jeremiah 6:16 |
| Show Me Your Glory | John 14:8 • Exodus 33:18 • Exodus 33:20 |
| Call to Me and I Will Answer | John 14:13 • Jeremiah 33:3 • Psalm 145:18 |

| Topic | References |
|---|---|
| Those Who Love Me and Keep My Commandments | John 14:15 • Exodus 20:6 • Deuteronomy 7:9 |
| I Will Set My Tent Among You | John 14:23 • Leviticus 26:11-12 • Ezekiel 37:27 |
| Yahweh Give You Peace | John 14:27 • Numbers 6:26 • Isaiah 26:12 |

## Prophecy Fulfilled

| Fulfillment | References |
|---|---|
| He Will Come Again | John 14:3 • Zechariah 14:4-5 • Daniel 7:13 |
| The God of Truth | John 14:6 • Psalm 86:11 • Isaiah 65:16 |
| Behold, Your God | John 14:9 • Isaiah 40:9 • Isaiah 9:6 |
| My Spirit Within You | John 14:17 • Ezekiel 36:27 • Joel 2:28 |
| A Father of the Fatherless | John 14:18 • Psalm 68:5 • Psalm 27:10 |
| They Shall All Know Me | John 14:26 • Jeremiah 31:34 • Isaiah 11:2 |
| He Will Be Our Peace | John 14:27 • Micah 5:5 • Isaiah 9:6 |

## For Further Study

Credible external commentary that expounds on this chapter in a way consistent with a Torah-honoring, Messianic reading of the text:

- Enduring Word - John 14 Commentary (David Guzik) - the Father's house, the way, the truth and the life, and the promise of the Counselor
- Life, Hope and Truth - The Gospel of John - John's signs, the I AM sayings, and why this Gospel differs from the other three
- Verse By Verse Ministry International - The Gospel of John, Lesson 14A - exposition of the upper room discourse and the promise of the Spirit

## John 14 - Introduction

The chapter follows directly on the prediction of Peter's denial, and its first words are let not your heart be troubled. The comfort is spoken to a man about to fail, before the failure rather than after it. Believe in God, He says, and believe also in Me, putting faith in Himself on the level of faith in God. In His Father's house - the temple of chapter 2, now enlarged beyond any building, and in Revelation the dwelling of God that comes down to be with people - are many dwelling places, and He goes to prepare one and will come again, so that where He is they may be. The promise is first a Person, then a place.

Thomas asks how they can know the way, and is told that Yahshua is the way, the truth and the life, and that no one comes to the Father except through Him - not a door closed but the only door that could be opened. Philip asks to be shown the Father, which is what Moses asked on the mountain and was

refused, and he is told that whoever has seen Yahshua has seen the Father. He had been looking at the answer to Moses's prayer for three years.

If you love Me, keep My commandments: it is the language of the ten commandments themselves and of Deuteronomy's faithful God who keeps covenant with those who love Him and keep His commandments. Love and obedience were never opposed. With that comes the promise of another Counselor, an advocate called alongside, of the same kind as Yahshua Himself - the Spirit of truth, now with them and soon in them, as Ezekiel foresaw the Spirit placed within to cause Israel to walk in Yahweh's statutes.

They will not be left orphans. The Father and the Son will come and make their home with whoever keeps His word, using the word for the dwelling places of verse 2. The Spirit will teach them and remind them of everything He said, which is how this Gospel came to be remembered. Then He leaves them His peace, not as the world gives it by removing trouble, but in the middle of it - spoken to frightened men on the worst night of their lives. And He says: arise, let us go from here.

## John 14:1-31 (WEB)

**1** "Don't let your heart be troubled. Believe in God. Believe also in me.[178]

**2** In my Father's house are many homes. If it weren't so, I would have told you. I am going to prepare a place for you.[179]

**3** If I go and prepare a place for you, I will come again, and will receive you to myself; that where I am, you may be there also.[180]

**4** Where I go, you know, and you know the way."

**5** Thomas said to him, "Lord, we don't know where you are going. How can we know the way?"

**6** Jesus said to him, "I am the way, the truth, and the life. No one comes to the Father, except through me.[181]

**7** If you had known me, you would have known my Father also. From now on, you know him, and have seen him."

**8** Philip said to him, "Lord, show us the Father, and that will be enough for us."[182]

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[178] **Cross-Reference:** Psalm 42:11 • Isaiah 26:3 - *why are you in despair, my soul, hope in God, and perfect peace for the mind that trusts in you*

[179] **Cross-Reference:** Psalm 23:6 • Revelation 21:2-3 - *I will dwell in Yahweh's house forever, and the holy city coming down with God's dwelling among people*

[180] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Zechariah 14:4-5 • Daniel 7:13 - *his feet standing on the Mount of Olives and Yahweh coming with all the holy ones, and one like a son of man coming with the clouds*

[181] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Psalm 86:11 • Isaiah 65:16 - *teach me your way and I will walk in your truth, and the God of truth*

[182] **Cross-Reference:** Exodus 33:18 • Exodus 33:20 - *please show me your glory, and you cannot see my face, for man may not see me and live*

**9** Jesus said to him, “Have I been with you such a long time, and do you not know me, Philip? He who has seen me has seen the Father. How do you say, ‘Show us the Father?’[183]

**10** Don’t you believe that I am in the Father, and the Father in me? The words that I tell you, I speak not from myself; but the Father who lives in me does his works.

**11** Believe me that I am in the Father, and the Father in me; or else believe me for the very works’ sake.

**12** Most certainly I tell you, he who believes in me, the works that I do, he will do also; and he will do greater works than these, because I am going to my Father.

**13** Whatever you will ask in my name, that will I do, that the Father may be glorified in the Son.[184]

**14** If you will ask anything in my name, I will do it.

**15** If you love me, keep my commandments.[185]

**16** I will pray to the Father, and he will give you another Counselor, that he may be with you forever,—

**17** the Spirit of truth, whom the world can’t receive; for it doesn’t see him, neither knows him. You know him, for he lives with you, and will be in you.[186]

**18** I will not leave you orphans. I will come to you.[187]

**19** Yet a little while, and the world will see me no more; but you will see me. Because I live, you will live also.

**20** In that day you will know that I am in my Father, and you in me, and I in you.

**21** One who has my commandments, and keeps them, that person is one who loves me. One who loves me will be loved by my Father, and I will love him, and will reveal myself to him.”

**22** Judas (not Iscariot) said to him, “Lord, what has happened that you are about to reveal yourself to us, and not to the world?”

**23** Jesus answered him, “If a man loves me, he will keep my word. My Father will love him, and we will come to him, and make our home with him.[188]

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[183] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Isaiah 40:9 • Isaiah 9:6 - *say to the cities of Judah, behold, your God, and the son given whose name is Mighty God, Everlasting Father*

[184] **Cross-Reference:** Jeremiah 33:3 • Psalm 145:18 - *call to me and I will answer you, and Yahweh is near to all who call on him in truth*

[185] **Cross-Reference:** Exodus 20:6 • Deuteronomy 7:9 - *loving kindness to thousands of those who love me and keep my commandments, and the faithful God who keeps covenant with them*

[186] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Ezekiel 36:27 • Joel 2:28 - *I will put my Spirit within you and cause you to walk in my statutes, and I will pour out my Spirit on all flesh*

[187] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Psalm 68:5 • Psalm 27:10 - *a father of the fatherless is God in his holy habitation, and when father and mother forsake me, Yahweh will take me up*

[188] **Cross-Reference:** Leviticus 26:11-12 • Ezekiel 37:27 - *I will set my tent among you and walk among you, and my tent will be with them*

**24** He who doesn't love me doesn't keep my words. The word which you hear isn't mine, but the Father's who sent me.

**25** I have said these things to you, while still living with you.

**26** But the Counselor, the Holy Spirit, whom the Father will send in my name, he will teach you all things, and will remind you of all that I said to you.[189]

**27** Peace I leave with you. My peace I give to you; not as the world gives, give I to you. Don't let your heart be troubled, neither let it be fearful.[190,191]

**28** You heard how I told you, 'I go away, and I come to you.' If you loved me, you would have rejoiced, because I said 'I am going to my Father;' for the Father is greater than I.

**29** Now I have told you before it happens so that, when it happens, you may believe.

**30** I will no more speak much with you, for the prince of the world comes, and he has nothing in me.

**31** But that the world may know that I love the Father, and as the Father commanded me, even so I do. Arise, let us go from here.

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[189] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Jeremiah 31:34 • Isaiah 11:2 - *they shall all know me from the least to the greatest, and the Spirit of wisdom and understanding resting on him*

[190] **Cross-Reference:** Numbers 6:26 • Isaiah 26:12 - *Yahweh lift up his face toward you and give you peace, and Yahweh will ordain peace for us*

[191] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Micah 5:5 • Isaiah 9:6 - *he will be our peace, and his name will be called Prince of Peace*

# CHAPTER 15 - The True Vine, Greater Love, and Hated Without a Cause

## Key Notes

- Israel was Yahweh's vine. You brought a vine out of Egypt, the psalm says. Isaiah sang about a vineyard that produced wild grapes. Jeremiah called Israel a noble vine turned degenerate (John 15:1, Psalm 80:8, Isaiah 5:1-2, Jeremiah 2:21).
- "I am the true vine" is the last of the seven I AM sayings with a picture. Where Israel the vine failed to bear fruit, He is the vine that does. True means the real one that the others pointed to (John 15:1).
- A great golden vine decorated the entrance to the temple, according to the historian Josephus. If they passed the temple on the way to the garden, it was in front of them (John 15:1, 14:31).
- "My Father is the farmer." The vinedresser, the one who tends the vine. The whole operation is in the Father's hands (John 15:1).
- "Every branch in me that doesn't bear fruit, he takes away." The verb can also mean lifts up, as vinedressers lift trailing branches off the ground so they can bear. The WEB reads takes away (John 15:2).
- "Every branch that bears fruit, he prunes." Pruning is cutting, and it is done to the fruitful branches, not the dead ones. If you are being cut back, it may be because you are bearing (John 15:2, Isaiah 18:5).
- "You are already pruned clean because of the word which I have spoken to you." The same word in Greek serves for pruned and cleansed. The word He spoke was doing the cutting (John 15:3, 13:10).
- "Remain in me" - the word remain, or abide, appears about ten times in the first ten verses. It is the single instruction of the chapter (John 15:4-10).
- "Apart from me you can do nothing." Not less. Nothing (John 15:5).
- A branch that does not remain is thrown out and burned. Ezekiel asked what vine wood is good for, and answered: not even a peg to hang a pot on - it is fuel (John 15:6, Ezekiel 15:2-4).
- "If you remain in me, and my words remain in you, you will ask whatever you desire." His words remaining in us shape what we desire before we ask (John 15:7).
- "In this is my Father glorified, that you bear much fruit." Fruit, in Scripture, is what a life produces - character and works both. Isaiah promised Israel would fill the world with fruit (John 15:8, Isaiah 27:6).
- "If you keep my commandments, you will remain in my love; even as I have kept my Father's commandments." The Son Himself kept the Father's commandments, and He holds that up as the pattern (John 15:10).

- “That my joy may remain in you, and that your joy may be made full.” The whole chapter on pruning and remaining is aimed at joy (John 15:11, Psalm 16:11).
- “Greater love has no one than this, that someone lay down his life for his friends.” Said the night before He did exactly that (John 15:13).
- “You are my friends, if you do whatever I command you.” Friendship with Him is not casual. It shows in obedience (John 15:14).
- “No longer do I call you servants… but I have called you friends.” Abraham was called the friend of God. Yahweh spoke to Moses face to face, as a man speaks to his friend. That privilege now extends to eleven ordinary men (John 15:15, Isaiah 41:8, Exodus 33:11).
- A servant does not know what his master is doing. A friend is told. Everything He heard from the Father, He told them (John 15:15).
- “You didn’t choose me, but I chose you.” Disciples normally chose their rabbi. He reverses it. Yahweh chose Israel, not because they were many but because He loved them (John 15:16, Deuteronomy 7:6-7).
- “If the world hates you, you know that it has hated me before it hated you.” Rejection of His people is not new information. It is His own experience extended (John 15:18).
- “If they persecuted me, they will also persecute you.” The prophets were seized and stoned in the temple courts for speaking Yahweh’s word. The pattern is old (John 15:20, 2 Chronicles 24:21).
- “They hated me without a cause” is written in their law, He says - meaning the Psalms, where David says it twice. The word law here covers all of Scripture (John 15:25, Psalm 35:19, 69:4).
- “The Spirit of truth, who proceeds from the Father, will testify about me. You will also testify.” Two witnesses again - the Spirit and the disciples (John 15:26-27, Deuteronomy 19:15).

## Key Cross-References (WEB)

| Topic | References |
|---|---|
| The Vine Out of Egypt | John 15:1 • Psalm 80:8-9 • Isaiah 5:1-2 |
| A Noble Vine Turned Degenerate | John 15:1 • Jeremiah 2:21 • Hosea 10:1 |
| Pruning Hooks Before the Harvest | John 15:2 • Isaiah 18:5 • Malachi 3:3 |
| Vine Wood for the Fire | John 15:6 • Ezekiel 15:2-4 |
| Love Him and Keep His Commandments | John 15:10 • Deuteronomy 11:1 • Deuteronomy 7:9 |
| The Friend of God | John 15:15 • Isaiah 41:8 • Exodus 33:11 |
| Chosen Because He Loved You | John 15:16 • Deuteronomy 7:6-7 • Isaiah 41:9 |
| The Prophets Persecuted | John 15:20 • 2 Chronicles 24:21 • Jeremiah 26:11 |

## Prophecy Fulfilled

| Fulfillment | References |
|---|---|
| The Branch Your Right Hand Planted | John 15:1 • Psalm 80:14-15 • Isaiah 4:2 |
| Israel Will Fill the World With Fruit | John 15:5 • Isaiah 27:6 • Hosea 14:7-8 |
| Fullness of Joy | John 15:11 • Psalm 16:11 • Isaiah 61:10 |
| He Poured Out His Soul to Death | John 15:13 • Isaiah 53:12 • Isaiah 53:4-5 |
| Hated Without a Cause | John 15:25 • Psalm 35:19 • Psalm 69:4 |
| My Spirit and My Words | John 15:26 • Isaiah 59:21 • Isaiah 48:16 |

## For Further Study

Credible external commentary that expounds on this chapter in a way consistent with a Torah-honoring, Messianic reading of the text:

- Enduring Word - John 15 Commentary (David Guzik) - the true vine, abiding, friendship with Yahshua, and the world's hatred
- Life, Hope and Truth - The Gospel of John - John's signs, the I AM sayings, and why this Gospel differs from the other three
- Verse By Verse Ministry International - The Gospel of John, Lesson 15A - exposition of the vine and the branches

## John 15 - Introduction

On the way from the upper room, Yahshua says that He is the true vine and His Father the farmer. Every hearer knew the vine was Israel: the vine brought out of Egypt in Psalm 80, the vineyard of Isaiah 5 that yielded wild grapes, the noble vine of Jeremiah 2 turned degenerate. Israel was the vine that kept failing to bear fruit, and He is the true vine, the one that does what the vine was planted to do.

The farmer removes branches that bear nothing and prunes those that bear, so that they bear more. The cutting falls on the fruitful branches, not the dead ones, and the disciples are already clean - the same word as pruned - through the word He has spoken to them. Then comes the single instruction of the chapter, repeated about ten times in ten verses: remain in Me. A branch bears nothing by itself; apart from Him they can do nothing at all, and a branch that does not remain withers and is burned, since vine wood, as Ezekiel observed, is good for nothing else.

Remaining is tied to obedience: keeping His commandments as He kept His Father's. And the aim of all of it, pruning and remaining and commandments alike, is that His joy may be in them and their joy full. Greater love, He says on the night before He shows it, has no one than this, that a man lay down his life for his friends. He no longer calls them servants, who do not know their master's business, but friends - the title of Abraham, the intimacy of Moses face to face - and He reminds them that they did not choose Him; He chose them, as Yahweh chose Israel, not for their numbers but for love.

Then He prepares them for what is coming. The world hated Him first and will hate them; if it persecuted Him it will persecute them, as it did the prophets before. It hated Him without a cause, as David wrote. And the Spirit of truth, proceeding from the Father, will testify about Him, and so will they - two witnesses, as the Torah requires.

## John 15:1-27 (WEB)

**1** "I am the true vine, and my Father is the farmer.[192,193]

**2** Every branch in me that doesn't bear fruit, he takes away. Every branch that bears fruit, he prunes, that it may bear more fruit.[194]

**3** You are already pruned clean because of the word which I have spoken to you.

**4** Remain in me, and I in you. As the branch can't bear fruit by itself, unless it remains in the vine, so neither can you, unless you remain in me.

**5** I am the vine. You are the branches. He who remains in me, and I in him, the same bears much fruit, for apart from me you can do nothing.[195]

**6** If a man doesn't remain in me, he is thrown out as a branch, and is withered; and they gather them, throw them into the fire, and they are burned.[196]

**7** If you remain in me, and my words remain in you, you will ask whatever you desire, and it will be done for you.

**8** "In this is my Father glorified, that you bear much fruit; and so you will be my disciples.

**9** Even as the Father has loved me, I also have loved you. Remain in my love.

**10** If you keep my commandments, you will remain in my love; even as I have kept my Father's commandments, and remain in his love.[197]

**11** I have spoken these things to you, that my joy may remain in you, and that your joy may be made full.[198]

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[192] **Cross-Reference:** Psalm 80:8-9 • Jeremiah 2:21 - *you brought a vine out of Egypt and planted it, and I planted you a noble vine, how then have you turned degenerate*

[193] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Psalm 80:14-15 • Isaiah 4:2 - *visit this vine, the branch you made strong for yourself, and Yahweh's branch beautiful and glorious*

[194] **Cross-Reference:** Isaiah 18:5 • Malachi 3:3 - *the sprigs cut off with pruning hooks before the harvest, and the refiner purifying the sons of Levi*

[195] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Isaiah 27:6 • Hosea 14:7-8 - *Israel blossoming and filling the world with fruit, and from me your fruit is found*

[196] **Cross-Reference:** Ezekiel 15:2-4 - *vine wood good for nothing but to be cast into the fire for fuel*

[197] **Cross-Reference:** Deuteronomy 11:1 • Deuteronomy 7:9 - *love Yahweh your God and keep his commandments always, and the faithful God who keeps covenant with those who love him*

[198] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Psalm 16:11 • Isaiah 61:10 - *in your presence is fullness of joy, and I will greatly rejoice in Yahweh*

**12** “This is my commandment, that you love one another, even as I have loved you.

**13** Greater love has no one than this, that someone lay down his life for his friends.[199]

**14** You are my friends, if you do whatever I command you.

**15** No longer do I call you servants, for the servant doesn’t know what his lord does. But I have called you friends, for everything that I heard from my Father, I have made known to you.[200]

**16** You didn’t choose me, but I chose you, and appointed you, that you should go and bear fruit, and that your fruit should remain; that whatever you will ask of the Father in my name, he may give it to you.[201]

**17** “I command these things to you, that you may love one another.

**18** If the world hates you, you know that it has hated me before it hated you.

**19** If you were of the world, the world would love its own. But because you are not of the world, since I chose you out of the world, therefore the world hates you.

**20** Remember the word that I said to you: ‘A servant is not greater than his lord.’ If they persecuted me, they will also persecute you. If they kept my word, they will also keep yours.[202]

**21** But all these things will they do to you for my name’s sake, because they don’t know him who sent me.

**22** If I had not come and spoken to them, they would not have had sin; but now they have no excuse for their sin.

**23** He who hates me, hates my Father also.

**24** If I hadn’t done among them the works which no one else did, they wouldn’t have had sin. But now have they seen and also hated both me and my Father.

**25** But this happened so that the word may be fulfilled which was written in their law, ‘They hated me without a cause.’[203]

**26** “When the Counselor has come, whom I will send to you from the Father, the Spirit of truth, who proceeds from the Father, he will testify about me.[204]

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[199] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Isaiah 53:12 • Isaiah 53:4-5 - *he poured out his soul to death and bore the sin of many, and was pierced for our transgressions*

[200] **Cross-Reference:** Isaiah 41:8 • Exodus 33:11 - *the offspring of Abraham my friend, and Yahweh speaking to Moses face to face as a man speaks to his friend*

[201] **Cross-Reference:** Deuteronomy 7:6-7 • Isaiah 41:9 - *chosen as his own possession, not because you were many, and I have chosen you and not cast you away*

[202] **Cross-Reference:** 2 Chronicles 24:21 • Jeremiah 26:11 - *Zechariah stoned in the court of Yahweh’s house, and Jeremiah called worthy of death for his prophecy*

[203] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Psalm 35:19 • Psalm 69:4 - *those who hate me without a cause, more than the hairs of my head*

**27** You will also testify, because you have been with me from the beginning.

[204] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Isaiah 59:21 • Isaiah 48:16 - *my Spirit who is on you and my words in your mouth, and the Lord Yahweh has sent me, with his Spirit*

## Major Themes Across John 13-15

- A supper before the Passover, dated by John himself
- Loved to the end, in the language of it is finished
- All things in His hands, and what He did with them was pick up a towel
- Garments laid down and taken up, the cross acted out in a room
- Feet washed, including the feet of the man who would betray Him
- Pride dressed up as humility, refusing to be served
- Bathed once, and washed daily of what the road picks up
- A morsel of honor handed to a traitor
- He went out, and it was night
- Love your neighbor, now measured by as I have loved you
- Known by love for one another
- A failure foretold, and comfort spoken before it happened
- The Father's house, larger than any building, coming down to dwell with people
- A promise that is first a Person and then a place
- The way, the truth, and the life, the only door that could be opened
- The answer to Moses's prayer standing in front of Philip
- Love and obedience in the words of the ten commandments
- Another Counselor of the same kind, within and not only beside
- The Spirit who causes us to walk in His statutes
- No orphans, and a home made by the Father and the Son
- Peace in the middle of the trouble, not by its removal
- The true vine where Israel the vine had failed
- Pruning that falls on the fruitful branches
- Remain, said about ten times in ten verses
- Apart from Him, nothing
- Vine wood good only for the vine or the fire
- The Son who kept His Father's commandments
- Joy as the goal of all the cutting and remaining
- Greater love, spoken the night before He showed it
- Servants no longer, but friends, like Abraham and Moses
- Chosen by Him, not choosing Him
- Hated without a cause, and sent to testify anyway

# CHAPTER 16 - It Is Good That I Go, a Woman in Labor, and I Have Overcome the World

## Key Notes

- “These things I have spoken to you, so that you wouldn’t be caused to stumble.” He warns them in advance so that the persecution confirms Him instead of shaking them (John 16:1, 16:4).
- “Whoever kills you will think that he offers service to God.” Saul of Tarsus did exactly that, and later said he thought it his duty (John 16:2, Acts 26:9-10).
- “None of you asks me, ‘Where are you going?’” Peter had asked earlier that night. Now grief has filled them so completely that they have stopped asking (John 16:5-6, 13:36).
- “It is to your advantage that I go away.” Better for them that He leave. While He was in a body He was in one place at a time; the Spirit would be with every one of them, everywhere (John 16:7, 14:16-17).
- The Spirit will convict the world - expose it, prove it wrong - about three things: sin, righteousness, and judgment. Each gets a reason (John 16:8-11).
- Sin, because they do not believe in Me. The root sin named here is not a list of actions but unbelief toward Him (John 16:9).
- Righteousness, because I am going to the Father. The cross looked like the verdict of a guilty man. The return to the Father overturns that verdict (John 16:10).
- Judgment, because the prince of this world has been judged. Past tense, before the cross even happens. The serpent’s head was promised to be crushed from the beginning (John 16:11, Genesis 3:15).
- “I have yet many things to tell you, but you can’t bear them now.” He paces what He tells them. Some truth has to wait until a person can carry it (John 16:12).
- “He will guide you into all truth.” A guide walks with you on a road. The psalmist prayed for the same thing: guide me in your truth, and teach me (John 16:13, Psalm 25:5).
- “He will not speak from himself.” The Spirit points away from Himself to the Son, as the Son points to the Father. Nobody in this Gospel speaks on his own authority (John 16:13-14, 7:16).
- “A little while” is said seven times in four verses. The disciples keep repeating it to each other because they cannot make sense of it. Three days is a little while (John 16:16-19).
- “You will weep and lament, but the world will rejoice.” That is the weekend of the cross exactly - and the next line is your sorrow will be turned into joy, not replaced by it. The same thing that caused the grief becomes the joy (John 16:20).
- The woman in labor is a picture the prophets used for the birth of something new out of pain. Isaiah sets it right before your dead shall live (John 16:21, Isaiah 26:17-19).
- “No one will take your joy away from you.” Joy that comes from a resurrection cannot be undone by anything less (John 16:22).

- “Whatever you may ask of the Father in my name, he will give it to you.” In my name is the new thing. They had prayed before; they had never prayed like this (John 16:23-24).
- “The Father himself loves you.” He does not have to persuade a reluctant Father on their behalf. The Father already loves them (John 16:26-27).
- “I came out from the Father, and have come into the world. Again, I leave the world, and go to the Father.” The whole Gospel in two sentences (John 16:28).
- “Now you speak plainly.” They think they finally understand. Within hours they will scatter (John 16:29-32).
- “You will be scattered, everyone to his own place, and you will leave me alone.” Zechariah said it: strike the shepherd, and the sheep will be scattered (John 16:32, Zechariah 13:7).
- “Yet I am not alone, because the Father is with me.” Said before the hours on the cross when He will cry out from the psalm about being forsaken - which the other Gospels record and John does not (John 16:32, Mark 15:34).
- “In the world you have oppression.” The word means pressure, crushing, the squeezing of grapes. He does not promise it away (John 16:33).
- “Cheer up! I have overcome the world.” Said by a man about to be arrested, tried, beaten and crucified - in the past tense (John 16:33).

## Key Cross-References (WEB)

| Topic | References |
|---|---|
| Killing as Service to God | John 16:2 • Acts 26:9-10 • Isaiah 66:5 |
| Ascended on High, Giving Gifts | John 16:7 • Psalm 68:18 • Ephesians 4:8 |
| Judged in Righteousness | John 16:8 • Psalm 9:7-8 • Isaiah 11:4 |
| Guide Me in Your Truth | John 16:13 • Psalm 25:5 • Psalm 143:10 |
| A Little Moment | John 16:16 • Isaiah 26:20 • Hosea 6:1-2 |
| Joy Comes in the Morning | John 16:20 • Psalm 30:5 • Psalm 126:5-6 |
| Zion in Labor | John 16:21 • Isaiah 66:7-9 • Micah 4:10 |
| Be Strong and Courageous | John 16:33 • Joshua 1:9 • Psalm 46:1 |

## Prophecy Fulfilled

| Fulfillment | References |
|---|---|
| The Spirit Poured From on High | John 16:7 • Isaiah 32:15 • Joel 2:28 |
| The Serpent Crushed | John 16:11 • Genesis 3:15 • Isaiah 27:1 |
| Declaring Things Before They Happen | John 16:13 • Isaiah 42:9 • Amos 3:7 |
| Labor Pains, Then the Dead Live | John 16:21 • Isaiah 26:17-19 |
| Strike the Shepherd | John 16:32 • Zechariah 13:7 |

| Fulfillment | References |
| --- | --- |
| | |
| The Lord Yahweh Will Help Me | John 16:32 • Isaiah 50:7-9 • Psalm 23:4 |

## For Further Study

Credible external commentary that expounds on this chapter in a way consistent with a Torah-honoring, Messianic reading of the text:

- Enduring Word - John 16 Commentary (David Guzik) - the work of the Holy Spirit, sorrow turned to joy, and overcoming the world
- Life, Hope and Truth - The Gospel of John - John's signs, the I AM sayings, and why this Gospel differs from the other three
- Verse By Verse Ministry International - The Gospel of John, Lesson 16A - exposition of the promise of the Spirit and the little while

## John 16 - Introduction

The last words before the garden prepare the disciples for what is coming. They will be put out of the synagogues, and men will kill them believing they serve God, as Saul of Tarsus later confessed he had done. Earlier that night Peter asked where He was going; now grief has so filled them that no one asks. So He offers the strangest comfort in the Gospel: it is to their advantage that He go, because otherwise the Counselor will not come. Bound to a body He was in one place at a time; the Spirit will be with all of them everywhere.

The Spirit will convict the world of sin, because they do not believe in Him; of righteousness, because He goes to the Father, overturning the verdict of the cross; and of judgment, because the prince of this world has been judged - in the past tense, before the cross has happened. He has more to tell them than they can bear, and the Spirit will guide them into all truth, speaking not on His own authority but glorifying the Son.

A little while, and they will not see Him; a little while, and they will. They repeat the phrase to one another, baffled, seven times in four verses; it is three days. They will weep while the world rejoices, and their sorrow will be turned into joy - not replaced but transformed, the cause of grief becoming the cause of joy. Like a woman in labor who forgets the anguish when the child is born, and like Isaiah's travailing people whose pangs give way to your dead shall live, their joy will be something no one can take from them.

They are to ask the Father in His name, and He tells them He need not plead with the Father for them, since the Father Himself loves them. He came from the Father and returns to Him. When they claim at last to understand, He tells them they will be scattered and leave Him alone, as Zechariah said of the struck shepherd - yet He will not be alone, for the Father is with Him. In the world they will have

pressure; in Him, peace. And He tells them to take courage, because He has overcome the world, speaking in the past tense on the night of His arrest.

## John 16:1-33 (WEB)

**1** "I have said these things to you so that you wouldn't be caused to stumble.

**2** They will put you out of the synagogues. Yes, the time comes that whoever kills you will think that he offers service to God.[205]

**3** They will do these things because they have not known the Father, nor me.

**4** But I have told you these things, so that when the time comes, you may remember that I told you about them. I didn't tell you these things from the beginning, because I was with you.

**5** But now I am going to him who sent me, and none of you asks me, 'Where are you going?'

**6** But because I have told you these things, sorrow has filled your heart.

**7** Nevertheless I tell you the truth: It is to your advantage that I go away, for if I don't go away, the Counselor won't come to you. But if I go, I will send him to you.[206,207]

**8** When he has come, he will convict the world about sin, about righteousness, and about judgment;[208]

**9** about sin, because they don't believe in me;

**10** about righteousness, because I am going to my Father, and you won't see me any more;

**11** about judgment, because the prince of this world has been judged.[209]

**12** "I have yet many things to tell you, but you can't bear them now.

**13** However when he, the Spirit of truth, has come, he will guide you into all truth, for he will not speak from himself; but whatever he hears, he will speak. He will declare to you things that are coming.[210,211]

**14** He will glorify me, for he will take from what is mine, and will declare it to you.

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[205] **Cross-Reference:** Acts 26:9-10 • Isaiah 66:5 - *Saul thinking he ought to oppose the name and voting for the death of the saints, and brothers who cast you out for my name's sake*

[206] **Cross-Reference:** Psalm 68:18 • Ephesians 4:8 - *you have ascended on high and received gifts among men, and when he ascended he gave gifts to men*

[207] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Isaiah 32:15 • Joel 2:28 - *until the Spirit is poured on us from on high, and I will pour out my Spirit on all flesh*

[208] **Cross-Reference:** Psalm 9:7-8 • Isaiah 11:4 - *he will judge the world in righteousness, and with righteousness he will judge the poor*

[209] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Genesis 3:15 • Isaiah 27:1 - *the seed of the woman bruising the serpent's head, and Yahweh punishing leviathan the twisted serpent*

[210] **Cross-Reference:** Psalm 25:5 • Psalm 143:10 - *guide me in your truth and teach me, and your Spirit is good, lead me*

[211] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Isaiah 42:9 • Amos 3:7 - *I declare new things and tell you about them before they come up, and the Lord Yahweh reveals his secret to the prophets*

**15** All things whatever the Father has are mine; therefore I said that he takes of mine, and will declare it to you.

**16** A little while, and you will not see me. Again a little while, and you will see me."[212]

**17** Some of his disciples therefore said to one another, "What is this that he says to us, 'A little while, and you won't see me, and again a little while, and you will see me;' and, 'Because I go to the Father'?"

**18** They said therefore, "What is this that he says, 'A little while'? We don't know what he is saying."

**19** Therefore Jesus perceived that they wanted to ask him, and he said to them, "Do you inquire among yourselves concerning this, that I said, 'A little while, and you won't see me, and again a little while, and you will see me?'

**20** Most certainly I tell you, that you will weep and lament, but the world will rejoice. You will be sorrowful, but your sorrow will be turned into joy.[213]

**21** A woman, when she gives birth, has sorrow, because her time has come. But when she has delivered the child, she doesn't remember the anguish any more, for the joy that a human being is born into the world.[214,215]

**22** Therefore you now have sorrow, but I will see you again, and your heart will rejoice, and no one will take your joy away from you.

**23** "In that day you will ask me no questions. Most certainly I tell you, whatever you may ask of the Father in my name, he will give it to you.

**24** Until now, you have asked nothing in my name. Ask, and you will receive, that your joy may be made full.

**25** I have spoken these things to you in figures of speech. But the time is coming when I will no more speak to you in figures of speech, but will tell you plainly about the Father.

**26** In that day you will ask in my name; and I don't say to you, that I will pray to the Father for you,

**27** for the Father himself loves you, because you have loved me, and have believed that I came from God.

**28** I came from the Father, and have come into the world. Again, I leave the world, and go to the Father."

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[212] **Cross-Reference:** Isaiah 26:20 • Hosea 6:1-2 - *hide yourself for a little moment until the indignation is past, and on the third day he will raise us up*

[213] **Cross-Reference:** Psalm 30:5 • Psalm 126:5-6 - *weeping may stay for the night but joy comes in the morning, and those who sow in tears will reap in joy*

[214] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Isaiah 26:17-19 - *as a woman with child cries out in her pangs, and then: your dead shall live, my dead bodies shall arise*

[215] **Cross-Reference:** Isaiah 66:7-9 • Micah 4:10 - *as soon as Zion travailed she gave birth, and labor to give birth, daughter of Zion, for there Yahweh will redeem you*

**29** His disciples said to him, “Behold, now you are speaking plainly, and using no figures of speech.

**30** Now we know that you know all things, and don’t need for anyone to question you. By this we believe that you came from God.”

**31** Jesus answered them, “Do you now believe?

**32** Behold, the time is coming, yes, and has now come, that you will be scattered, everyone to his own place, and you will leave me alone. Yet I am not alone, because the Father is with me.[216,217]

**33** I have told you these things, that in me you may have peace. In the world you have oppression; but cheer up! I have overcome the world.”[218]

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[216] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Zechariah 13:7 - *strike the shepherd, and the sheep will be scattered*

[217] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Isaiah 50:7-9 • Psalm 23:4 - *the Lord Yahweh will help me and he who justifies me is near, and I will fear no evil, for you are with me*

[218] **Cross-Reference:** Joshua 1:9 • Psalm 46:1 - *be strong and courageous, Yahweh your God is with you wherever you go, and God is our refuge and strength*

# CHAPTER 17 - The Prayer Before the Garden, the Glory Before the World, and That They May Be One

## Key Notes

- He lifted up His eyes to heaven. The disciples are not told to close theirs. They are meant to hear every word of this prayer, and so are we (John 17:1, Psalm 123:1).
- This chapter is often called the high priestly prayer. The high priest carried the names of the tribes of Israel on his shoulders and over his heart when he went in before Yahweh. Here the names are carried in prayer (John 17:9, Exodus 28:12, 28:29).
- “Father, the time has come.” The hour that was not yet at Cana, and arrived when the Greeks came, is now (John 17:1, 2:4, 12:23).
- “This is eternal life, that they should know you, the only true God, and him whom you sent.” Eternal life is defined here not as duration but as knowing. Jeremiah said: let him who glories glory in this, that he understands and knows me (John 17:3, Jeremiah 9:24).
- Knowing, in Hebrew thought, is not information. It is the word used for the closest of all relationships. Hosea says Yahweh desires the knowledge of God more than burnt offerings (John 17:3, Hosea 6:6).
- “I glorified you on the earth. I have accomplished the work which you have given me to do.” Said before the cross, as though it were already done. Tomorrow He will say it is finished (John 17:4, 19:30).
- “Glorify me with the glory which I had with you before the world existed.” Yahweh said in Isaiah: my glory I will not give to another. Either the Son is claiming what no creature can have, or He is not another (John 17:5, Isaiah 42:8).
- “I revealed your name to the people whom you have given me.” The psalm says I will declare your name to my brothers, and Hebrews puts those words in His mouth. Making the Name known was His work (John 17:6, Psalm 22:22).
- “They were yours, and you have given them to me.” The disciples were the Father’s before they were the Son’s, a gift passed from one to the other (John 17:6).
- “I pray not for the world, but for those whom you have given me.” Not that He does not care for the world - He came for it - but this prayer is for His own (John 17:9, 3:16).
- “Keep them through your name which you have given me.” The Father’s name was given to the Son. Yahweh said of the angel who went before Israel: my name is in him (John 17:11, Exodus 23:21).
- “That they may be one, even as we are.” The unity He asks for is modeled on the unity of the Father and the Son. Not uniformity - oneness (John 17:11, 10:30).
- “None of them is lost, except the son of destruction, that the Scripture might be fulfilled.” Peter later quotes the psalms about Judas: let another take his office (John 17:12, Psalm 109:8, Acts 1:20).

- “That they may have my joy made full in themselves.” Joy again, on the night before the cross (John 17:13, 15:11).
- “I pray not that you would take them from the world, but that you would keep them from the evil one.” Not removal, but protection in the middle of it (John 17:15, Psalm 121:7).
- “Sanctify them in your truth. Your word is truth.” The psalm says your law is truth, and all your words are truth. To be sanctified is to be set apart, and the word does the setting apart (John 17:17, Psalm 119:142, 119:160).
- “For their sakes I sanctify myself.” Priests were consecrated before they could serve. He sets Himself apart for the offering He is about to make (John 17:19, Exodus 29:1).
- “Not for these only, but for those also who will believe in me through their word.” That is everyone who has believed since. You were prayed for, on purpose, the night before the cross (John 17:20).
- “That they may all be one; even as you, Father, are in me, and I in you.” The unity of believers is meant to be the evidence that the Father sent the Son. The world is supposed to see it (John 17:21, 17:23).
- Ezekiel’s two sticks, Judah and Joseph, were joined into one stick in Yahweh’s hand. The prayer for oneness lands on a very old promise (John 17:21, Ezekiel 37:17).
- “You loved them, even as you loved me.” The Father loves those who belong to the Son with the same love He has for the Son (John 17:23).
- “I desire that they also may be with me where I am, that they may see my glory.” The psalmist said: I will be satisfied, when I awake, with seeing your form (John 17:24, Psalm 17:15).
- “Before the foundation of the world” - the love between the Father and the Son was before there was a world to love (John 17:24).
- “I made known to them your name, and will make it known.” The prayer ends where it began: the Name, and the love, and Him in them (John 17:26).

## Key Cross-References (WEB)

| Topic | References |
|---|---|
| I Lift Up My Eyes | John 17:1 • Psalm 123:1 • Psalm 121:1-2 |
| Knowing Yahweh | John 17:3 • Jeremiah 9:24 • Hosea 6:6 |
| Names Carried Before Yahweh | John 17:9 • Exodus 28:12 • Exodus 28:29 |
| Kept From All Evil | John 17:15 • Psalm 121:7 • Psalm 91:11 |
| Your Word Is Truth | John 17:17 • Psalm 119:142 • Psalm 119:160 |
| Consecrated to Minister | John 17:19 • Exodus 29:1 • Leviticus 8:12 |
| Brothers Living in Unity | John 17:21 • Psalm 133:1 • Ezekiel 37:17 |
| Satisfied With Seeing Your Form | John 17:24 • Psalm 17:15 • Psalm 16:11 |

## Prophecy Fulfilled

| Fulfillment | References |
|---|---|
| My Glory I Will Not Give to Another | John 17:5 • Isaiah 42:8 • Proverbs 8:22-23 |
| I Will Declare Your Name | John 17:6 • Psalm 22:22 • Exodus 3:15 |
| My Name Is in Him | John 17:11 • Exodus 23:21 • Isaiah 52:6 |
| Let Another Take His Office | John 17:12 • Psalm 109:8 • Psalm 41:9 |
| A Priest Forever Who Intercedes | John 17:20 • Psalm 110:4 • Isaiah 53:12 |
| My Holy Name Made Known | John 17:26 • Ezekiel 39:7 • Psalm 102:15 |

## For Further Study

Credible external commentary that expounds on this chapter in a way consistent with a Torah-honoring, Messianic reading of the text:

- Enduring Word - John 17 Commentary (David Guzik) - the high priestly prayer, eternal life, sanctification, and unity
- Life, Hope and Truth - The Gospel of John - John's signs, the I AM sayings, and why this Gospel differs from the other three
- Verse By Verse Ministry International - The Gospel of John, Lesson 17A - exposition of the prayer of Yahshua for His disciples

## John 17 - Introduction

The chapter is a single prayer, spoken aloud with eyes lifted to heaven so that the disciples may hear it. It is often called the high priestly prayer, and the title fits: the high priest bore the names of the tribes on stones at his shoulders and over his heart whenever he went in before Yahweh, and here the Son carries His own into the Father's presence.

The hour has come, and He asks to be glorified so that He may glorify the Father. Eternal life is defined not by its length but as knowing the only true God and the one He sent - knowing in the Hebrew sense of the closest relationship, the knowledge Jeremiah calls the only true boast and Hosea prizes above burnt offerings. He has finished the work He was given, He says, the day before He cries that it is finished, and He asks for the glory He had with the Father before the world existed. Isaiah records Yahweh saying He will give His glory to no other; either the Son asks for what no creature may have, or He is not other.

He prays for the disciples whom the Father gave Him, describing as keepers of the Father's word the very men who are about to scatter. He asks that they be kept through the name the Father has given Him - as Yahweh once said of His messenger, my name is in him - and made one as the Father and Son are one. Only the son of destruction was lost, in fulfillment of Scripture. He asks not that they be taken

out of the world but kept from the evil one, and sanctified in the truth, which is the Father's word; and He sanctifies Himself for their sake, as a priest set apart for his offering.

Then the prayer widens to everyone who will believe through their word - every believer since, prayed for on the night before the cross. He asks that they all be one, as the Father is in Him and He in the Father, so that the world may believe the Father sent Him; the old promise of Ezekiel's two sticks joined into one stands behind it. He asks that they be with Him where He is, to see the glory given Him in the love that was before the foundation of the world, and He ends where He began, with the Name made known and the love of the Father in them.

## John 17:1-26 (WEB)

**1** Jesus said these things, and lifting up his eyes to heaven, he said, "Father, the time has come. Glorify your Son, that your Son may also glorify you;[219]

**2** even as you gave him authority over all flesh, so he will give eternal life to all whom you have given him.

**3** This is eternal life, that they should know you, the only true God, and him whom you sent, Jesus Christ.[220]

**4** I glorified you on the earth. I have accomplished the work which you have given me to do.

**5** Now, Father, glorify me with your own self with the glory which I had with you before the world existed.[221]

**6** I revealed your name to the people whom you have given me out of the world. They were yours, and you have given them to me. They have kept your word.[222]

**7** Now they have known that all things whatever you have given me are from you,

**8** for the words which you have given me I have given to them, and they received them, and knew for sure that I came from you, and they have believed that you sent me.

**9** I pray for them. I don't pray for the world, but for those whom you have given me, for they are yours.[223]

**10** All things that are mine are yours, and yours are mine, and I am glorified in them.

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[219] **Cross-Reference:** Psalm 123:1 • Psalm 121:1-2 - *to you I lift up my eyes, you who sit in the heavens, and my help comes from Yahweh*

[220] **Cross-Reference:** Jeremiah 9:24 • Hosea 6:6 - *let him who glories glory in this, that he knows me, and the knowledge of God more than burnt offerings*

[221] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Isaiah 42:8 • Proverbs 8:22-23 - *I am Yahweh, that is my name, I will not give my glory to another, and wisdom set up from everlasting before the earth existed*

[222] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Psalm 22:22 • Exodus 3:15 - *I will declare your name to my brothers, and this is my name forever, my memorial to all generations*

[223] **Cross-Reference:** Exodus 28:12 • Exodus 28:29 - *Aaron bearing the names of Israel on his shoulders and on his heart before Yahweh*

**11** I am no more in the world, but these are in the world, and I am coming to you. Holy Father, keep them through your name which you have given me, that they may be one, even as we are.[224]

**12** While I was with them in the world, I kept them in your name. Those whom you have given me I have kept. None of them is lost, except the son of destruction, that the Scripture might be fulfilled.[225]

**13** But now I come to you, and I say these things in the world, that they may have my joy made full in themselves.

**14** I have given them your word. The world hated them, because they are not of the world, even as I am not of the world.

**15** I pray not that you would take them from the world, but that you would keep them from the evil one.[226]

**16** They are not of the world even as I am not of the world.

**17** Sanctify them in your truth. Your word is truth.[227]

**18** As you sent me into the world, even so I have sent them into the world.

**19** For their sakes I sanctify myself, that they themselves also may be sanctified in truth.[228]

**20** Not for these only do I pray, but for those also who will believe in me through their word,[229]

**21** that they may all be one; even as you, Father, are in me, and I in you, that they also may be one in us; that the world may believe that you sent me.[230]

**22** The glory which you have given me, I have given to them; that they may be one, even as we are one;

**23** I in them, and you in me, that they may be perfected into one; that the world may know that you sent me, and loved them, even as you loved me.

**24** Father, I desire that they also whom you have given me be with me where I am, that they may see my glory, which you have given me, for you loved me before the foundation of the world.[231]

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[224] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Exodus 23:21 • Isaiah 52:6 - *listen to his voice, for my name is in him, and my people shall know my name*

[225] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Psalm 109:8 • Psalm 41:9 - *let his days be few and another take his office, and my familiar friend has lifted up his heel against me*

[226] **Cross-Reference:** Psalm 121:7 • Psalm 91:11 - *Yahweh will keep you from all evil, and his angels in charge of you to guard you*

[227] **Cross-Reference:** Psalm 119:142 • Psalm 119:160 - *your law is truth, and all of your words are truth*

[228] **Cross-Reference:** Exodus 29:1 • Leviticus 8:12 - *what you shall do to make them holy to minister as priests, and the anointing oil poured on Aaron's head to sanctify him*

[229] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Psalm 110:4 • Isaiah 53:12 - *a priest forever in the order of Melchizedek, and he made intercession for the transgressors*

[230] **Cross-Reference:** Psalm 133:1 • Ezekiel 37:17 - *how good and pleasant for brothers to live together in unity, and the two sticks joined into one in your hand*

**25** Righteous Father, the world hasn't known you, but I knew you; and these knew that you sent me.

**26** I made known to them your name, and will make it known; that the love with which you loved me may be in them, and I in them."[232]

[231] **Cross-Reference:** Psalm 17:15 • Psalm 16:11 - *I shall be satisfied when I awake with seeing your form, and in your presence is fullness of joy*

[232] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Ezekiel 39:7 • Psalm 102:15 - *I will make my holy name known among my people Israel, and the nations will fear Yahweh's name*

# CHAPTER 18 - Across the Kidron, I Am and They Fell Back, and What Is Truth?

## Key Notes

- He crossed the brook Kidron, the valley between Jerusalem and the Mount of Olives. King David crossed the same brook weeping, fleeing the city after his trusted counselor Ahithophel joined the rebellion against him. Ahithophel later went home and hanged himself (John 18:1, 2 Samuel 15:23, 15:31, 17:23).
- Only John calls it a garden. The first Adam fell in a garden. The last Adam was arrested in one, and will be buried in one (John 18:1, 19:41).
- Judas knew the place because Yahshua often met there with His disciples. Betrayal uses what friendship knows (John 18:2).
- The detachment was a Roman cohort, or part of one, with officers from the chief priests. Rome and the temple came for Him together (John 18:3, 18:12).
- They came with lanterns and torches to find the light of the world (John 18:3, 8:12).
- “Jesus therefore, knowing all the things that were happening to him, went out.” He was not found. He stepped forward (John 18:4).
- “I am he” is ego eimi once more, and this time a company of soldiers goes backward and falls to the ground at the words. The psalmist said: when evildoers came at me, they stumbled and fell (John 18:5-6, Psalm 27:2).
- John notes that Judas was standing with them. He was on the wrong side of the line when the words were spoken (John 18:5).
- “If therefore you seek me, let these go.” John says this fulfilled His own word: of those you gave me, I have lost none. The shepherd stands between the wolf and the sheep (John 18:8-9, 17:12).
- Only John names Peter as the one with the sword and Malchus as the servant who lost his ear. By the time John wrote, perhaps it no longer endangered anyone to say so (John 18:10).
- “The cup which the Father has given me, shall I not surely drink it?” The prophets speak of the cup of Yahweh’s wrath. He drinks it willingly (John 18:11, Isaiah 51:17, Psalm 75:8).
- He was taken first to Annas, father-in-law of Caiaphas. Annas had been high priest years before and had been removed by the Romans, but five of his sons and his son-in-law held the office after him. He was still the power behind it (John 18:13, Luke 3:2).
- Another disciple, known to the high priest, got Peter into the courtyard. Most take him to be the beloved disciple, John himself (John 18:15-16).
- “Are you also one of this man’s disciples?” “I am not.” In the garden Yahshua said I am, and an armed company fell down. In the courtyard Peter says I am not to a servant girl (John 18:17).

- The fire was a fire of coals - a charcoal fire. The word appears in only one other place in the New Testament: the charcoal fire on the beach where Yahshua restores Peter. Denied by one, restored by the other (John 18:18, 21:9).
- “I spoke openly to the world… in secret I said nothing.” Yahweh says the same in Isaiah: I have not spoken in secret, in a place of the land of darkness (John 18:20, Isaiah 45:19).
- An officer struck Him with his hand. Micah said: they will strike the judge of Israel with a rod on the cheek. Isaiah’s servant said: I gave my cheeks to those who plucked out the hair (John 18:22, Micah 5:1, Isaiah 50:6).
- “If I have spoken evil, testify of the evil.” He does not turn the other cheek by staying silent. He asks for a lawful charge. Meekness is not the same as having no voice (John 18:23).
- The third denial comes from a relative of Malchus, the man whose ear Peter cut off. Didn’t I see you in the garden with him? Then the rooster crowed (John 18:26-27).
- “They themselves didn’t enter into the Praetorium, that they might not be defiled, but might eat the Passover.” On the morning of the trial the Passover had not yet been eaten. John has been consistent about this since chapter 13 (John 18:28, 13:1, 19:14).
- Careful not to be defiled by a Gentile’s house, they were in the middle of handing an innocent man over to be killed. The irony needs no comment (John 18:28).
- “It is illegal for us to put anyone to death.” Rome kept the power of execution. That is why He would die by crucifixion rather than stoning - lifted up, as He had said, the kind of death He would die (John 18:31-32, 12:32-33).
- Psalm 22 describes the sufferer’s hands and feet pierced - the reading of the Septuagint and of the WEB, which the Masoretic text has as like a lion. Zechariah says they will look on me whom they have pierced (John 18:32, Psalm 22:16, Zechariah 12:10).
- “Are you the King of the Jews?” is Pilate’s first question in all four Gospels. It was the charge Rome cared about (John 18:33).
- “My Kingdom is not of this world.” Not from this world - its source is elsewhere. It is not that the kingdom has nothing to do with the earth; Daniel saw it filling the earth. It does not come by the means this world uses (John 18:36, Daniel 2:44).
- “If my Kingdom were of this world, then my servants would fight.” One of them had already drawn a sword, and been told to put it away (John 18:36, 18:11).
- “For this reason I have been born, and for this reason I have come into the world, that I should testify to the truth.” Born, and came into the world - two statements, one about birth and one about coming from somewhere else (John 18:37).
- “What is truth?” Pilate asked it standing in front of the one who had said I am the truth, and walked out without waiting for an answer (John 18:38, 14:6).
- “I find no basis for a charge against him.” The first of three times Pilate says it. The Passover lamb had to be without defect, and the Roman judge examines Him and finds none (John 18:38, 19:4, 19:6, Exodus 12:5).

- Barabbas was a robber - the word was used for bandits and violent rebels. His name means son of the father. On the Day of Atonement one goat died and the other was sent away alive. Many have seen the picture here; John simply tells what happened (John 18:40, Leviticus 16:8-10).

## Key Cross-References (WEB)

| Topic | References |
|---|---|
| David Crossing the Kidron | John 18:1 • 2 Samuel 15:23 • 2 Samuel 15:31 |
| Lanterns in the Dark | John 18:3 • Job 24:13 • Psalm 139:12 |
| Annas and Caiaphas | John 18:13 • Luke 3:2 • Acts 4:6 |
| Not Spoken in Secret | John 18:20 • Isaiah 45:19 • Isaiah 48:16 |
| Do Not Curse a Ruler | John 18:23 • Exodus 22:28 • Acts 23:5 |
| Defiled and Unable to Keep the Passover | John 18:28 • Numbers 9:6 • Numbers 9:10 |
| Hanged on a Tree | John 18:32 • Deuteronomy 21:22-23 • Galatians 3:13 |
| Two Goats | John 18:40 • Leviticus 16:8-10 |

## Prophecy Fulfilled

| Fulfillment | References |
|---|---|
| They Stumbled and Fell | John 18:6 • Psalm 27:2 • Psalm 35:4 |
| None of Them Lost | John 18:9 • Ezekiel 34:16 • Isaiah 40:11 |
| The Cup in Yahweh's Hand | John 18:11 • Isaiah 51:17 • Psalm 75:8 |
| Struck on the Cheek | John 18:22 • Micah 5:1 • Isaiah 50:6 |
| Pierced | John 18:32 • Psalm 22:16 • Zechariah 12:10 |
| A Kingdom That Will Never Be Destroyed | John 18:36 • Daniel 2:44 • Daniel 7:27 |
| A Lamb Without Defect | John 18:38 • Exodus 12:5 • Isaiah 53:9 |

## For Further Study

Credible external commentary that expounds on this chapter in a way consistent with a Torah-honoring, Messianic reading of the text:

- Enduring Word - John 18 Commentary (David Guzik) - the arrest in the garden, Peter's denials, and Yahshua before Annas and Pilate
- Life, Hope and Truth - The Gospel of John - John's signs, the I AM sayings, and why this Gospel differs from the other three
- Verse By Verse Ministry International - The Gospel of John, Lesson 18A - exposition of the betrayal, arrest and trials

## John 18 - Introduction

When the prayer ends, Yahshua crosses the brook Kidron with His disciples - the brook King David crossed weeping as he fled Jerusalem, betrayed by his trusted counselor Ahithophel, who later hanged himself. The parallel needs no comment. Only John calls the place a garden: the first Adam fell in a garden, the last is arrested in one and will be buried in one. Judas knows it because Yahshua often met there with His disciples, and he comes with Roman soldiers and temple officers, carrying lanterns and torches to find the light of the world.

Knowing all that is coming, Yahshua goes out to meet them and asks whom they seek. At His answer, ego eimi, the armed company goes backward and falls to the ground - and then He lets them rise and take Him, asking only that His disciples be let go, so that He loses none of those given Him. Peter strikes off Malchus's ear and is told to sheathe the sword: the cup the Father has given must be drunk. He is bound and taken first to Annas, the deposed high priest who still held the power behind the office through his sons and his son-in-law Caiaphas.

In the courtyard Peter, asked by a servant girl whether he is a disciple, says I am not - the reverse of the I am that felled the soldiers - and warms himself at a charcoal fire, a word that appears again only at the beach where he will be restored. Before Annas, Yahshua says He has spoken openly and nothing in secret, and when an officer strikes Him, as Micah foresaw the judge of Israel struck on the cheek, He asks for a lawful charge; meekness is not silence. Peter denies Him twice more, the last time to a relative of Malchus, and the rooster crows.

At dawn He is brought to the Praetorium, and His accusers will not enter lest they be defiled and unable to eat the Passover - which, as John has said since chapter 13, had not yet been eaten. Rome holds the power of death, so He will be lifted up rather than stoned, as He had said. To Pilate He says His kingdom is not from this world and does not advance by the sword, and that He was born to testify to the truth. Pilate asks what truth is, standing before the one who said He is the truth, and walks out without waiting for an answer. Three times he will find no fault in Him, as the Passover lamb had to be found without defect. The crowd asks instead for Barabbas, a violent robber whose name means son of the father.

## John 18:1-40 (WEB)

**1** When Jesus had spoken these words, he went out with his disciples over the brook Kidron, where there was a garden, into which he and his disciples entered.[233]

**2** Now Judas, who betrayed him, also knew the place, for Jesus often met there with his disciples.

**3** Judas then, having taken a detachment of soldiers and officers from the chief priests and the Pharisees, came there with lanterns, torches, and weapons.[234]

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[233] **Cross-Reference:** 2 Samuel 15:23 • 2 Samuel 15:31 - *the king passing over the brook Kidron while the country wept, and Ahithophel among the conspirators*

[234] **Cross-Reference:** Job 24:13 • Psalm 139:12 - *those who rebel against the light, and the darkness that does not hide from you*

**4** Jesus therefore, knowing all the things that were happening to him, went out, and said to them, “Who are you looking for?”

**5** They answered him, “Jesus of Nazareth.” Jesus said to them, “I am he.” Judas also, who betrayed him, was standing with them.

**6** When therefore he said to them, “I am he,” they went backward, and fell to the ground.[235]

**7** Again therefore he asked them, “Who are you looking for?” They said, “Jesus of Nazareth.”

**8** Jesus answered, “I told you that I am he. If therefore you seek me, let these go their way,”

**9** that the word might be fulfilled which he spoke, “Of those whom you have given me, I have lost none.”[236]

**10** Simon Peter therefore, having a sword, drew it, and struck the high priest’s servant, and cut off his right ear. The servant’s name was Malchus.

**11** Jesus therefore said to Peter, “Put the sword into its sheath. The cup which the Father has given me, shall I not surely drink it?”[237]

**12** So the detachment, the commanding officer, and the officers of the Jews, seized Jesus and bound him,

**13** and led him to Annas first, for he was father-in-law to Caiaphas, who was high priest that year.[238]

**14** Now it was Caiaphas who advised the Jews that it was expedient that one man should perish for the people.

**15** Simon Peter followed Jesus, as did another disciple. Now that disciple was known to the high priest, and entered in with Jesus into the court of the high priest;

**16** but Peter was standing at the door outside. So the other disciple, who was known to the high priest, went out and spoke to her who kept the door, and brought in Peter.

**17** Then the maid who kept the door said to Peter, “Are you also one of this man’s disciples?” He said, “I am not.”

**18** Now the servants and the officers were standing there, having made a fire of coals, for it was cold. They were warming themselves. Peter was with them, standing and warming himself.

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[235] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Psalm 27:2 • Psalm 35:4 - *when evildoers came at me they stumbled and fell, and let those who plot my ruin be turned back*

[236] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Ezekiel 34:16 • Isaiah 40:11 - *I will seek that which was lost and bind up the broken, and he will gather the lambs in his arm*

[237] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Isaiah 51:17 • Psalm 75:8 - *the cup of his wrath drunk from Yahweh’s hand, and the cup in Yahweh’s hand poured out*

[238] **Cross-Reference:** Luke 3:2 • Acts 4:6 - *the high priesthood of Annas and Caiaphas, and Annas the high priest with Caiaphas and the high priest’s relatives*

**19** The high priest therefore asked Jesus about his disciples, and about his teaching.

**20** Jesus answered him, “I spoke openly to the world. I always taught in synagogues, and in the temple, where the Jews always meet. I said nothing in secret.[239]

**21** Why do you ask me? Ask those who have heard me what I said to them. Behold, these know the things which I said.”

**22** When he had said this, one of the officers standing by slapped Jesus with his hand, saying, “Do you answer the high priest like that?”[240]

**23** Jesus answered him, “If I have spoken evil, testify of the evil; but if well, why do you beat me?”[241]

**24** Annas sent him bound to Caiaphas, the high priest.

**25** Now Simon Peter was standing and warming himself. They said therefore to him, “You aren’t also one of his disciples, are you?” He denied it, and said, “I am not.”

**26** One of the servants of the high priest, being a relative of him whose ear Peter had cut off, said, “Didn’t I see you in the garden with him?”

**27** Peter therefore denied it again, and immediately the rooster crowed.

**28** They led Jesus therefore from Caiaphas into the Praetorium. It was early, and they themselves didn’t enter into the Praetorium, that they might not be defiled, but might eat the Passover.[242]

**29** Pilate therefore went out to them, and said, “What accusation do you bring against this man?”

**30** They answered him, “If this man weren’t an evildoer, we wouldn’t have delivered him up to you.”

**31** Pilate therefore said to them, “Take him yourselves, and judge him according to your law.” Therefore the Jews said to him, “It is not lawful for us to put anyone to death,”

**32** that the word of Jesus might be fulfilled, which he spoke, signifying by what kind of death he should die.[243,244]

**33** Pilate therefore entered again into the Praetorium, called Jesus, and said to him, “Are you the King of the Jews?”

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[239] **Cross-Reference:** Isaiah 45:19 • Isaiah 48:16 - *I have not spoken in secret, in a place of the land of darkness, and from the beginning I have not spoken in secret*

[240] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Micah 5:1 • Isaiah 50:6 - *they will strike the judge of Israel with a rod on the cheek, and I gave my cheeks to those who plucked off the hair*

[241] **Cross-Reference:** Exodus 22:28 • Acts 23:5 - *you shall not curse a ruler of your people*

[242] **Cross-Reference:** Numbers 9:6 • Numbers 9:10 - *men unclean who could not keep the Passover on that day, and the provision for the unclean to keep it still*

[243] **Cross-Reference:** Deuteronomy 21:22-23 • Galatians 3:13 - *he who is hanged on a tree is accursed of God, and Messiah becoming a curse for us*

[244] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Psalm 22:16 • Zechariah 12:10 - *they have pierced my hands and feet, and they will look to me whom they have pierced*

**34** Jesus answered him, “Do you say this by yourself, or did others tell you about me?”

**35** Pilate answered, “I’m not a Jew, am I? Your own nation and the chief priests delivered you to me. What have you done?”

**36** Jesus answered, “My Kingdom is not of this world. If my Kingdom were of this world, then my servants would fight, that I wouldn’t be delivered to the Jews. But now my Kingdom is not from here.”[245]

**37** Pilate therefore said to him, “Are you a king then?” Jesus answered, “You say that I am a king. For this reason I have been born, and for this reason I have come into the world, that I should testify to the truth. Everyone who is of the truth listens to my voice.”

**38** Pilate said to him, “What is truth?” When he had said this, he went out again to the Jews, and said to them, “I find no basis for a charge against him.[246]

**39** But you have a custom, that I should release someone to you at the Passover. Therefore, do you want me to release to you the King of the Jews?”

**40** Then they all shouted again, saying, “Not this man, but Barabbas!” Now Barabbas was a robber.[247]

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[245] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Daniel 2:44 • Daniel 7:27 - *the God of heaven setting up a kingdom that will never be destroyed, and an everlasting kingdom that all dominions will serve*

[246] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Exodus 12:5 • Isaiah 53:9 - *your lamb shall be without defect, and he had done no violence, nor was any deceit in his mouth*

[247] **Cross-Reference:** Leviticus 16:8-10 - *lots cast for two goats, one offered for a sin offering and the other sent away alive*

## Major Themes Across John 16-18

- Persecution foretold so that it would confirm faith instead of breaking it
- Men who kill and believe they are serving God
- Grief so full it stopped asking questions
- The advantage of His going: the Spirit with every one of them everywhere
- Sin, righteousness, and judgment, with the prince already judged
- Truth given at the pace a person can carry it
- A little while, said seven times, meaning three days
- Sorrow turned into joy, not replaced by it
- Labor pains that end in your dead shall live
- A Father who does not need persuading to love
- Scattered sheep, and a Shepherd who was not alone
- Peace in Him and pressure in the world, and the world already overcome
- A prayer spoken aloud so that we could hear it
- Names carried before the Father like the stones on the high priest's shoulders
- Eternal life defined as knowing Him
- The glory Yahweh gives to no other, asked for by the Son
- The Father's name given to the Son
- Kept in the world, not taken out of it
- Sanctified by the word, which is truth
- Prayed for before we were born: those who would believe through their word
- Oneness as the evidence that the Father sent the Son
- Love before the foundation of the world
- A king crossing the Kidron, betrayed by a friend
- A garden where the last Adam was arrested
- Lanterns and torches searching for the light of the world
- I am, and an armed company on the ground
- A shepherd stepping between the soldiers and the sheep
- The cup received, not refused
- I am, and I am not: the Master and the disciple on the same night
- Two charcoal fires, one for denial and one for restoration
- Struck on the cheek, and asking for justice rather than staying silent
- Careful not to be defiled while delivering the innocent to death

- A kingdom not from this world, which does not run on swords
- What is truth, asked of the truth, without waiting for an answer
- No fault found in the Lamb

# CHAPTER 19 - Behold the Man, It Is Finished, and a Tomb in a Garden

## Key Notes

- Pilate had Him flogged before any verdict, probably hoping a beating would satisfy the crowd. It did not (John 19:1, 19:4-6).
- The crown was woven from thorns. Thorns came into the world with the curse on the ground in Genesis 3. The one who came to undo the curse wore it on His head (John 19:2, Genesis 3:17-18).
- “Behold, the man!” Pilate means look at him - beaten, harmless, pitiful. Zechariah had said: behold, the man whose name is the Branch, and he shall build Yahweh’s temple. Pilate quoted a prophet without knowing it (John 19:5, Zechariah 6:12).
- “I find no basis for a charge against him” is said for the second and third times here. The Lamb examined by the judge three times, and found without defect (John 19:4, 19:6, 18:38).
- “By our law he ought to die, because he made himself the Son of God.” Now the real charge comes out. Not sedition. Blasphemy (John 19:7, Leviticus 24:16).
- When he heard that, Pilate was more afraid. Romans had stories about sons of gods walking among men. Where are you from? - and Yahshua gives him no answer, as the servant before his shearers was silent (John 19:8-9, Isaiah 53:7).
- “You would have no power at all against me, unless it were given to you from above.” The governor thinks he holds the power. He is told where it comes from (John 19:11).
- “You aren’t Caesar’s friend.” Friend of Caesar was an honored title, and a threat: a governor reported to Rome for freeing a would-be king would lose everything (John 19:12).
- The judgment seat stood on a stone pavement called Gabbatha. John gives both the Greek and the Hebrew name, as an eyewitness would (John 19:13).
- “It was the Preparation Day of the Passover” - the day the lambs were made ready. Mark places the crucifixion at the third hour and John has Pilate’s verdict at about the sixth; whether John counts hours differently or both are approximate, readers have long discussed (John 19:14, Mark 15:25).
- “Behold, your King!” And the chief priests answer: we have no king but Caesar. The men who led the worship of Yahweh rejected Him as King out loud, as Israel did when they asked Samuel for a king like the nations (John 19:14-15, 1 Samuel 8:7).
- “He went out, bearing his cross.” Isaac carried the wood up Moriah on his own back. John does not mention Simon of Cyrene; he wants you to see the Son carrying the wood (John 19:17, Genesis 22:6).
- Golgotha means the place of a skull. It was outside the city, as the sin offering was burned outside the camp (John 19:17, 19:20, Hebrews 13:11-12).
- Two others were crucified with Him, one on each side, and Yahshua in the middle. Numbered with the transgressors, as Isaiah said (John 19:18, Isaiah 53:12).

- The sign read JESUS OF NAZARETH, THE KING OF THE JEWS in Hebrew, Latin and Greek - the language of the covenant, of the empire, and of the wider world. Everybody passing by could read it (John 19:19-20).
- “What I have written, I have written.” Pilate, who could not stand up for the truth, would not change a sign that told it (John 19:22).
- The soldiers split His clothes four ways, and gambled for the seamless tunic, woven from the top in one piece. The robe of the high priest was woven work, made so it would not be torn. The psalm says: they divide my garments among them, and cast lots for my clothing (John 19:23-24, Exodus 28:32, Psalm 22:18).
- Women stood by the cross, and one disciple. Most of the men who had promised to die with Him were gone (John 19:25-26).
- “Woman, behold your son!” The same address He used at Cana. His mother appears at the first sign and at the cross, and at both He calls her woman (John 19:26, 2:4).
- From the cross He provides for His mother. Honor your father and your mother - kept to His last breath (John 19:26-27, Exodus 20:12).
- “I am thirsty.” The one who offered living water at a well and shouted come and drink at the feast, thirsty. In my thirst they gave me vinegar to drink, the psalm says (John 19:28, 4:14, 7:37, Psalm 69:21).
- The sponge was put on hyssop - the plant used to paint the blood of the Passover lamb on the doorposts in Egypt. John alone mentions it (John 19:29, Exodus 12:22).
- “It is finished” is one word in Greek, tetelestai, which could be written on a bill to mean paid in full. It is from the same root as loved them to the end in 13:1 (John 19:30, 13:1).
- “He bowed his head, and gave up his spirit.” He was not overcome. He handed His spirit over. No one took His life from Him (John 19:30, 10:18).
- “That Sabbath was a special one” - in older translations, a high day. That is the language of an annual Sabbath, and the first day of Unleavened Bread was a holy convocation with no regular work. This study reads it that way, which places two Sabbaths in that week and leaves room for three days and three nights in the tomb (John 19:31, Leviticus 23:6-7, Matthew 12:40).
- Bodies were not to hang overnight, because the Torah says a hanged man must be buried the same day. Breaking the legs made death come quickly (John 19:31, Deuteronomy 21:22-23).
- They did not break His legs, because He was already dead. A bone of the Passover lamb was not to be broken (John 19:33, 19:36, Exodus 12:46, Psalm 34:20).
- A soldier pierced His side, and blood and water came out. John stops the story to swear that he saw it - he who has seen has testified, and his testimony is true (John 19:34-35).
- “They will look on him whom they pierced” is Zechariah 12, where Yahweh is speaking: they will look to me whom they have pierced. John quotes it of the man on the cross (John 19:37, Zechariah 12:10).

- Joseph of Arimathea, a secret disciple for fear of the Jews, asks for the body. Nicodemus, who first came by night, comes with him. The cross brought the hidden ones into the open (John 19:38-39).
- A hundred Roman pounds of myrrh and aloes is about seventy-five pounds by our measure - a burial fit for a king. The psalm says all your garments smell of myrrh and aloes (John 19:39, Psalm 45:8, 2 Chronicles 16:14).
- The tomb was new, in a garden, and no one had ever been laid in it. Isaiah said His grave would be with a rich man in His death (John 19:41, Isaiah 53:9, Matthew 27:57).

## Key Cross-References (WEB)

| Topic | References |
|---|---|
| Thorns and Thistles | John 19:2 • Genesis 3:17-18 |
| He Ought to Die by Our Law | John 19:7 • Leviticus 24:16 • Deuteronomy 18:20 |
| They Have Rejected Me as King | John 19:15 • 1 Samuel 8:7 • Judges 8:23 |
| The Wood Laid on the Son | John 19:17 • Genesis 22:6 |
| Woven So It Would Not Tear | John 19:23 • Exodus 28:31-32 • Exodus 39:22 |
| A Bunch of Hyssop | John 19:29 • Exodus 12:22 • Psalm 51:7 |
| A Special Sabbath | John 19:31 • Leviticus 23:6-7 • Deuteronomy 21:22-23 |
| A New Tomb in a Garden | John 19:41 • Matthew 27:60 • Genesis 2:8 |

## Prophecy Fulfilled

| Fulfillment | References |
|---|---|
| Behold, the Man Whose Name Is the Branch | John 19:5 • Zechariah 6:12 • Isaiah 4:2 |
| Silent Before His Shearers | John 19:9 • Isaiah 53:7 • Psalm 38:13-14 |
| Numbered With the Transgressors | John 19:18 • Isaiah 53:12 |
| Lots Cast for His Clothing | John 19:24 • Psalm 22:18 |
| Vinegar for His Thirst | John 19:28 • Psalm 69:21 • Psalm 22:15 |
| Not a Bone Broken | John 19:36 • Exodus 12:46 • Psalm 34:20 |
| Him Whom They Pierced | John 19:37 • Zechariah 12:10 |
| With a Rich Man in His Death | John 19:41 • Isaiah 53:9 • Psalm 45:8 |

## For Further Study

Credible external commentary that expounds on this chapter in a way consistent with a Torah-honoring, Messianic reading of the text:

- Enduring Word - John 19 Commentary (David Guzik) - the trial before Pilate, the crucifixion, and the burial
- Life, Hope and Truth - The Gospel of John - John's signs, the I AM sayings, and why this Gospel differs from the other three
- Verse By Verse Ministry International - The Gospel of John, Lesson 19A - exposition of the crucifixion according to John

## John 19 - Introduction

Pilate has Yahshua flogged, and the soldiers crown Him with thorns - the mark of the curse laid on the ground in Genesis 3, now worn by the one who came to undo it - and mock Him in purple. Pilate leads Him out with the words behold, the man, meaning only that so pitiful a figure could be no threat, and repeating unawares Zechariah's announcement of the man whose name is the Branch, who would build the temple of Yahweh. Twice more Pilate declares he finds no fault in Him. The Lamb is examined three times and found without defect.

Then the true charge emerges: He made Himself the Son of God. Pilate, frightened, asks where He is from and receives no answer, the silence of the servant before his shearers. Told that his power comes from above, and threatened with the loss of Caesar's friendship, Pilate sits in judgment on the Preparation Day of the Passover, as the lambs were being made ready, and presents Him as their King. The chief priests answer that they have no king but Caesar - the rejection of Yahweh's kingship that Samuel heard when Israel asked for a king like the nations.

He goes out carrying His own cross, as Isaac carried the wood up Moriah, and is crucified between two others, numbered with the transgressors. Pilate's sign names Him King of the Jews in Hebrew, Latin and Greek, and he will not alter it. The soldiers divide His garments and cast lots for the seamless tunic, as Psalm 22 foretold. From the cross He gives His mother into the care of the disciple He loved, keeping the commandment to honor her to His last breath. He thirsts - He who offered living water - and is given vinegar on hyssop, the plant that marked the Passover blood on the doorposts. Then He says tetelestai, it is finished, paid in full, and gives up His spirit.

The day was the Preparation, and the coming Sabbath a special one, the language of an annual Sabbath; this study reads it as the first day of Unleavened Bread, which makes two Sabbaths that week and room for three days and three nights in the tomb. The legs of the others are broken, but not His, for He is already dead and no bone of the Passover lamb was to be broken. A spear pierces His side, blood and water flow, and John swears to what he saw, citing Zechariah's they will look on him whom they pierced - spoken there by Yahweh of Himself. Then Joseph of Arimathea and Nicodemus, disciples who had hidden, come into the open and bury Him with a king's weight of spices in a new tomb in a garden.

## John 19:1-42 (WEB)

**1** So Pilate then took Jesus, and flogged him.

**2** The soldiers twisted thorns into a crown, and put it on his head, and dressed him in a purple garment.[248]

**3** They kept saying, “Hail, King of the Jews!” and they kept slapping him.

**4** Then Pilate went out again, and said to them, “Behold, I bring him out to you, that you may know that I find no basis for a charge against him.”

**5** Jesus therefore came out, wearing the crown of thorns and the purple garment. Pilate said to them, “Behold, the man!”[249]

**6** When therefore the chief priests and the officers saw him, they shouted, saying, “Crucify! Crucify!” Pilate said to them, “Take him yourselves, and crucify him, for I find no basis for a charge against him.”

**7** The Jews answered him, “We have a law, and by our law he ought to die, because he made himself the Son of God.”[250]

**8** When therefore Pilate heard this saying, he was more afraid.

**9** He entered into the Praetorium again, and said to Jesus, “Where are you from?” But Jesus gave him no answer.[251]

**10** Pilate therefore said to him, “Aren’t you speaking to me? Don’t you know that I have power to release you, and have power to crucify you?”

**11** Jesus answered, “You would have no power at all against me, unless it were given to you from above. Therefore he who delivered me to you has greater sin.”

**12** At this, Pilate was seeking to release him, but the Jews cried out, saying, “If you release this man, you aren’t Caesar’s friend! Everyone who makes himself a king speaks against Caesar!”

**13** When Pilate therefore heard these words, he brought Jesus out, and sat down on the judgment seat at a place called “The Pavement”, but in Hebrew, “Gabbatha.”

**14** Now it was the Preparation Day of the Passover, at about the sixth hour. He said to the Jews, “Behold, your King!”

**15** They cried out, “Away with him! Away with him! Crucify him!” Pilate said to them, “Shall I crucify your King?” The chief priests answered, “We have no king but Caesar!”[252]

**16** So then he delivered him to them to be crucified. So they took Jesus and led him away.

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[248] **Cross-Reference:** Genesis 3:17-18 - *the ground cursed for Adam’s sake, yielding thorns and thistles*

[249] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Zechariah 6:12 • Isaiah 4:2 - *behold, the man whose name is the Branch, who shall build Yahweh’s temple, and Yahweh’s branch beautiful and glorious*

[250] **Cross-Reference:** Leviticus 24:16 • Deuteronomy 18:20 - *he who blasphemes Yahweh’s name shall surely be put to death, and the prophet who speaks presumptuously in my name shall die*

[251] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Isaiah 53:7 • Psalm 38:13-14 - *as a sheep before its shearers is silent he did not open his mouth, and a mute man who does not open his mouth*

[252] **Cross-Reference:** 1 Samuel 8:7 • Judges 8:23 - *they have rejected me as king over them, and Yahweh shall rule over you*

**17** He went out, bearing his cross, to the place called “The Place of a Skull”, which is called in Hebrew, “Golgotha”,[253]

**18** where they crucified him, and with him two others, on either side one, and Jesus in the middle.[254]

**19** Pilate wrote a title also, and put it on the cross. There was written, “JESUS OF NAZARETH, THE KING OF THE JEWS.”

**20** Therefore many of the Jews read this title, for the place where Jesus was crucified was near the city; and it was written in Hebrew, in Latin, and in Greek.

**21** The chief priests of the Jews therefore said to Pilate, “Don’t write, ‘The King of the Jews,’ but, ‘he said, “I am King of the Jews.”’”

**22** Pilate answered, “What I have written, I have written.”

**23** Then the soldiers, when they had crucified Jesus, took his garments and made four parts, to every soldier a part; and also the coat. Now the coat was without seam, woven from the top throughout.[255]

**24** Then they said to one another, “Let’s not tear it, but cast lots for it to decide whose it will be,” that the Scripture might be fulfilled, which says, “They parted my garments among them. For my cloak they cast lots.” Therefore the soldiers did these things.[256]

**25** But there were standing by the cross of Jesus his mother, and his mother’s sister, Mary the wife of Clopas, and Mary Magdalene.

**26** Therefore when Jesus saw his mother, and the disciple whom he loved standing there, he said to his mother, “Woman, behold, your son!”

**27** Then he said to the disciple, “Behold, your mother!” From that hour, the disciple took her to his own home.

**28** After this, Jesus, seeing that all things were now finished, that the Scripture might be fulfilled, said, “I am thirsty.”[257]

**29** Now a vessel full of vinegar was set there; so they put a sponge full of the vinegar on hyssop, and held it at his mouth.[258]

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[253] **Cross-Reference:** Genesis 22:6 - *Abraham laying the wood of the burnt offering on Isaac his son*

[254] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Isaiah 53:12 - *he poured out his soul to death and was counted with the transgressors*

[255] **Cross-Reference:** Exodus 28:31-32 • Exodus 39:22 - *the robe of the ephod with a binding of woven work so that it would not be torn, made of woven work*

[256] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Psalm 22:18 - *they divide my garments among them, and they cast lots for my clothing*

[257] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Psalm 69:21 • Psalm 22:15 - *in my thirst they gave me vinegar to drink, and my tongue sticks to the roof of my mouth*

[258] **Cross-Reference:** Exodus 12:22 • Psalm 51:7 - *a bunch of hyssop dipped in the blood of the lamb for the doorposts, and purify me with hyssop*

**30** When Jesus therefore had received the vinegar, he said, “It is finished.” He bowed his head, and gave up his spirit.

**31** Therefore the Jews, because it was the Preparation Day, so that the bodies wouldn’t remain on the cross on the Sabbath (for that Sabbath was a special one), asked of Pilate that their legs might be broken, and that they might be taken away.[259]

**32** Therefore the soldiers came, and broke the legs of the first, and of the other who was crucified with him;

**33** but when they came to Jesus, and saw that he was already dead, they didn’t break his legs.

**34** However one of the soldiers pierced his side with a spear, and immediately blood and water came out.

**35** He who has seen has testified, and his testimony is true. He knows that he tells the truth, that you may believe.

**36** For these things happened, that the Scripture might be fulfilled, “A bone of him will not be broken.”[260]

**37** Again another Scripture says, “They will look on him whom they pierced.”[261]

**38** After these things, Joseph of Arimathaea, being a disciple of Jesus, but secretly for fear of the Jews, asked of Pilate that he might take away Jesus’ body. Pilate gave him permission. He came therefore and took away his body.

**39** Nicodemus, who at first came to Jesus by night, also came bringing a mixture of myrrh and aloes, about a hundred Roman pounds.[262]

**40** So they took Jesus’ body, and bound it in linen cloths with the spices, as the custom of the Jews is to bury.

**41** Now in the place where he was crucified there was a garden. In the garden was a new tomb in which no man had ever yet been laid.[263,264]

**42** Then because of the Jews’ Preparation Day (for the tomb was near at hand) they laid Jesus there.

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[259] **Cross-Reference:** Leviticus 23:6-7 • Deuteronomy 21:22-23 - *the first day of Unleavened Bread a holy convocation with no regular work, and the hanged body not left on the tree overnight*

[260] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Exodus 12:46 • Psalm 34:20 - *do not break any of the lamb’s bones, and he protects all his bones, not one is broken*

[261] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Zechariah 12:10 - *they will look to me whom they have pierced, and mourn for him as for an only son*

[262] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Psalm 45:8 - *all your garments smell of myrrh, aloes and cassia*

[263] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Isaiah 53:9 - *his grave made with the wicked, and with a rich man in his death*

[264] **Cross-Reference:** Matthew 27:60 • Genesis 2:8 - *laid in Joseph’s own new tomb cut out of the rock, and the garden Yahweh God planted in Eden*

# CHAPTER 20 - An Empty Tomb Before Dawn, Mary in the Garden, and My Lord and My God

## Key Notes

- “On the first day of the week… while it was still dark.” Mary came early and the stone was already gone. Nobody in any Gospel sees the resurrection happen. They find it already done (John 20:1).
- The first day of the week, after the Sabbath, was the day the firstfruits sheaf was waved before Yahweh during Unleavened Bread. Paul calls the risen Messiah the firstfruits of those who are asleep (John 20:1, Leviticus 23:10-11, 1 Corinthians 15:20).
- “They have taken away the Lord out of the tomb.” Her first thought is grave robbery. Nobody expected a resurrection, which is one reason the accounts read as reports rather than inventions (John 20:2).
- The other disciple outran Peter and got there first. John tells on himself - he got there first and waited outside; Peter, being Peter, went straight in (John 20:4-6).
- The linen cloths were lying there, and the cloth that had been on His head was rolled up in a place by itself. Thieves do not unwrap a body and fold the cloth. Lazarus came out still wrapped. Yahshua left the wrappings behind (John 20:5-7, 11:44).
- “He saw and believed.” Before any appearance, before any angel spoke to him, the beloved disciple believed from what was left in the tomb (John 20:8).
- “They still didn’t know the Scripture, that he must rise from the dead.” The Scriptures had said it - you will not let your holy one see corruption, on the third day he will raise us up - and they had not put it together (John 20:9, Psalm 16:10, Hosea 6:2).
- Mary stays when the men go home. She is weeping outside the tomb, and she stoops to look in (John 20:10-11).
- Two angels in white, one at the head and one at the feet of where the body had lain. Over the ark of the covenant, two cherubim faced each other from either end of the mercy seat, and Yahweh said: there I will meet with you (John 20:12, Exodus 25:18-22).
- “Woman, why are you weeping?” asked by the angels and then by Yahshua. Her grief is taken seriously, and questioned (John 20:13, 20:15).
- She supposed Him to be the gardener. It is a garden, and in a sense she was right. The first man was put in a garden to tend it. The last Adam walks in one on the morning of the new creation (John 20:15, Genesis 2:15).
- “Mary.” One word. The good shepherd calls his own sheep by name, and they know his voice (John 20:16, 10:3).
- “Rabboni” means my teacher, a warmer form than Rabbi. John translates it, as he translated Rabbi and Messiah in chapter 1 (John 20:16, 1:38).

- “Don’t hold me” can mean stop clinging to me. She has Him back and does not want to let go. He has somewhere to go and something for her to do (John 20:17).
- “I haven’t yet ascended to my Father.” Many connect this with the firstfruits sheaf, which had to be presented before Yahweh to be accepted. The text says only that He had not yet ascended (John 20:17, Leviticus 23:11).
- “Go to my brothers.” For the first time in this Gospel He calls the disciples brothers. My Father and your Father, my God and your God. The cross made them family (John 20:17, Psalm 22:22).
- Mary Magdalene is the first person in the Gospel to see the risen Lord and the first sent to tell about it. I have seen the Lord (John 20:18).
- That evening the doors were locked for fear. He came and stood in the middle. Locked doors did not keep Him out, and fear did not keep Him away (John 20:19).
- “Peace be to you” was the ordinary greeting, shalom. On that night, from Him, to the men who ran, it was not ordinary at all. He said it twice (John 20:19, 20:21).
- He showed them His hands and His side. The risen body still carries the wounds. Isaiah said: I have engraved you on the palms of my hands (John 20:20, Isaiah 49:16).
- “As the Father has sent me, even so I send you.” Their mission is modeled on His (John 20:21, 17:18).
- “He breathed on them.” The word is the one used when Yahweh God breathed into the man’s nostrils the breath of life, and Ezekiel prophesied to the breath to breathe on the slain so they would live. New creation, in a locked room (John 20:22, Genesis 2:7, Ezekiel 37:9).
- “If you forgive anyone’s sins, they have been forgiven them.” The first thing the risen Lord hands His people is the work of forgiveness. It is where deliverance starts (John 20:23).
- Thomas was not there. Unless I see the print of the nails, and put my hand into His side, I will not believe. He asked for what the others had already been given (John 20:24-25).
- “After eight days” - by their counting, the next first day of the week. He comes again to the same room and goes straight to Thomas (John 20:26).
- He offers Thomas exactly what Thomas demanded, word for word. He had heard every word of the doubt without being in the room (John 20:27, 20:25).
- “My Lord and my God!” is the highest confession in the Gospels, and it comes from the doubter. The psalmist prayed rise up to defend me, my God, my Lord. Yahshua does not correct him (John 20:28, Psalm 35:23).
- The Gospel began with the Word was God and nearly ends with a man calling Him my God. John 1:1 and John 20:28 are the frame of the book (John 20:28, 1:1).
- “Blessed are those who have not seen, and have believed.” That is everyone who has believed since - including everyone reading this (John 20:29).

- “These are written, that you may believe that Jesus is the Christ, the Son of God, and that believing you may have life in his name.” John tells you why he wrote the book. Everything he chose was chosen for this (John 20:30-31).

## Key Cross-References (WEB)

| Topic | References |
|---|---|
| The Day After the Sabbath | John 20:1 • Leviticus 23:10-11 • Leviticus 23:15-16 |
| Cherubim at Either End | John 20:12 • Exodus 25:18-20 • Exodus 25:22 |
| The Man in the Garden | John 20:15 • Genesis 2:15 • Genesis 3:8 |
| Called by Name | John 20:16 • Isaiah 43:1 • John 10:3 |
| Your God My God | John 20:17 • Ruth 1:16 • Psalm 22:22 |
| Peace, Peace | John 20:19 • Isaiah 57:19 • Numbers 6:26 |
| Sins Forgiven | John 20:23 • Psalm 32:1-2 • Micah 7:18 |
| Blessed Without Seeing | John 20:29 • Habakkuk 2:4 • Psalm 34:8 |

## Prophecy Fulfilled

| Fulfillment | References |
|---|---|
| Not Abandoned to Corruption | John 20:9 • Psalm 16:10 • Hosea 6:2 |
| The Firstfruits | John 20:17 • Leviticus 23:10-11 • 1 Corinthians 15:20 |
| Here I Am, Send Me | John 20:21 • Isaiah 6:8 • Isaiah 61:1 |
| Breath on the Slain | John 20:22 • Ezekiel 37:9-10 • Genesis 2:7 |
| Engraved on the Palms of My Hands | John 20:27 • Isaiah 49:16 • Zechariah 13:6 |
| My God and My Lord | John 20:28 • Psalm 35:23 • Isaiah 9:6 |

## For Further Study

Credible external commentary that expounds on this chapter in a way consistent with a Torah-honoring, Messianic reading of the text:

- Enduring Word - John 20 Commentary (David Guzik) - the empty tomb, Mary Magdalene, the appearance to the disciples, and Thomas
- Life, Hope and Truth - The Gospel of John - John’s signs, the I AM sayings, and why this Gospel differs from the other three
- Verse By Verse Ministry International - The Gospel of John, Lesson 20A - exposition of the resurrection accounts in John

## John 20 - Introduction

On the first day of the week, while it is still dark, Mary Magdalene finds the stone already removed. No one in any Gospel witnesses the resurrection itself; it is found already accomplished. The day is the one after the Sabbath on which, during Unleavened Bread, the firstfruits sheaf was waved before Yahweh, and Paul would call the risen Messiah the firstfruits of those who sleep. Mary assumes robbery and runs to Peter and the beloved disciple, who race to the tomb. John records that he arrived first and waited, and that Peter went straight in. The linen lies in place and the head cloth is rolled up apart - no thief's work, and a contrast with Lazarus, who came out bound. The beloved disciple sees and believes, though none of them yet understood the Scriptures that He must rise.

Mary remains, weeping, and sees two angels where the body had lain, one at the head and one at the feet, like the cherubim at either end of the mercy seat where Yahweh promised to meet with Israel. She mistakes the risen Lord for the gardener - not wholly wrongly, in a garden on the first morning of the new creation - until He speaks her name, as the shepherd calls his own sheep. She clings to Him and is told to let go: He has not yet ascended, and she is to tell His brothers - the first time He calls them that - that He ascends to His Father and theirs, His God and theirs. She becomes the first to announce that she has seen the Lord.

That evening He stands among the disciples behind locked doors and gives them peace, twice, showing the wounds in His hands and side. As the Father sent Him, He sends them, and He breathes on them - the verb of Yahweh breathing life into Adam and of Ezekiel's breath upon the slain - saying receive the Holy Spirit, and entrusting them with the forgiveness of sins, which is where deliverance begins.

Thomas, absent, demands to touch the wounds. Eight days later Yahshua returns and offers him the exact terms of his doubt, which He had heard without being present. Thomas answers my Lord and my God, and is not corrected; the Gospel that opened with the Word was God closes its account with a man calling Him my God. Blessed are those who have not seen and yet believe - every reader since. And John states his purpose: these things are written that you may believe that Jesus is the Christ, the Son of God, and believing have life in His name.

## John 20:1-31 (WEB)

**1** Now on the first day of the week, Mary Magdalene went early, while it was still dark, to the tomb, and saw the stone taken away from the tomb.[265]

**2** Therefore she ran and came to Simon Peter, and to the other disciple whom Jesus loved, and said to them, "They have taken away the Lord out of the tomb, and we don't know where they have laid him!"

**3** Therefore Peter and the other disciple went out, and they went toward the tomb.

**4** They both ran together. The other disciple outran Peter, and came to the tomb first.

**5** Stooping and looking in, he saw the linen cloths lying, yet he didn't enter in.

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[265] **Cross-Reference:** Leviticus 23:10-11 • Leviticus 23:15-16 - *the sheaf of firstfruits waved on the day after the Sabbath, and the count of fifty days from that day*

**6** Then Simon Peter came, following him, and entered into the tomb. He saw the linen cloths lying,

**7** and the cloth that had been on his head, not lying with the linen cloths, but rolled up in a place by itself.

**8** So then the other disciple who came first to the tomb also entered in, and he saw and believed.

**9** For as yet they didn't know the Scripture, that he must rise from the dead.[266]

**10** So the disciples went away again to their own homes.

**11** But Mary was standing outside at the tomb weeping. So, as she wept, she stooped and looked into the tomb,

**12** and she saw two angels in white sitting, one at the head, and one at the feet, where the body of Jesus had lain.[267]

**13** They told her, "Woman, why are you weeping?" She said to them, "Because they have taken away my Lord, and I don't know where they have laid him."

**14** When she had said this, she turned around and saw Jesus standing, and didn't know that it was Jesus.

**15** Jesus said to her, "Woman, why are you weeping? Who are you looking for?" She, supposing him to be the gardener, said to him, "Sir, if you have carried him away, tell me where you have laid him, and I will take him away."[268]

**16** Jesus said to her, "Mary." She turned and said to him, "Rabboni!" which is to say, "Teacher!"[269]

**17** Jesus said to her, "Don't hold me, for I haven't yet ascended to my Father; but go to my brothers, and tell them, 'I am ascending to my Father and your Father, to my God and your God.'"[270,271]

**18** Mary Magdalene came and told the disciples that she had seen the Lord, and that he had said these things to her.

**19** When therefore it was evening, on that day, the first day of the week, and when the doors were locked where the disciples were assembled, for fear of the Jews, Jesus came and stood in the middle, and said to them, "Peace be to you."[272]

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[266] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Psalm 16:10 • Hosea 6:2 - *you will not allow your holy one to see corruption, and on the third day he will raise us up*

[267] **Cross-Reference:** Exodus 25:18-20 • Exodus 25:22 - *two cherubim at the two ends of the mercy seat, and there I will meet with you*

[268] **Cross-Reference:** Genesis 2:15 • Genesis 3:8 - *the man put in the garden to cultivate and keep it, and Yahweh God walking in the garden*

[269] **Cross-Reference:** Isaiah 43:1 • John 10:3 - *I have called you by your name, you are mine, and the shepherd calls his own sheep by name*

[270] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Leviticus 23:10-11 • 1 Corinthians 15:20 - *the sheaf of the firstfruits waved before Yahweh to be accepted, and Messiah raised as the first fruits of those who are asleep*

[271] **Cross-Reference:** Ruth 1:16 • Psalm 22:22 - *your God my God, and I will declare your name to my brothers*

**20** When he had said this, he showed them his hands and his side. The disciples therefore were glad when they saw the Lord.

**21** Jesus therefore said to them again, “Peace be to you. As the Father has sent me, even so I send you.”[273]

**22** When he had said this, he breathed on them, and said to them, “Receive the Holy Spirit![274]

**23** If you forgive anyone’s sins, they have been forgiven them. If you retain anyone’s sins, they have been retained.”[275]

**24** But Thomas, one of the twelve, called Didymus, wasn’t with them when Jesus came.

**25** The other disciples therefore said to him, “We have seen the Lord!” But he said to them, “Unless I see in his hands the print of the nails, put my finger into the print of the nails, and put my hand into his side, I will not believe.”

**26** After eight days again his disciples were inside, and Thomas was with them. Jesus came, the doors being locked, and stood in the middle, and said, “Peace be to you.”

**27** Then he said to Thomas, “Reach here your finger, and see my hands. Reach here your hand, and put it into my side. Don’t be unbelieving, but believing.”[276]

**28** Thomas answered him, “My Lord and my God!”[277]

**29** Jesus said to him, “Because you have seen me, you have believed. Blessed are those who have not seen, and have believed.”[278]

**30** Therefore Jesus did many other signs in the presence of his disciples, which are not written in this book;

**31** but these are written, that you may believe that Jesus is the Christ, the Son of God, and that believing you may have life in his name.

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[272] **Cross-Reference:** Isaiah 57:19 • Numbers 6:26 - *peace, peace, to him who is far off and to him who is near, and Yahweh give you peace*

[273] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Isaiah 6:8 • Isaiah 61:1 - *whom shall I send, and the anointed one sent to proclaim liberty*

[274] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Ezekiel 37:9-10 • Genesis 2:7 - *breath, breathe on these slain that they may live, and Yahweh God breathing into the man the breath of life*

[275] **Cross-Reference:** Psalm 32:1-2 • Micah 7:18 - *blessed is he whose disobedience is forgiven, and who is a God like you, who pardons iniquity*

[276] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Isaiah 49:16 • Zechariah 13:6 - *I have engraved you on the palms of my hands, and the wounds with which he was wounded in the house of his friends*

[277] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Psalm 35:23 • Isaiah 9:6 - *rise up to defend me, my God, my Lord, and the son given whose name is Mighty God*

[278] **Cross-Reference:** Habakkuk 2:4 • Psalm 34:8 - *the righteous will live by his faith, and taste and see that Yahweh is good*

# CHAPTER 21 - A Night of Catching Nothing, Breakfast on the Beach, and Do You Love Me?

## Key Notes

- Chapter 20 ended with a purpose statement that sounds like a conclusion. Chapter 21 reads like an epilogue, added to tell what happened to Peter and to correct a rumor about the beloved disciple (John 21:1, 20:31, 21:23).
- Seven disciples are there, and Nathanael of Cana is named - the man from chapter 1, who has not been mentioned since (John 21:2, 1:45-49).
- “I’m going fishing.” Peter goes back to what he knew before he was called. The others go with him. That night they caught nothing (John 21:3).
- It is the same scene as the day He first called Peter in Luke: a night of nothing, a word to let the nets down, and more fish than the net could hold. He is calling Peter again, the same way (John 21:3-6, Luke 5:5-6).
- “Children, have you anything to eat?” He calls them children, little ones, the way a father would. They answer with one word: no (John 21:5).
- “Cast the net on the right side of the boat.” A hundred yards from shore, on the side they had presumably already tried. The difference was not the location. It was the word (John 21:6).
- “It’s the Lord!” The beloved disciple recognizes Him first; Peter acts first. He throws on his coat and jumps into the water. The two of them, true to form (John 21:7).
- A fire of coals, with fish and bread already on it. The charcoal fire is the same word as the fire in the high priest’s courtyard where Peter denied Him. The only two in the New Testament (John 21:9, 18:18).
- Fish and bread, the same food as the feeding of the five thousand. He takes the bread and gives it to them, and the fish likewise (John 21:9, 21:13, 6:11).
- “Bring some of the fish which you have just caught.” He already has fish on the fire. He asks for theirs anyway. He wants their part in it (John 21:10).
- A hundred and fifty-three large fish, counted. It is the kind of thing a fisherman remembers. Many symbolic readings have been offered; the text offers none. And the net was not torn, though in the earlier catch the nets were breaking (John 21:11, Luke 5:6).
- Ezekiel saw a river flowing from the temple, and fishermen spreading their nets, and fish exceedingly many. The catch is a picture of what the mission will bring in (John 21:11, Ezekiel 47:9-10).
- “Come and eat breakfast.” The risen Lord of all creation cooks breakfast for men who abandoned Him (John 21:12).
- “None of the disciples dared inquire of him, ‘Who are you?’ knowing that it was the Lord.” He is the same and not the same, recognized and yet changed (John 21:12).

- “Simon, son of Jonah” - not Peter, the rock. The name he had before he was called. Three times (John 21:15-17, 1:42).
- “Do you love me more than these?” More than these men, or more than these fish and boats? Peter had once claimed more than the others: even if all fall away, I will not. Now he does not compare himself to anyone (John 21:15, Mark 14:29).
- The WEB shows a change in the Greek. Twice Yahshua asks do you love me, using agapao, and Peter answers I have affection for you, using phileo. The third time Yahshua takes Peter’s own word. Readers debate how much weight to give it, since John uses both words for the Father’s love for the Son (John 21:15-17, 3:35, 5:20).
- Three questions for three denials. He does not skip the wound, and He does not leave it open (John 21:17, 18:17, 18:25, 18:27).
- “Peter was grieved because he asked him the third time.” Restoration can hurt. The grief is part of the healing (John 21:17).
- “Lord, you know everything. You know that I have affection for you.” Peter no longer trusts his own promises. He appeals to what the Lord knows (John 21:17).
- Feed my lambs, tend my sheep, feed my sheep. The man who failed is given the flock. Restoration in this Gospel is not probation; it is a commission (John 21:15-17, 10:11).
- “When you are old, you will stretch out your hands, and another will dress you.” John explains it meant the kind of death by which Peter would glorify God. Early tradition says Peter was crucified in Rome. Peter himself later wrote that the putting off of his tent was near, as the Lord had shown him (John 21:18-19, 2 Peter 1:14).
- “Follow me.” The first words He spoke to His first followers in chapter 1 were come and see; the last words He says to Peter are follow me (John 21:19, 1:39).
- “Lord, what about this man?” Peter, just restored, immediately looks at somebody else’s path. “What is that to you? You follow me” (John 21:21-22).
- A rumor spread that the beloved disciple would not die. John corrects it carefully: Yahshua never said that. He said if I desire that he stay until I come. Even at the end, John insists on exactly what was said (John 21:23).
- “This is the disciple who testifies about these things, and wrote these things. We know that his witness is true.” The beloved disciple is the author, and others vouch for him (John 21:24).
- “Even the world itself wouldn’t have room for the books.” John chose a handful of signs out of a life too large to write down - and chose them so that you might believe (John 21:25, 20:30-31).

## Key Cross-References (WEB)

| Topic | References |
|---|---|
| Labor in Vain | John 21:3 • Psalm 127:1-2 • Haggai 1:6 |
| At Your Word I Will Let Down the Net | John 21:6 • Luke 5:5-6 |

| Topic | References |
|---|---|
| The Fire of Coals | John 21:9 • John 18:18 |
| He Took the Bread and Gave It | John 21:13 • John 6:11 |
| Shepherds After My Heart | John 21:15 • Jeremiah 3:15 • Ezekiel 34:2 |
| Confessing and Finding Mercy | John 21:17 • Proverbs 28:13 • Psalm 51:12 |
| The Putting Off of My Tent | John 21:18 • 2 Peter 1:14 |
| He Arose and Followed | John 21:19 • 1 Kings 19:20-21 |

## Prophecy Fulfilled

| Fulfillment | References |
|---|---|
| Fish Exceedingly Many | John 21:11 • Ezekiel 47:9-10 • Jeremiah 16:16 |
| He Will Feed His Flock | John 21:15 • Isaiah 40:11 • Ezekiel 34:23 |
| He Restores My Soul | John 21:17 • Psalm 23:3 • Isaiah 57:18 |
| Until I Come | John 21:22 • Zechariah 14:5 • Malachi 3:1 |
| You Are My Witnesses | John 21:24 • Isaiah 43:10 • Isaiah 44:8 |

## For Further Study

Credible external commentary that expounds on this chapter in a way consistent with a Torah-honoring, Messianic reading of the text:

- Enduring Word - John 21 Commentary (David Guzik) - the miraculous catch, breakfast by the sea, and the restoration of Peter
- Life, Hope and Truth - The Gospel of John - John's signs, the I AM sayings, and why this Gospel differs from the other three
- Verse By Verse Ministry International - The Gospel of John, Lesson 21 - exposition of the epilogue and Peter's restoration

## John 21 - Introduction

The Gospel seemed to close with its purpose statement, but John adds an epilogue, because Peter's story is unfinished. Seven disciples are by the Sea of Tiberias, Nathanael of Cana among them, and Peter announces that he is going fishing - back to the life before his call, perhaps believing after the courtyard that it was all he was fit for. They fish all night and catch nothing. At dawn a man on the shore, unrecognised, calls them children, asks if they have caught anything, and tells them to cast on the right side. The net fills beyond hauling - the very scene of Peter's first call in Luke, repeated to call him again.

The beloved disciple recognises Him first, and Peter, as at the tomb, acts first, plunging into the sea. On the shore is a charcoal fire, with fish and bread - the word used only here and for the fire where Peter denied Him, and the food of the five thousand. He asks for some of their catch though He has fish

already cooking. The catch is counted, a hundred and fifty-three, and the net holds, as Ezekiel's fishermen spread their nets by the river from the temple among fish exceedingly many. Then the risen Lord serves breakfast to the men who had abandoned Him.

After the meal He addresses Peter by his old name, Simon son of Jonah, and asks three times whether Peter loves Him. Peter, who once claimed to love Him more than all the others, now compares himself to no one, and answers with a humbler word than the one he was asked - which the WEB preserves - until the third time Yahshua takes up Peter's own word. Three questions answer three denials, and Peter is grieved, because restoration does not skip the wound; but he appeals no longer to his own promises, only to the Lord's knowledge of him. Each answer is followed by a charge to feed or tend the flock. The man who failed is given the sheep. Restoration is a commission, not a probation.

Yahshua tells Peter that in old age he will stretch out his hands and be led where he would not go, signifying the death by which he would glorify God, and says follow Me. Peter at once asks about the beloved disciple, and is told that whatever is decided for that man, his part is to follow. John corrects the rumor that this disciple would not die, insisting on exactly what was said, and the book closes with the testimony of its author, vouched for by others, and the confession that the world itself could not contain the books if everything He did were written.

## John 21:1-25 (WEB)

**1** After these things, Jesus revealed himself again to the disciples at the sea of Tiberias. He revealed himself this way.

**2** Simon Peter, Thomas called Didymus, Nathanael of Cana in Galilee, and the sons of Zebedee, and two others of his disciples were together.

**3** Simon Peter said to them, "I'm going fishing." They told him, "We are also coming with you." They immediately went out, and entered into the boat. That night, they caught nothing.[279]

**4** But when day had already come, Jesus stood on the beach, yet the disciples didn't know that it was Jesus.

**5** Jesus therefore said to them, "Children, have you anything to eat?" They answered him, "No."

**6** He said to them, "Cast the net on the right side of the boat, and you will find some." They cast it therefore, and now they weren't able to draw it in for the multitude of fish.[280]

**7** That disciple therefore whom Jesus loved said to Peter, "It's the Lord!" So when Simon Peter heard that it was the Lord, he wrapped his coat around him (for he was naked), and threw himself into the sea.

**8** But the other disciples came in the little boat (for they were not far from the land, but about two hundred cubits away), dragging the net full of fish.

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[279] **Cross-Reference:** Psalm 127:1-2 • Haggai 1:6 - *unless Yahweh builds the house they labor in vain, and you have sown much and bring in little*

[280] **Cross-Reference:** Luke 5:5-6 - *we worked all night and took nothing, but at your word I will let down the net, and the net was breaking*

**9** So when they got out on the land, they saw a fire of coals there, and fish laid on it, and bread.[281]

**10** Jesus said to them, “Bring some of the fish which you have just caught.”

**11** Simon Peter went up, and drew the net to land, full of great fish, one hundred fifty-three; and even though there were so many, the net wasn’t torn.[282]

**12** Jesus said to them, “Come and eat breakfast.” None of the disciples dared inquire of him, “Who are you?” knowing that it was the Lord.

**13** Then Jesus came and took the bread, gave it to them, and the fish likewise.[283]

**14** This is now the third time that Jesus was revealed to his disciples, after he had risen from the dead.

**15** So when they had eaten their breakfast, Jesus said to Simon Peter, “Simon, son of Jonah, do you love me more than these?” He said to him, “Yes, Lord; you know that I have affection for you.” He said to him, “Feed my lambs.”[284,285]

**16** He said to him again a second time, “Simon, son of Jonah, do you love me?” He said to him, “Yes, Lord; you know that I have affection for you.” He said to him, “Tend my sheep.”

**17** He said to him the third time, “Simon, son of Jonah, do you have affection for me?” Peter was grieved because he asked him the third time, “Do you have affection for me?” He said to him, “Lord, you know everything. You know that I have affection for you.” Jesus said to him, “Feed my sheep.[286,287]

**18** Most certainly I tell you, when you were young, you dressed yourself, and walked where you wanted to. But when you are old, you will stretch out your hands, and another will dress you, and carry you where you don’t want to go.”[288]

**19** Now he said this, signifying by what kind of death he would glorify God. When he had said this, he said to him, “Follow me.”[289]

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[281] **Cross-Reference:** John 18:18 - *the fire of coals in the high priest’s courtyard where Peter stood warming himself*

[282] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Ezekiel 47:9-10 • Jeremiah 16:16 - *fishermen spreading nets where the river flows and fish exceedingly many, and I will send for many fishermen*

[283] **Cross-Reference:** John 6:11 - *Jesus took the loaves, gave thanks, and distributed them, and likewise the fish*

[284] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Isaiah 40:11 • Ezekiel 34:23 - *he will feed his flock like a shepherd, and one shepherd set over them who will feed them*

[285] **Cross-Reference:** Jeremiah 3:15 • Ezekiel 34:2 - *shepherds according to my heart who feed you with knowledge, and shouldn’t the shepherds feed the sheep*

[286] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Psalm 23:3 • Isaiah 57:18 - *he restores my soul, and I have seen his ways, and will heal him and restore comforts to him*

[287] **Cross-Reference:** Proverbs 28:13 • Psalm 51:12 - *whoever confesses and renounces his sins finds mercy, and restore to me the joy of your salvation*

[288] **Cross-Reference:** 2 Peter 1:14 - *the putting off of my tent comes swiftly, as our Lord made clear to me*

[289] **Cross-Reference:** 1 Kings 19:20-21 - *Elisha leaving the oxen and running after Elijah, and then he arose and went after him*

**20** Then Peter, turning around, saw a disciple following. This was the disciple whom Jesus loved, the one who had also leaned on Jesus' breast at the supper and asked, "Lord, who is going to betray You?"

**21** Peter seeing him, said to Jesus, "Lord, what about this man?"

**22** Jesus said to him, "If I desire that he stay until I come, what is that to you? You follow me."[290]

**23** This saying therefore went out among the brothers, that this disciple wouldn't die. Yet Jesus didn't say to him that he wouldn't die, but, "If I desire that he stay until I come, what is that to you?"

**24** This is the disciple who testifies about these things, and wrote these things. We know that his witness is true.[291]

**25** There are also many other things which Jesus did, which if they would all be written, I suppose that even the world itself wouldn't have room for the books that would be written.

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[290] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Zechariah 14:5 • Malachi 3:1 - *Yahweh my God will come, and all the holy ones with you, and the Lord whom you seek will suddenly come*

[291] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Isaiah 43:10 • Isaiah 44:8 - *you are my witnesses, says Yahweh, and is there a God besides me*

## Major Themes Across John 19-21

- Thorns from the curse, worn as a crown by the one who came to lift it
- Behold the man, a pagan governor quoting Zechariah without knowing it
- The Lamb examined three times and found without defect
- Power over Him given only from above
- We have no king but Caesar, from the men who led Yahweh's worship
- The Son carrying the wood up the hill, as Isaac did
- A sign in three languages telling the truth Pilate would not stand for
- A seamless tunic, woven like the robe of the high priest
- A mother given a son from the cross
- The giver of living water, thirsty
- Hyssop, the plant that marked the Passover blood on the doorposts
- It is finished: paid in full
- A spirit given up, not taken
- A special Sabbath, and two Sabbaths in one week
- Not a bone broken, like the Passover lamb
- They will look on Him whom they pierced, spoken by Yahweh of Himself
- Secret disciples brought into the open by the cross
- A king's burial in a new tomb in a garden
- A tomb found already empty, before dawn, on the day of firstfruits
- Grave clothes left lying, and a head cloth folded by itself
- Two angels at the head and feet, like the cherubim of the mercy seat
- The last Adam mistaken for the gardener
- One word, her name, and she knew His voice
- Brothers for the first time, and a Father shared
- Peace spoken first to the men who ran
- Wounds still carried by the risen body
- Breath on the disciples as on the first man and Ezekiel's slain
- Forgiveness handed over first, where deliverance begins
- The doubter's exact words offered back to him
- My Lord and my God: the frame of the book closing
- Blessed are those who have not seen
- A night of nothing and a word from the shore

- Two charcoal fires, denial and restoration
- Breakfast cooked by the risen Lord
- Three questions for three denials
- Restoration that is a commission, not a probation
- What is that to you? You follow Me